

Age Friendly Northfield Survey Final Report

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1. Background

Age Friendly Northfield (AFN) is a volunteer organization that helps to make the Northfield community a good place to live for people of all ages, especially older adults.

There are many home services that are very important for older adults in the Northfield community in order to continue living independently while maintaining a high quality of life. Age Friendly Northfield is aiming to make these services affordable, accessible, and easy to find. Although there are many caregivers, health care providers, and other organizations that are trying to provide services, there still might be a gap between the demand for the services and the elderly sufficiently receiving these services.

In order to find the possible gaps that exist between the elderly and the service providers, AFN recently conducted a survey of adults aged 50+ in Northfield in the spring of 2021 on the availability of in-home supports and services to identify areas of the community that needed improvement. The services included: chore, homemaker, home modifications, nutrition/meal, personal care and home health, respite care, support group, and transportation services. The survey was distributed as paper copies and online through the following link: <https://bit.ly/agefriendlynorthfield>.

In this report, we analyzed the results of this survey and identified important service gaps in the community.

2. Methodology

This report is based on the survey data collected by AFN from Northfield residents age 50+ on the availability of the following home and community-based services: chore, homemaker, home modifications, nutrition/meal, personal care and home health, respite care, support group and transportation.

Not all responses to the survey were valid, so we had to filter the data to only include responses to the survey that were acceptable for analysis. We decided to check whether there was a difference between the survey responses for surveys that filled out less than 25% of the survey and surveys that filled out more than 25% of the survey. We checked this by conducting a proportion test for the first question to see if the proportion of people who answered “Yes” to the first question differed depending on survey progress. While we did not find a statistically significant difference, we believed that there was enough of a difference to justify removing surveys that were less than 25% filled out, because they only answered a couple of questions and this could have been people testing the survey. All of the analysis conducted will only include surveys that were more than 25% filled out.

In order to visualize the general results for goals, we created barplots that display the number of people who checked the option. This method was applied to all the plots in the Service Category Breakdown section and the Demographics section. For plots in the general results for goals, the same method was used when generating the plot for “What resources do people use to find services”.

What services are people using?

In order to calculate the usage percentage of each service, we first calculated the total number of people who answered each question regarding if they use the service or not (the first question of each service section). We divided the answer categories into yes, no and no answer. We used stacked bar plots to visualize the percentage of each service.

What services do people need but are not using?

In order to calculate the needed but not used service, we first counted the number of people who answered each service’s corresponding question. Then, we counted the number of people who answered that they don’t have an unmet service for each question, and used the total number of respondents minus the previous number to calculate the number of unmet needs. After this step, we use the number of unmet needs divided by the number of respondents for each question to calculate the percentage of unmet needs for each service.

Why are people not using services?

A stacked barplot is created for “Why people are not using services” to provide an overview of the reasons why services were not used. Each bar consists of the number of people who checked the reason in each service.

Which services are most needed but not available?

A barplot is created to provide an overview specifically of the number of people that deemed a service as unavailable. Each bar is composed of the number of people who checked the reason in each service. For transportation services, there were three options in the survey that indicated some form of unavailability, so the number of people that marked transportation services as being unavailable was calculated by finding the number of people that checked at least one of the options for unavailability in the survey (location not served, unavailable, and/or handicap option not available).

Caregiver analysis

In order to identify the respondents who are caregivers, we used a list of questions from the survey as reference points. If a respondent selects a certain option in any one of these questions, they are flagged as a caregiver. The questions are:

- Q5. Please check the box next to any of the healthy living topics you would be interested in learning more about or participating in. (Respondents who selected “Caregiver Support” are identified as caregivers.)
- Q22. Did you use an in-home or out-of-home respite care service over the past year? (Respondents who selected “Yes” are identified as caregivers.)

- Q24 Which respite care services did you need, but not use? (Respondents who selected “In-home”, “Out-of-home”, or “Other” are identified as caregivers.)
- Q27 Which support group did you use in the past year? (Respondents who selected “Caregiver” are identified as caregivers.)

The data visualization methods used in caregiver analysis are the same as the ones mentioned above.

Income analysis

To determine if the survey results differed based on income, we chose to split the survey respondents into two categories: those that reported an annual income greater than 75,000 dollars, and those that reported an annual income less than 75,000 dollars. We chose this split because it separated the respondents into relatively similar group sizes, with 136 people reporting an income greater than 75,000 dollars and 154 people reporting an income less than 75,000 dollars.

The data visualization methods used in income analysis are the same as the ones mentioned above.

3. Summary of Findings

In this report, we aim to address the main goals brought to our attention by Age-Friendly Northfield in how older adults can be better supported. The following is the five goals we addressed and a summary of overall findings:

1. Which services are people using? According to the analysis generated, chore services are the most popular service people are using. Homemaker, transportation and home modification services are also commonly used compared to other services.
2. What services do people need but are not using? According to the analysis generated, chore services are the most needed but not used service. Homemaker services also have unmet needs.
3. Why aren't people using the services? According to the analysis generated, most people found help on their own or couldn't find the service.
4. What services are most needed but unavailable? According to the analysis generated, transportation services stand out as being indicated as highly unavailable. Support group and chore services were also deemed unavailable.
5. What resources do people use to find services? According to the analysis generated, the top 3 resources for finding services are FiftyNorth, healthcare professionals, and faith communities.

Overall, the 4 services which appear to need the most development are **chore, transportation, support group, and homemaker services.**

Most people **found help on their own** for why a service was needed but not used, but the second common reason was that they **don't know how to find the service.**

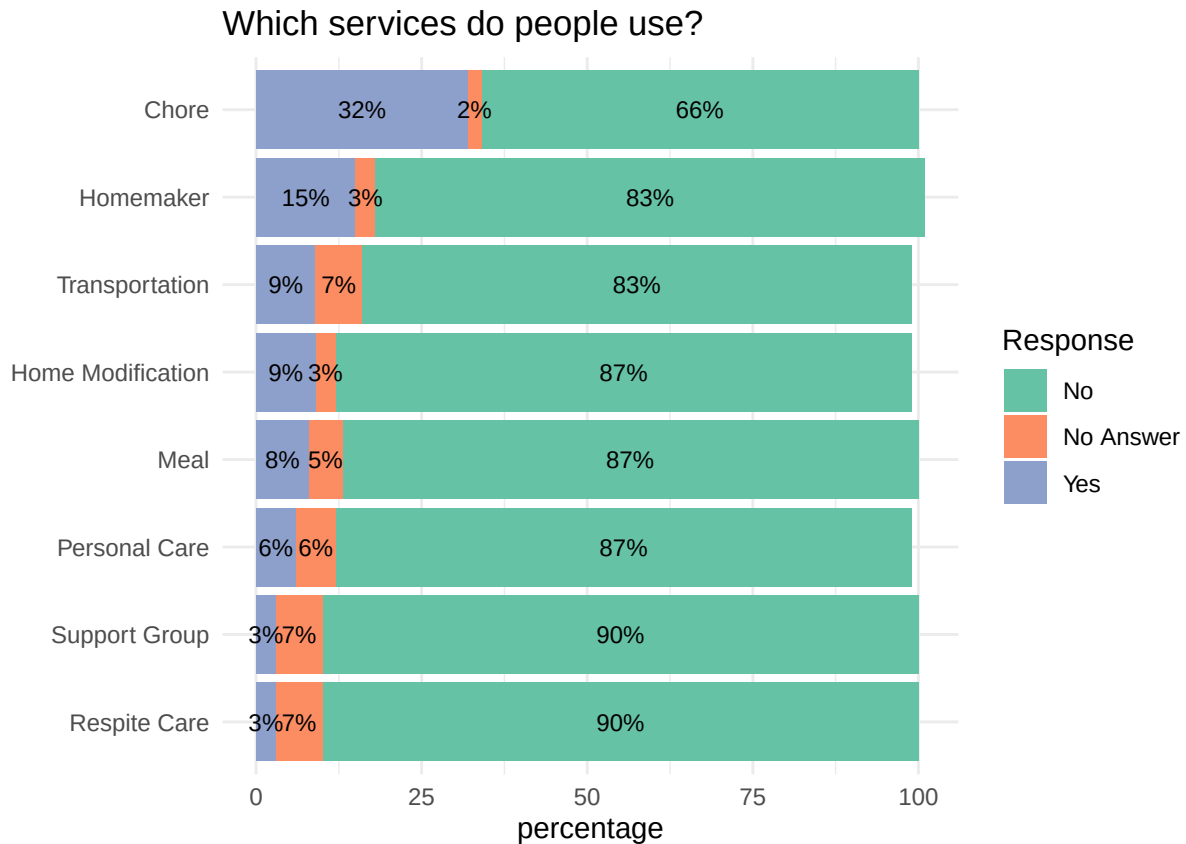
- **Chore services** were the most needed but not used service; however, this could be because it was the most popular service.
- **Transportation services** were indicated as being the most unavailable, but this also could be due to the survey having 3 separate options for how this was unavailable.
- **Support group** services were both needed but not used, and unavailable.
- **Homemaker** services were needed but not used, but were not deemed as highly unavailable.

Based on the counts of people answering the questions, **chore services and transportation services** are especially in need of development.

4. General Results for Goals

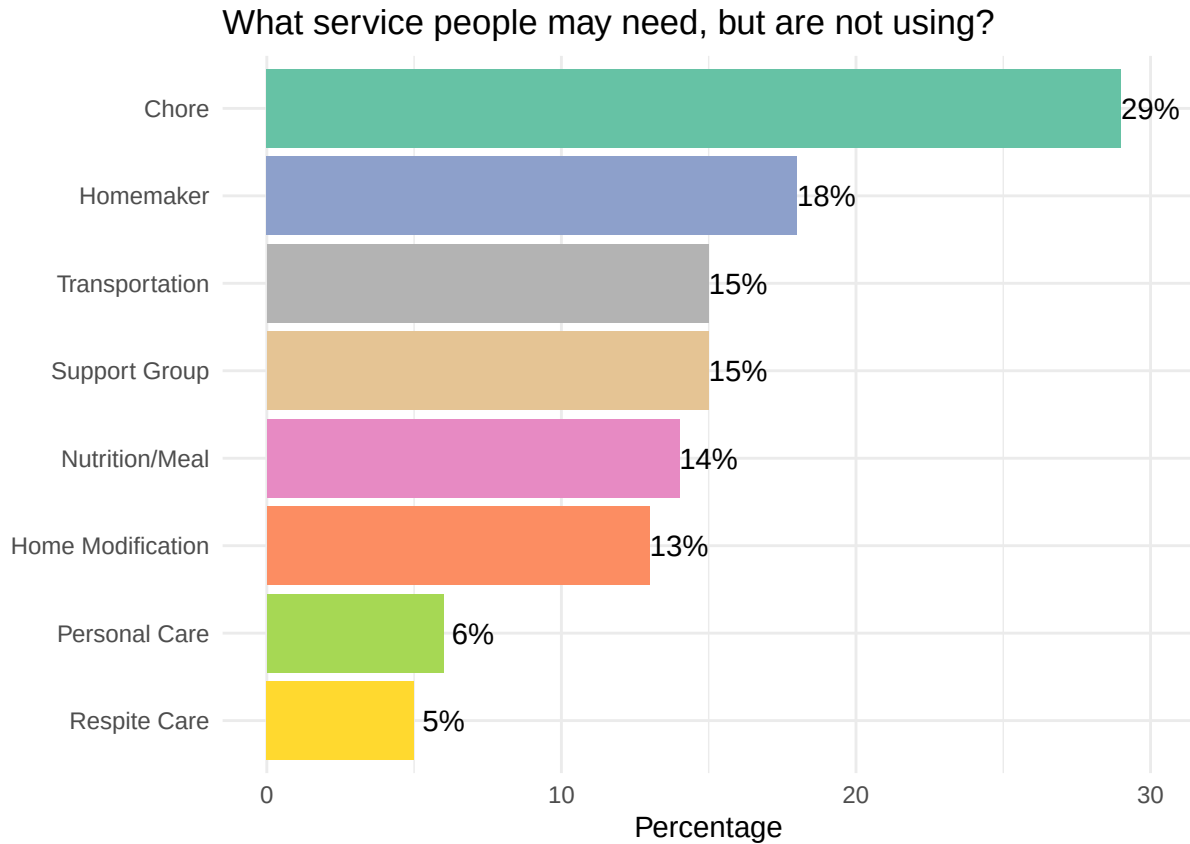
What services are people using?

As shown in the stacked bar plot below, chore services are the most popular service with 32% of respondents using it. Homemaker services are the second most popular one with 15% of respondents using it. Transportation and home modification services are tied in third place, with 9% of respondents using it.



What services do people need but are not using?

As shown in the bar plot below, chore services are the most needed but not used service with 29% of respondents indicating unmet needs. Homemaker services are the second most needed service with 18% of respondents indicating needs. Transportation and support group services are tied in the third place with 15% of respondents indicating unmet needs.



Why are people not using services?

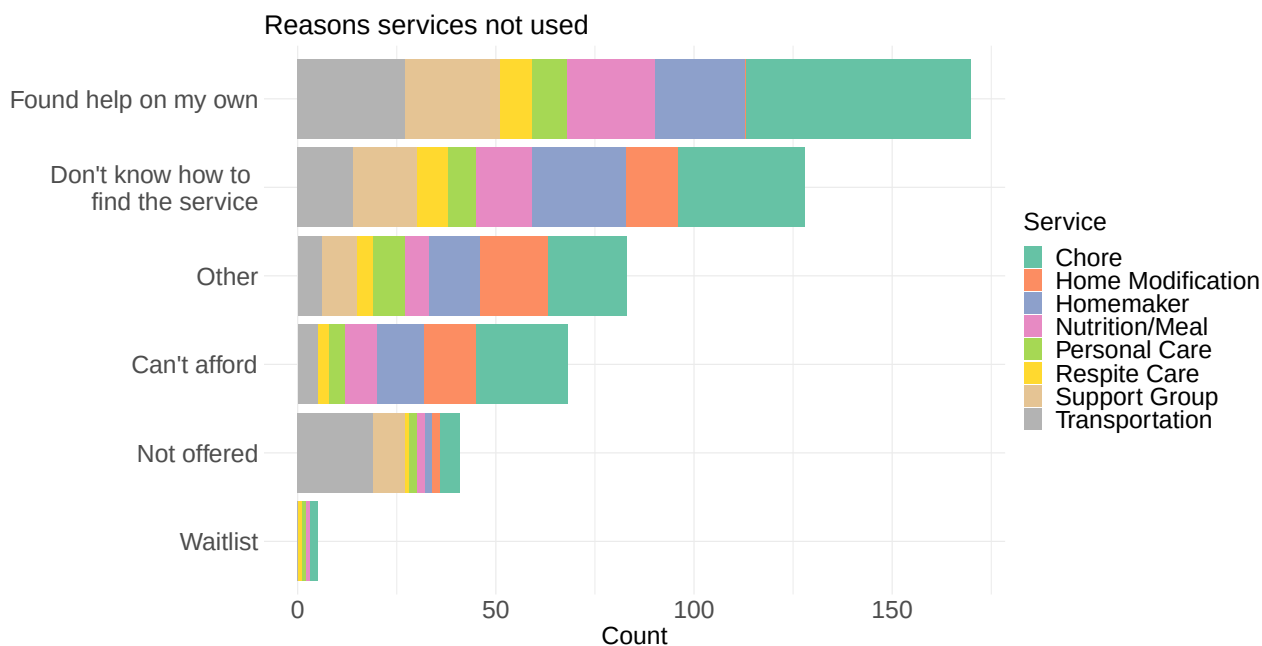
This is an overview of why people are not using services. The most common reason is “found help on my own”, followed by “don’t know how to find the service”, “other”, “can’t afford”, “not offered”, and “waitlist”.

What stands out in this plot is the disproportionately large amount of responses indicating the unavailability of the transportation services, suggested by the grey box within the reason “not offered”.

Note: The count in this plot refers to the number of times a reason is selected by the participants, not the number of people who had that reason.

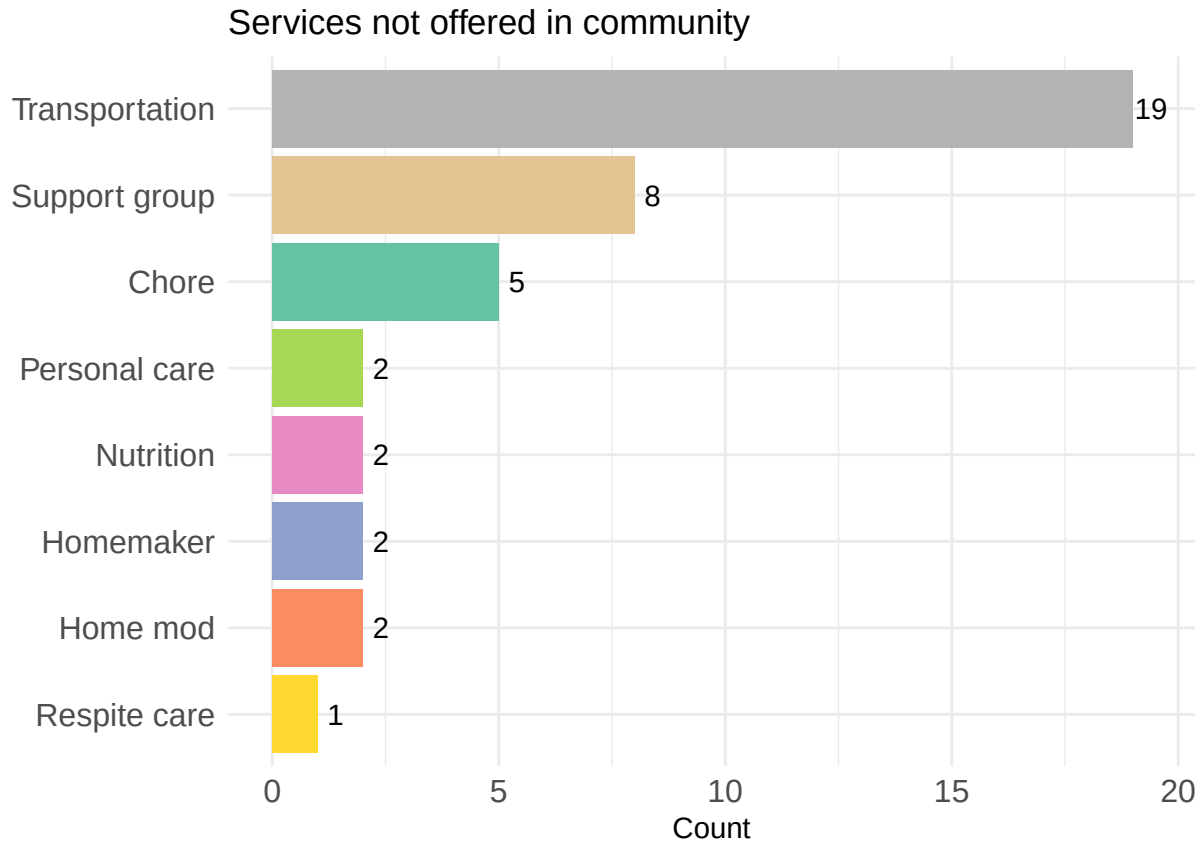
Table 1: Reasons of services not being used

Reason	Chore	Homemaker	Home Modification	Nutrition/Meal	Personal Care and Home Health	Respite Care	Support Group	Transportation
Not offered	5	2	2	2	2	1	8	19
Don't know how to find the service	32	24	13	14	7	8	16	14
Can't afford	23	12	13	8	4	3	0	5
Waitlist	2	0	0	1	1	1	0	0
Found help on my own	57	23	0	22	9	8	24	27
Other	20	13	17	6	8	4	9	6



Which services are most needed but not available?

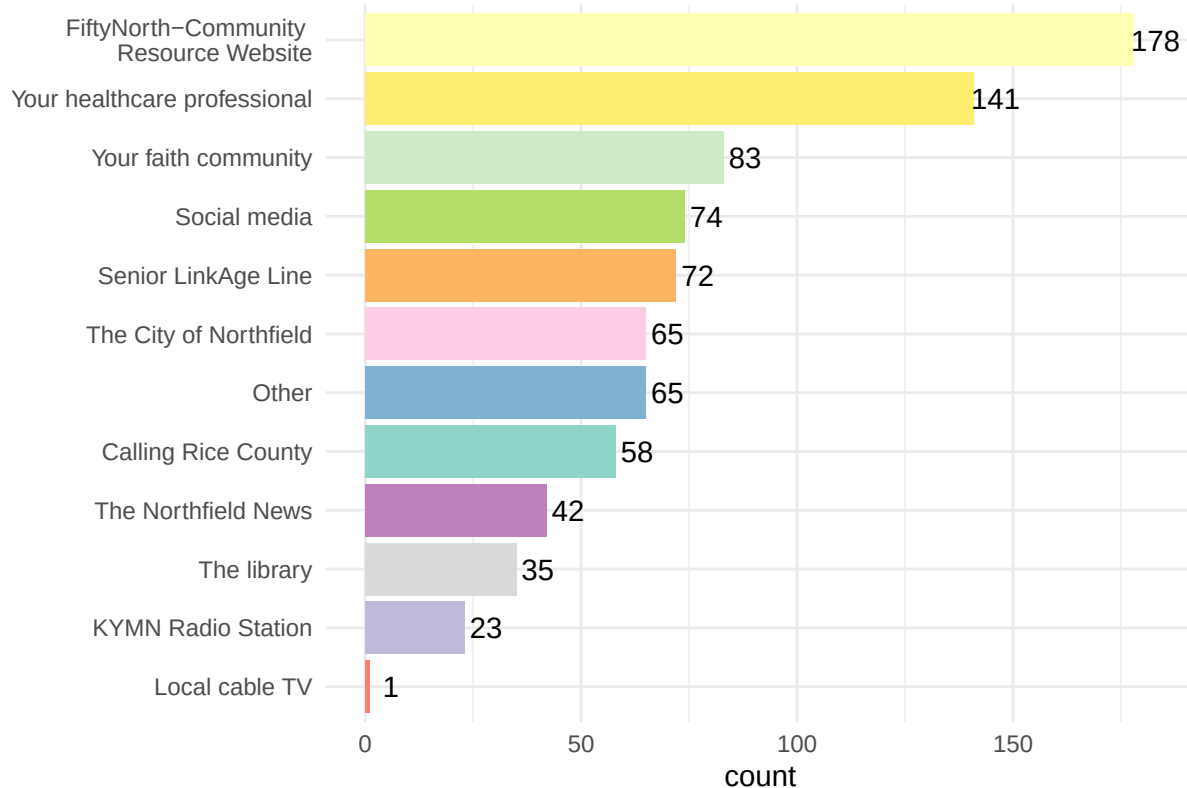
As shown in the bar plot below, transportation services stand out as being unavailable, with 19 people saying that transportation services were unavailable for them. As mentioned in the methodology, this could just be due to there being three options in the survey indicating some form of unavailability, so respondents might have been more likely to mark this service as unavailable if they were prompted with more reasons. Support group services are the 2nd most unavailable service with 8 people marking this as unavailable, followed by chore services with 5 respondents.



What resources do people use to find services?

According to the bar plot shown below, FiftyNorth-Community Resource Website is the most popular resource people use to find services, with over half of the respondents using this resource. We have a total 349 valid responses, and 178 people put FiftyNorth-Community Resource Website as one of their top three choices. People's healthcare professionals are the second most popular resource, with 141 people using this resource. People's faith communities are the third most popular resource, with 83 people using it. Among the 64 text responses, 17 people indicated the usage of internet search including Google, and 23 people mentioned family or friend recommendations. Hospital/doctor recommendations are not included in some people's top 3 resources, but some respondents also included healthcare professionals in their text responses.

What resources people use to find service?



Text Responses

1. "Internet"
2. "Northfield Hospital"
3. "internet search"
4. "family and friends"
5. "friends"
6. "Email"
7. "Friends and acquaintances"
8. "Friends/Colleagues"
9. "Neighbours"
10. "City of Dundas"
11. "web"
12. "web search for service providers"
13. "Internet"
14. "Asking friends for suggestions or referrals"
15. "The Interwebs"
16. "family members"

17. "Family/friends"
18. "Google"
19. "Northfield Hospital Social Services Dept."
20. "a family member"
21. "Internet"
22. "personal network"
23. "internet"
24. "I wouldn't know so I'd ask friends for ideas"
25. "referrals from friends"
26. "My fellow colleagues for health care as we trade services"
27. "Google"
28. "google"
29. "Friend recommendation-word of mouth"
30. "my dtr's"
31. "Since there is no other place to add comment, the BEST thing you can do for seniors is to SHOVEL downtown sidewalks!! And keep the streets plowed along the curbs; most seniors are terrified of falls and stay home in the winter. We need to be safe getting OUT of our homes for errands, meeting friends, and going to appointments. More consistency on snow removal in shopping areas is needed."
32. "Google"
33. "Internet"
34. "Friend"
35. "Friends and family"
36. "Chose more than three: (1) your healthcare professional (2) Social Media (3) online resources"
37. "Friends"
38. "Friends"
39. "Google"
40. "Chose more than three: FiftyNorth, Your Healthcare professional, calling Rice County, Senior LinkAge Line, Social Media"
41. "Web search (Google, DuckDuckGo)"
42. "Three Links"
43. "Website: neighborhood"
44. "Internet search"
45. "Chamber of Commerce"
46. "Internet"
47. "Calling Dakota County (I am a Northfield resident but my home is in Dakota County)"
48. "Rice County Area on Aging"
49. "Other selected - Senior LinkAge Line and Your healthcare professional; FiftyNorth-Community Resource Website - I am not a member and did not think bout their Resource Website for these services"
50. "CAC or Three Rivers Community Action"
51. "private care givers that I know"
52. "friends and family"
53. "NRC"
54. "also chose... Your faith community, FiftyNorth, the library, social media"
55. "also chose... your faith community, FiftyNorth, KYMN, your healthcare professional, calling rice county, Senior LinkAge Line, social media"
56. "Also chose... KYMN and your healthcare professional"
57. "Also chose... your faith community, your healthcare professional"
58. "Also chose... calling Rice County, Senior LinkAge Line"
59. "friends"
60. "also chose... Local cable TV and Your healthcare professional"
61. "friends, family"
62. "Also selected... The City of Nfld, FiftyNorth, Your faith community, social media, Your healthcare professional, the library"
63. "Also chose... Your faith community, calling Rice County, social media, Your healthcare professional"

64. “wife and other family members”

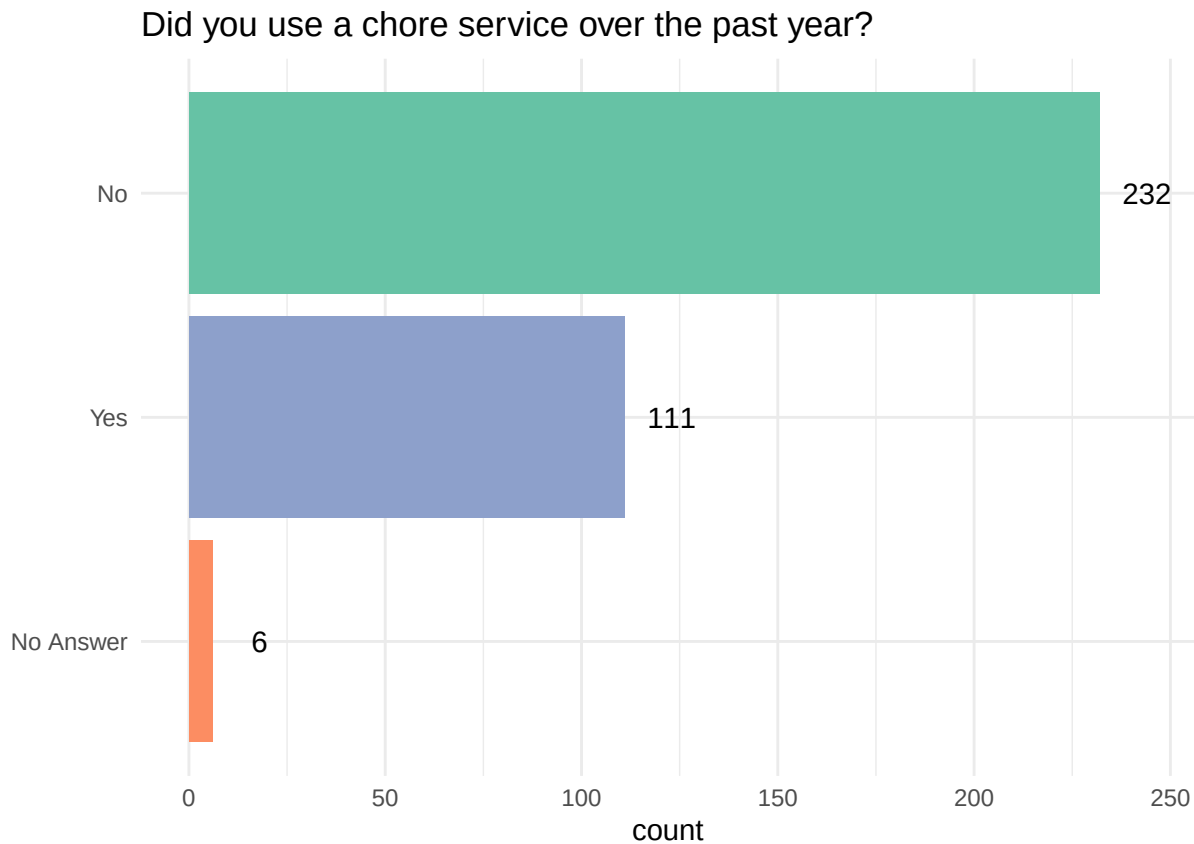
5. Service Category Breakdown

This section provides plots and analysis for each question from the survey.

Chore Services

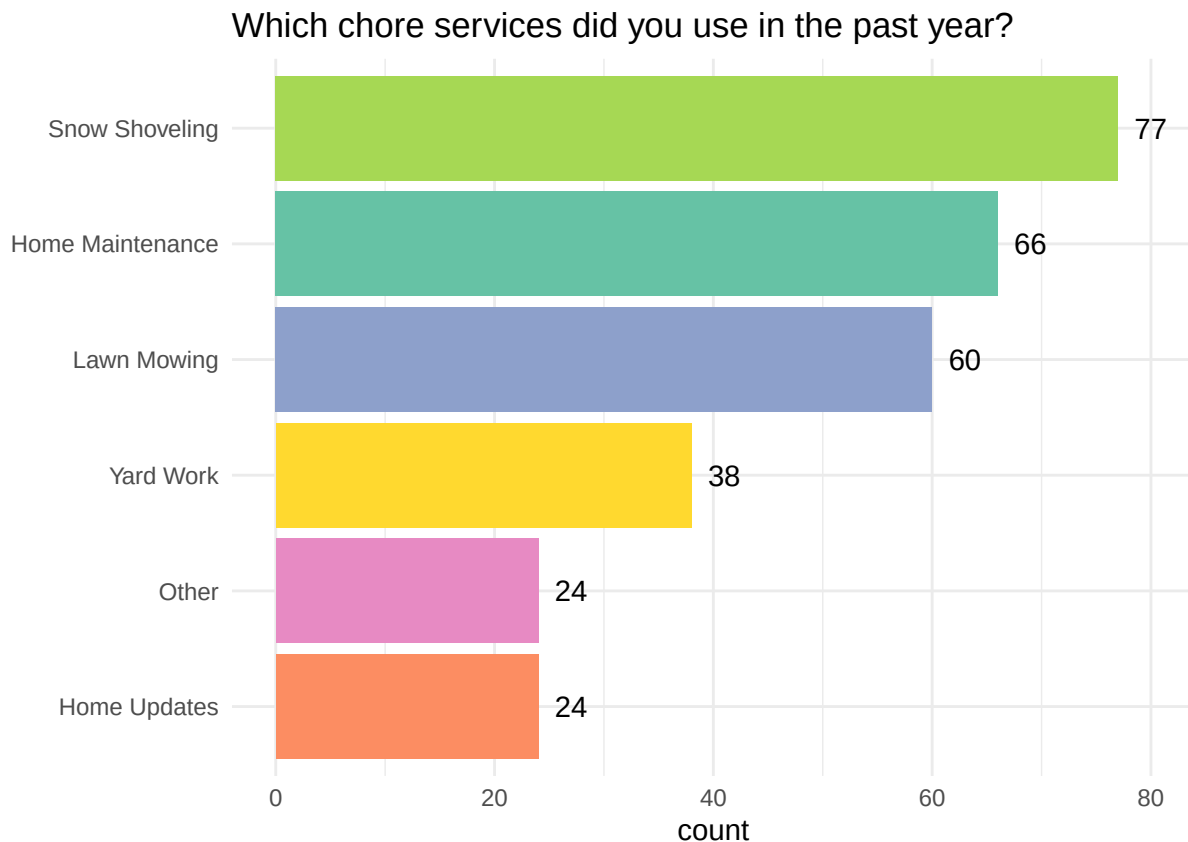
Q1. Did you use a chore service over the past year?

As shown in the barplot below, out of the 343 people who answered this question, 111 people used this service, and 232 people did not use this service.



Q2. Which chore services did you use in the past year? (please check all that apply)

This question was shown to everyone who answered “Yes” to the previous question, and allowed for multiple answers. Out of the 110 people who answered this question, 77 of them used it for snow shoveling, 66 for home maintenance, 60 for lawn mowing, 38 for yard work, 24 for home updates, and 24 for other purposes. Out of the 23 written responses, 10 of them referred to house cleaning and 4 of them referred to handyman projects. This question was shown to everyone who answered “Yes” to the previous question, and allowed for multiple answers.



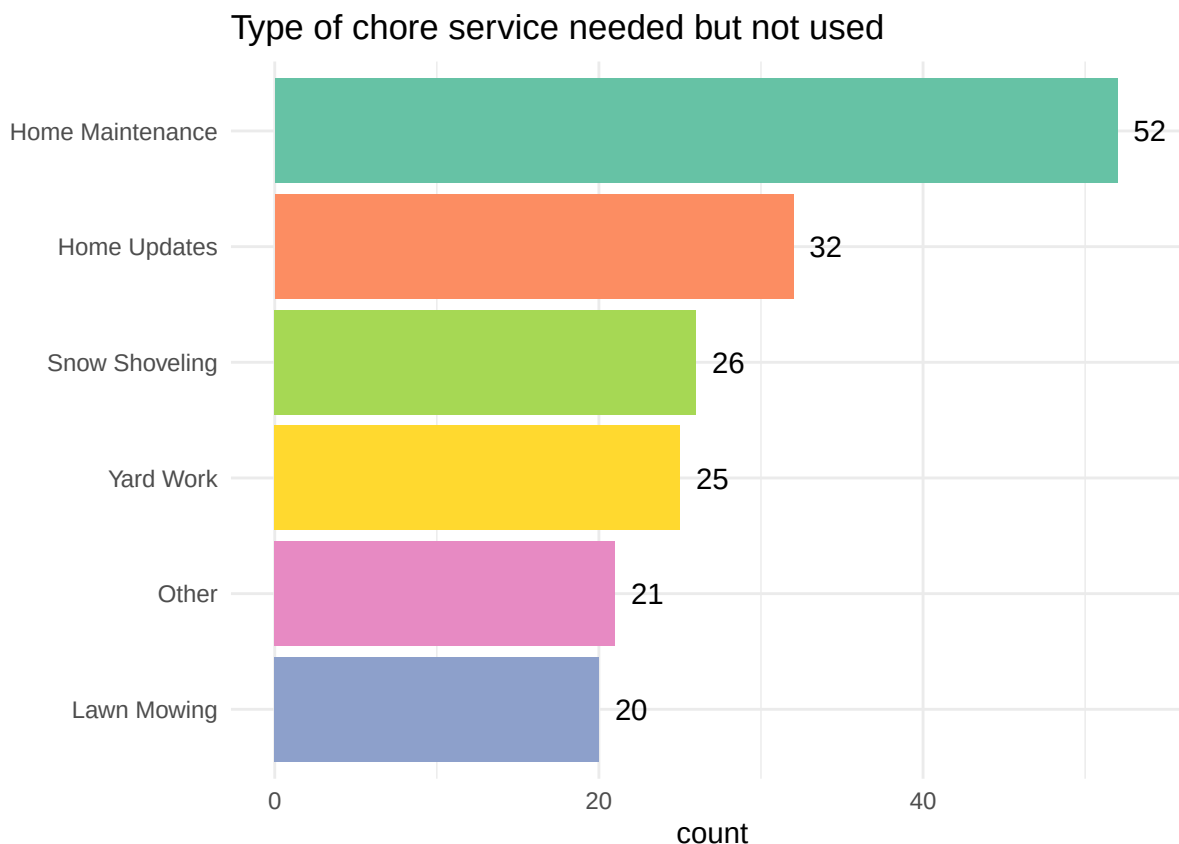
Text Responses

1. “House Cleaning”
2. “Cleaning, laundry, grocery shopping”
3. “cleaning”
4. “fall leaves raked & removed”
5. “Packing boxes to donate”
6. “Putting up shelves, fixing doors”
7. “small handyman projects”
8. “house cleaning”
9. “adding under counter lights, tuning lawn mower, fixing caulk, mouseproofing, switching out light fixture, installing wireless router”
10. “House cleaning”
11. “Lawn fertilizing,kitchen remodel”
12. “Housecleaning a couple of times”
13. “carpet cleaning; furniture moving”
14. “Lawn weed control and fertilizer”
15. “Cleaning our apartment”
16. “Dog clean-up”
17. “housekeeping”

18. "cleaning"
19. "House cleaning"
20. "vacuuming, scrubbing bathrroms"
21. "house cleaning"
22. "Help with technology (phone, internet, tv); Tree trimming; Carrying heavy items (water softener salt, cat litter, items to go to landfill)"
23. "Replacing entry doors, storm doors, gutters, siding, roof repair."

Q3. Which chore services did you need, but not use? (please check all that apply)

Everyone was shown this question, and allowed for multiple answers. Out of the 316 people who answered this question, 95 of them needed a chore service but did not use one, while 223 had no unmet needs. Out of the 95 people who needed a chore service but did not use one, 52 of them needed chore services for home maintenance, 32 for shopping for home updates, 26 for snow shoveling, 25 for yard work, 21 for other purposes and 20 for lawn mowing. Out of the 20 written responses, 4 of them referred to moving objects, 3 of them referred to house cleaning, and 2 to technology assistance. Everyone was shown this question, and allowed for multiple answers.



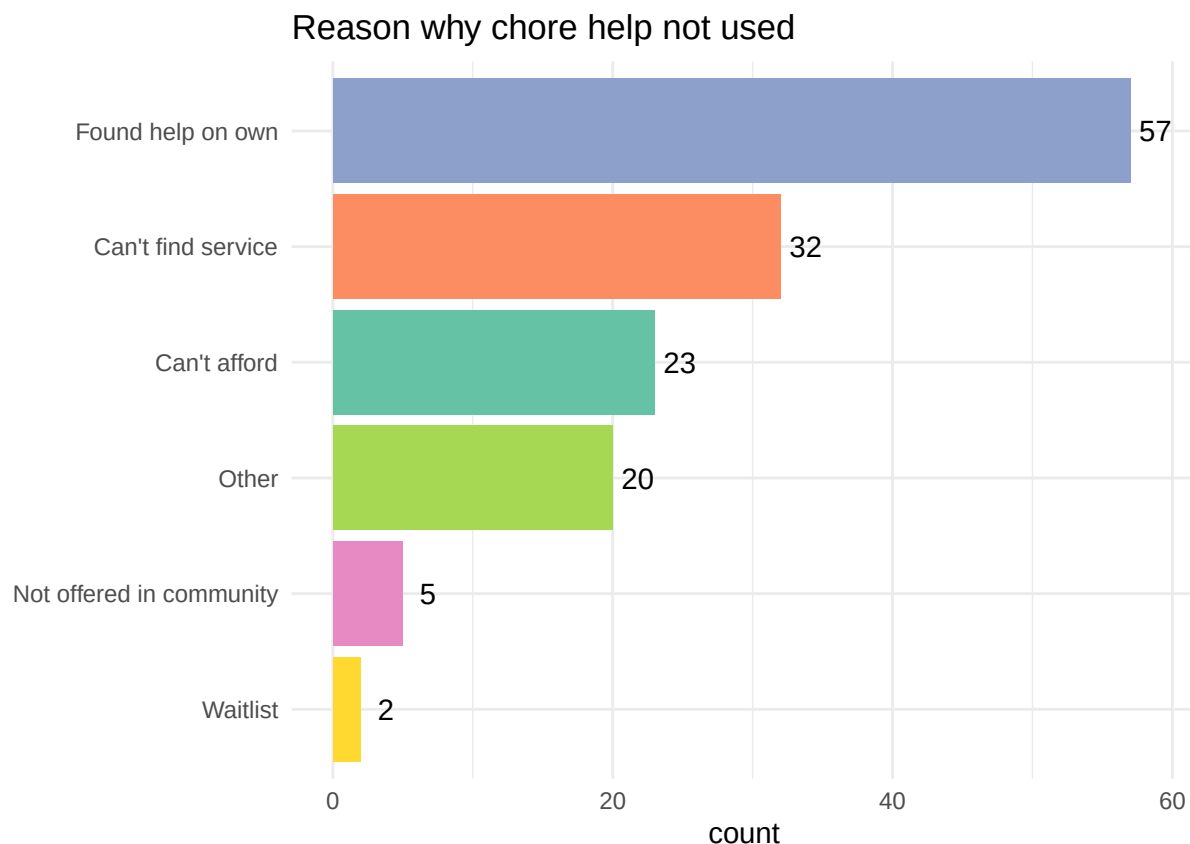
Text Responses

1. "Our HOA provides some of these, but not all."
2. "Basic computer"
3. "weekly house cleaning"
4. "moving rocks"
5. "All supplied at VOC"
6. "clothes repair"
7. "painting, assembling furniture"
8. "my HOA takes care of most of the chores listed"
9. "occasional cleaning of high items/places"
10. "housecleaning"
11. "Did NOT NEED chore service"
12. "housecleaning"
13. "needed someone to move boxes to storage"
14. "Window fix"
15. "lifting and moving things around"
16. "Technology assistance (computer, internet, TV)"

17. “holiday decorations, moving furniture”
18. “roofing”
19. “Walking dogs”
20. “Window washing”

Q4. If you needed help with a chore service over the past year but did not use one, what was the reason? (please check all that apply)

This question was shown to everyone who did not check “I did not have an unmet chore service need”, and allowed for multiple answers. Out of the 103 people who answered this question, 57 found help on their own, 32 of them didn’t know how to find the service, 23 couldn’t afford it, 20 had other reasons, 5 did not use it because the service was not offered, and 2 were on a waitlist. Out of the 20 written responses, 6 of them referred to workers being busy / help not being immediately available. This question was shown to everyone who did not check “I did not have an unmet need” in the previous question, and allowed for multiple answers.



Text Responses

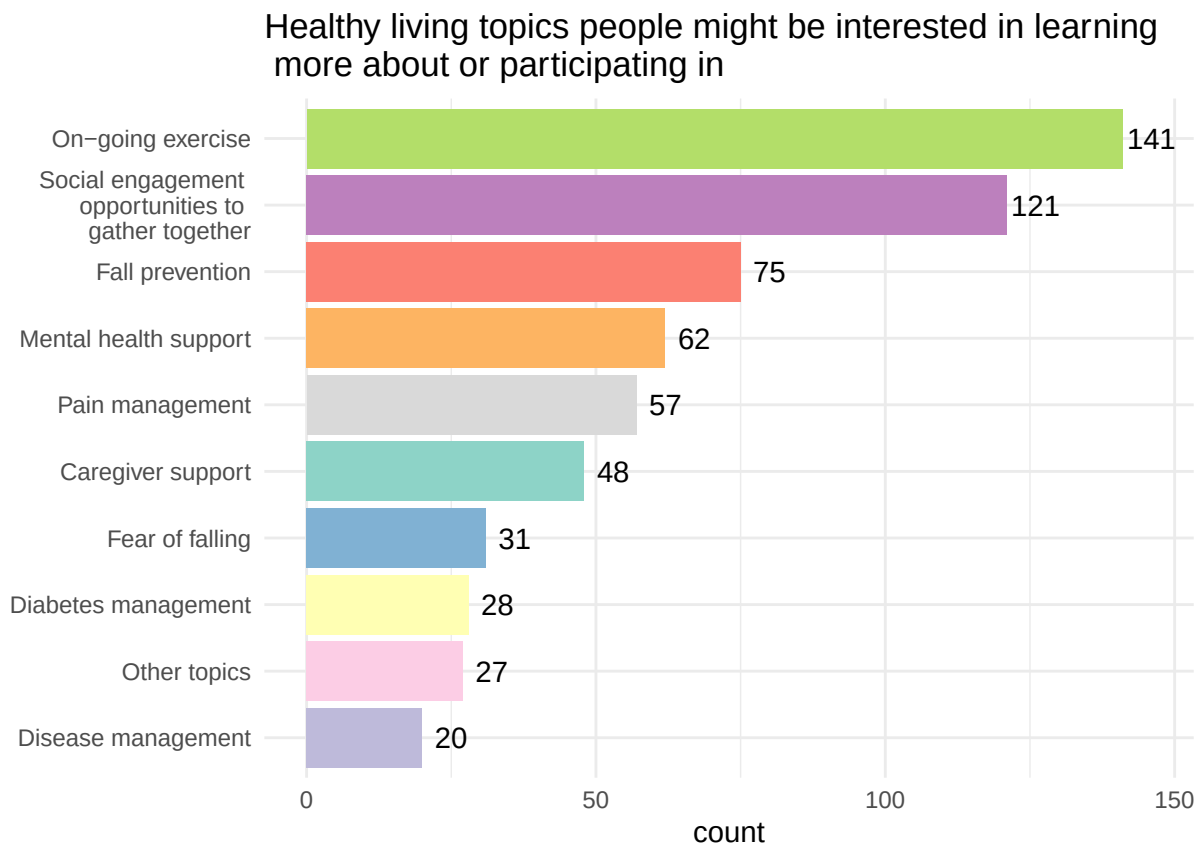
1. “it would make my husband feel bad”
2. “Not convenient–help not available immediately when i needed it.”
3. “Never heard of this before!”
4. “Hoped we would be able to manage on our own”
5. “Able to do it myself”
6. “Mollie Skaar is deceased. 08/13/2021”
7. “I had called someone to come and clean the windows, and he said he would, but he never showed up.”
8. “Not enough people doing this work -all booked up”
9. “I knew the city council would ignore me as they have in the past”
10. “Time management with working full time at my Acupuncture practice.”
11. “Live in townhome which services were included in association fees”
12. “Handi people are very busy and don’t like to come for just a small job”
13. “My HOA provides most of the service needs listed”
14. “Did NOT need ine”
15. “Not enough providers of this service”
16. “I am able to do myself so far AND did not know about chore service.”

17. "Shortage of people to do the chores"
18. "I do it myself"
19. "Gossipers"
20. "Not a high enough priority"

Healthy Living Programs

Q5. Please check the box next to any of the healthy living topics you would be interested in learning more about or participating in.

Out of the 244 people who answered this question, here are the number of people who indicated each topic they were interested in: 141 people indicated on-going exercise, 121 for social engagement opportunities to gather together, 75 for fall prevention, 62 for mental health support, 57 for pain management, 48 for caregiver support, 31 for fear of falling, 28 for diabetes management, 27 for other topics, 20 for disease management. Among 27 text answers, 4 of them mention transportation and 11 answers mention mental or physical health topics.



Text Responses

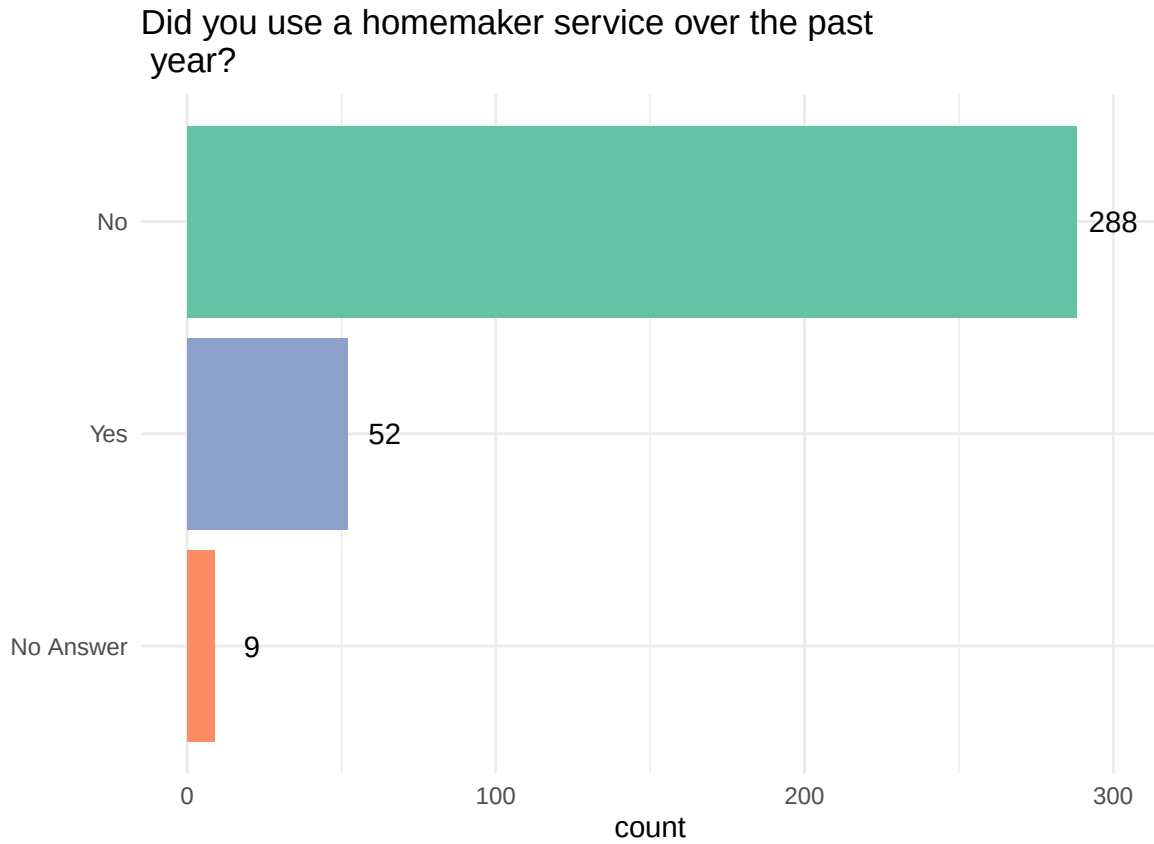
1. "Classes for special interests"
2. "volunteer opportunities"
3. "organized physical activities, such as biking, hiking, pickle ball and trainer availability"
4. "nothing at this time"
5. "caregiver network - this seems to be all word of mouth now but could use better ways to match caremongers & clients"
6. "Christmas lights tour in December, archery, gun safety, shooting range, mounted archery, scavenger hunt by car, sleigh rides down trails in winter"
7. "Stroke recovery"
8. "Mental support, for adult child"
9. "strength training for women"
10. "After COVID"
11. "Different health care options in the city (both traditional and alternative)"
12. "preparing home for ageing"

13. "55Alive - safe driving"
14. "Outdoor exercise groups"
15. "changing relationships with adult children, grandparenting"
16. "Financial aid"
17. "transportation on weekends"
18. "Public Transportation"
19. "Sleep routines"
20. "Cannon Valley Elder Collegium - I already participate"
21. "Transportation to medical care in the Cities and around Northfield"
22. "Core and bone strengthening exercises"
23. "these are at FiftyNorth"
24. "Home healthcare"
25. "Daily simple exercises"
26. "Transportation to medical appts"
27. "home bound - do not get out without family help"

Homemaker Services

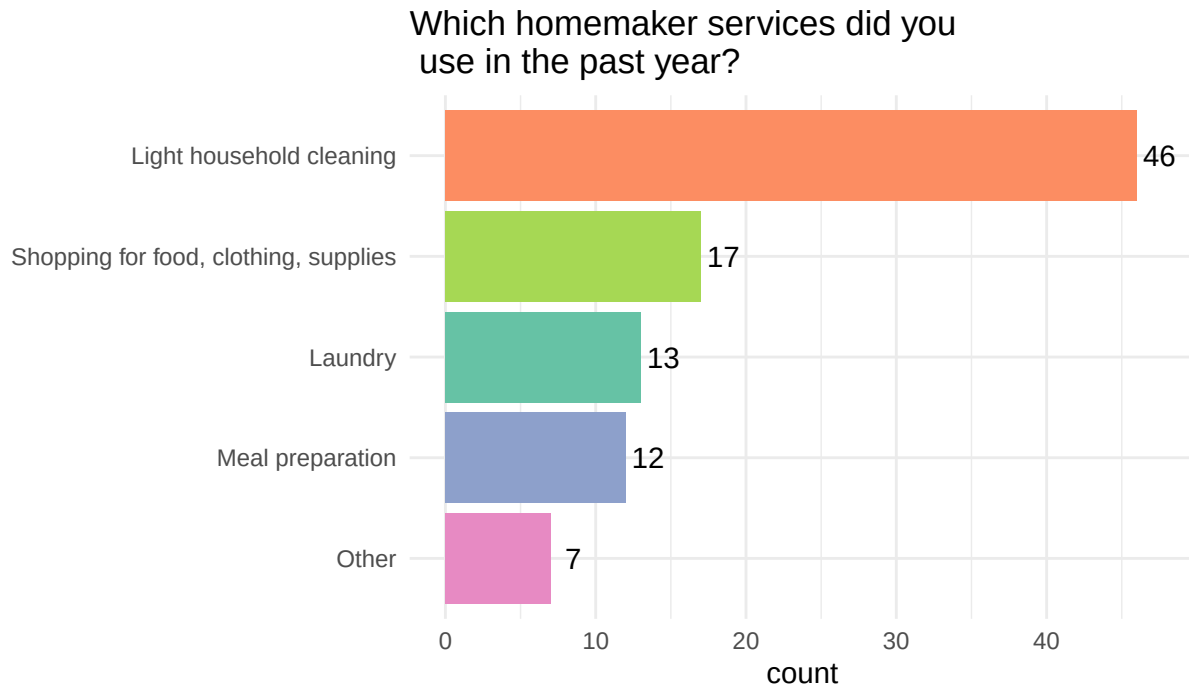
Q6. Did you use a homemaker service over the past year?

As shown in the barplot below, out of the 340 respondents, 52 people used this service, and 288 people did not use this service.



Q7. Which homemaker services did you use in the past year? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 51 respondents who answered this question, 40 of them used it for light household cleaning, 17 for shopping for food, clothing, supplies, 13 for laundry, 12 for meal preparation, and 7 for other purposes. Out of the 7 written responses, 2 of them demand more housing cleaning services such as deep house cleaning, window washing, and etc. This question was shown to everyone who answered “Yes” to the previous question, and allowed for multiple answers.

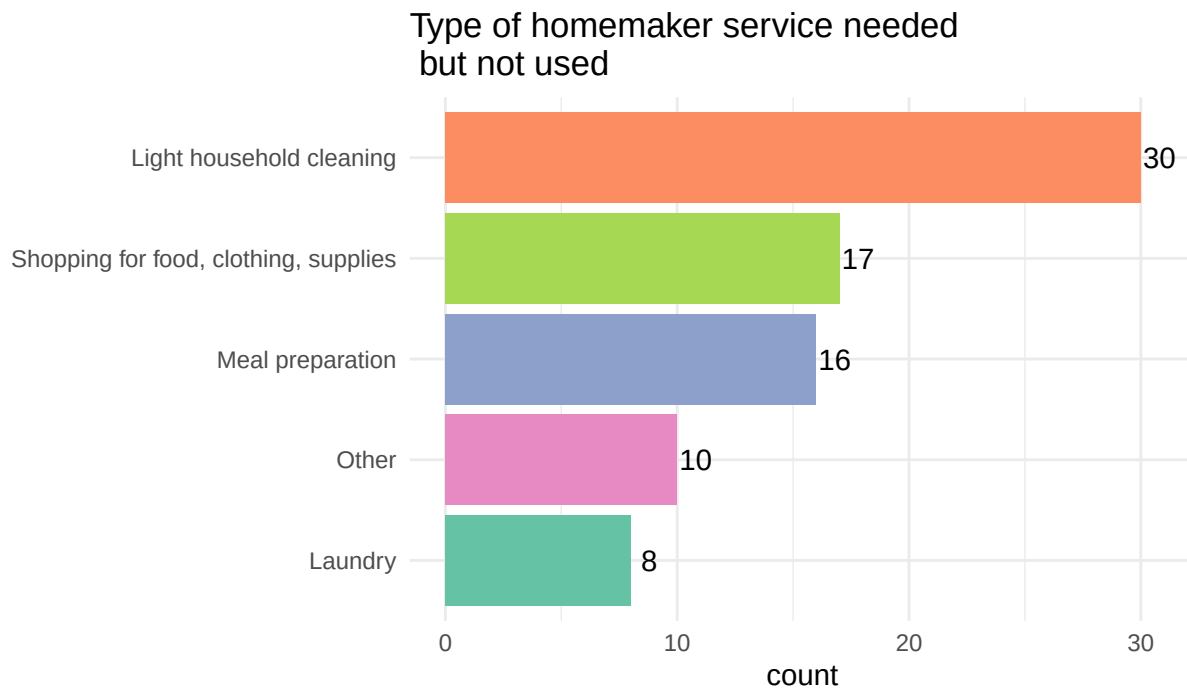


Text Responses

1. “Deep clean house cleaning”
2. “My wife provides home making services. She is quite inexpensive and does a decent job ;)”
3. “MOW 7x.wk and my adult kids do the rest”
4. “I inadvertently mentioned the housecleaning in the "Chore" section.”
5. “Showering, Personal”
6. “Because of covid we had groceries delivered”
7. “Misc chores - window washing, etc.”

Q8. Which Homemaker services did you need, but not use? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 307 respondents who answered this question, 56 of them needed a homemaker service but did not use one, while 253 had no unmet needs. Out of the 56 respondents who needed a homemaker service but did not use one, 30 needed homemaker services for light household cleaning, 17 for shopping for food, clothing, supplies, 16 for meal preparation, 10 for other purposes, and 8 for laundry. The 10 written responses are very diverse and specific. Everyone was shown this question, and allowed for multiple answers.

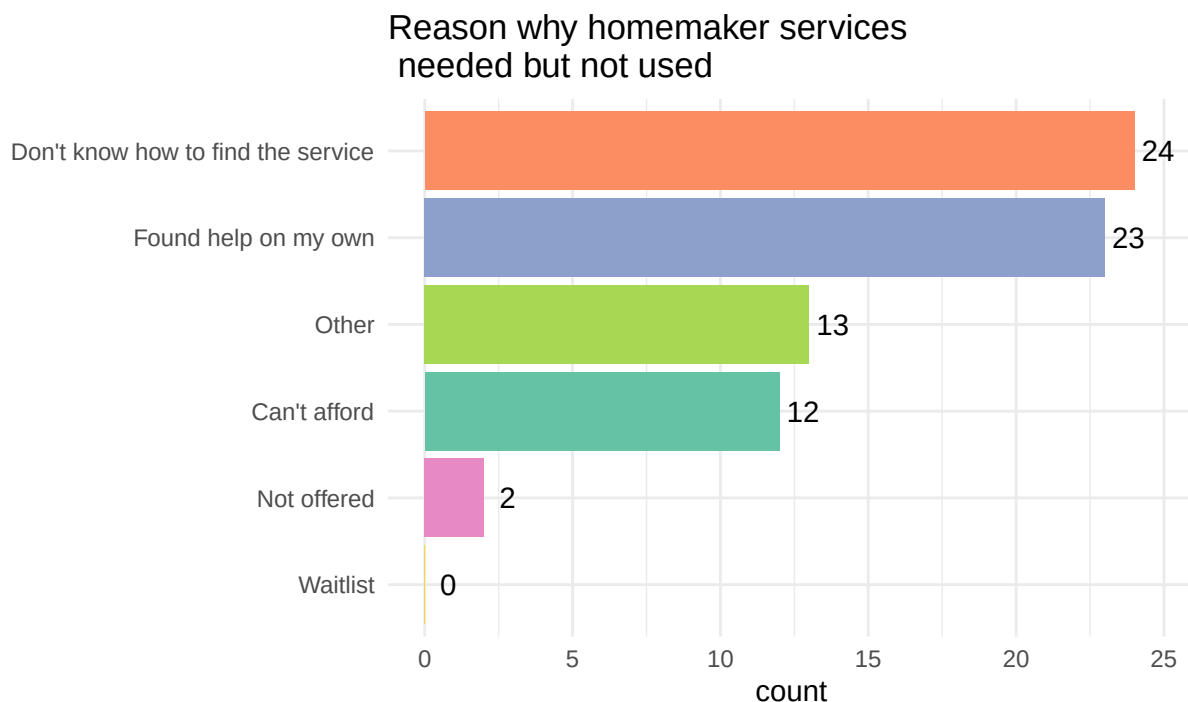


Text Responses

1. "Caregiver help"
2. "whole house cleaning"
3. "Bed changing new linens"
4. "Trash out"
5. "shoveling snow from the sidewalk that is not needed"
6. "adult children"
7. "None needed"
8. "see next ?/answer"
9. "Heavy-duty cleaning (moving furniture, toilet and sink scrubbing, etc.)"
10. "cleaning cupboards and kitchen"

Q9. If you needed help with a homemaker service over the past year but did not use one, what was the reason? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 63 respondents who answered this question, 24 of them didn't know how to find the service, 23 found help on their own, 13 had other reasons, 12 couldn't afford it, 2 did not use it because the service was not offered. Out of the 13 written responses, 4 of them are about being unable to find the service needed, 2 are about financial concern, 2 about not having time to find services, and 2 about not knowing that the services exist. This question was shown to everyone who did not check "I did not have an unmet need" in the previous question, and allowed for multiple answers.



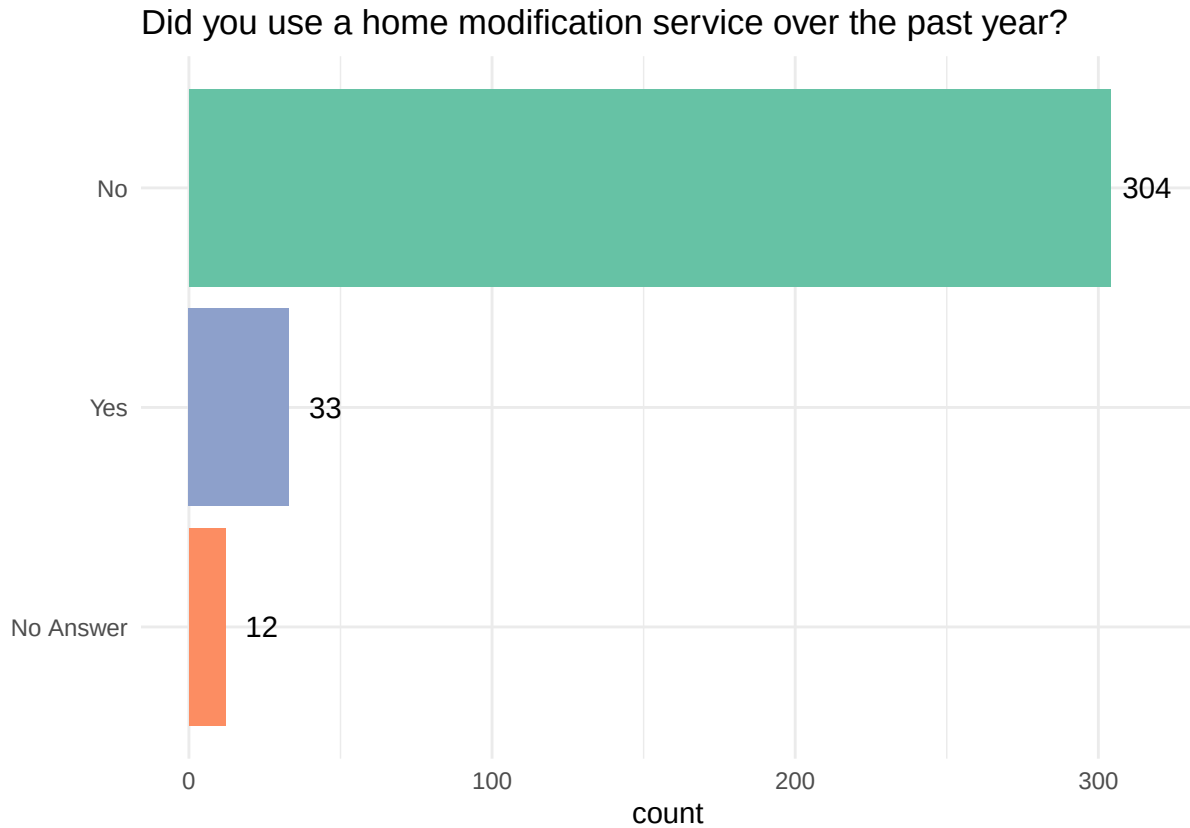
Text Responses

1. "I hired services before the pandemic. The cleaner stopped due to the pandemic and I have not looked for help thus far."
2. "I knew the city would ignore me"
3. "no one was coming over to notice"
4. "I tried homemaking and companionship thru Aging Svcs in Montgomery but it was too time consuming for my dtr to direct their work"
5. "people don't do it in town"
6. "Did NOT need"
7. "Asking for affordable helpers"
8. "insufficient time to hunt it down; people I contacted were too busy to take me on"
9. "I am able to do for myself so far, but did not know it is available."
10. "I haven't been able to find services."
11. "Covid - short-staffed at Manor"
12. "I can do some myself"
13. "Meal on Wheels (for lunch)"

Home Modification Services

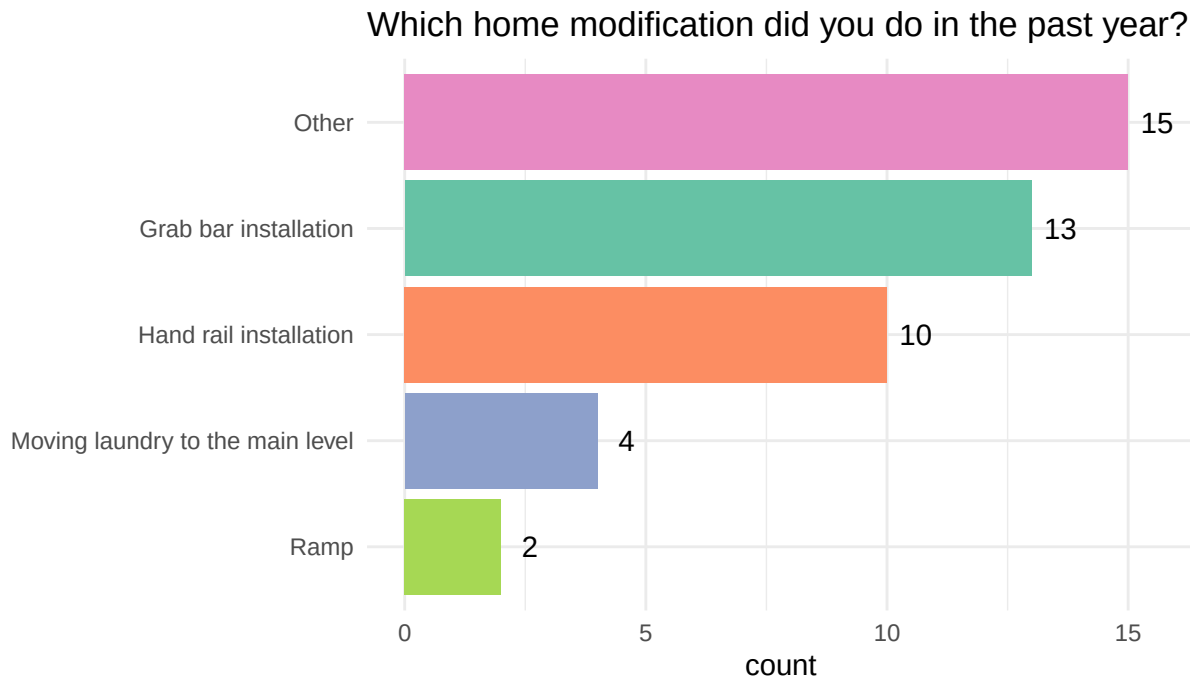
Q10. In the past year have you used a service to make modifications to your home?

As shown in the barplot below, out of the 337 respondents, 33 people used this service, and 304 people did not use this service.



Q11. Which home modifications did you have completed in the past year? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 32 respondents who answered this question, 15 of them used it for other reasons, 13 for grab bar installation, 10 for hand rail installation, 4 for moving laundry to the main level, and 2 for ramps. Out of the 15 written responses, 2 of them are about kitchen remodel, 2 about lighting, and the others are diverse and specific. This question was shown to everyone who answered “Yes” to the previous question, and allowed for multiple answers.

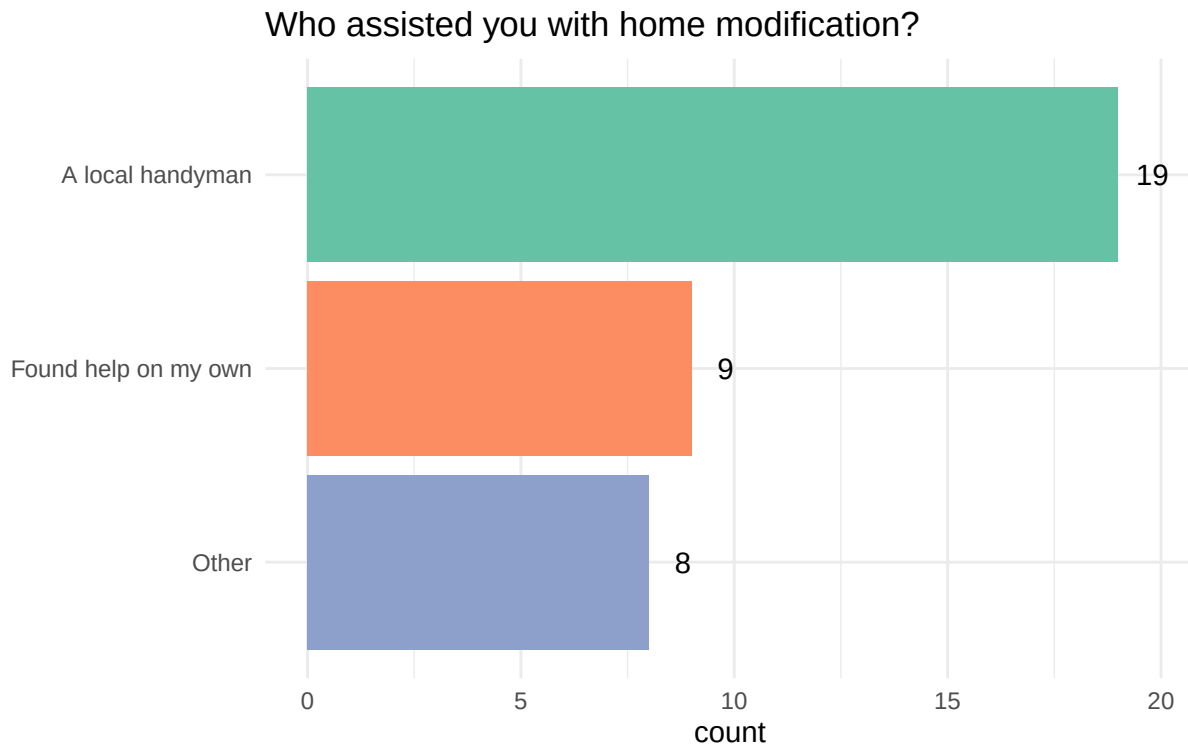


Text Responses

1. "Raising concrete to make sidewalk/home entry safer."
2. "improving lighting"
3. "Chair thingy for the steps"
4. "Siding repair"
5. "adding better lighting"
6. "height adjusted toilet"
7. "planning an accessible addition"
8. "added 1st floor bathroom"
9. "Many! adaptations provided by Occupational Therapist wife"
10. "dtr s put grab bars on tub"
11. "Attach garage - no step entry"
12. "bathroom modification"
13. "Kitchen Remodel"
14. "Renew kitchen"
15. "techo (ceiling)"

Q12. Who assisted you with making the home modification? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 33 respondents who used this services over the past year, 19 of them had a local handyman to assist them, 9 found help on their own, and 8 had other assistance. Out of the 8 written responses, 4 of them mention local contractors. This question was shown to everyone who answered “Yes” to question 10, and allowed for multiple answers.

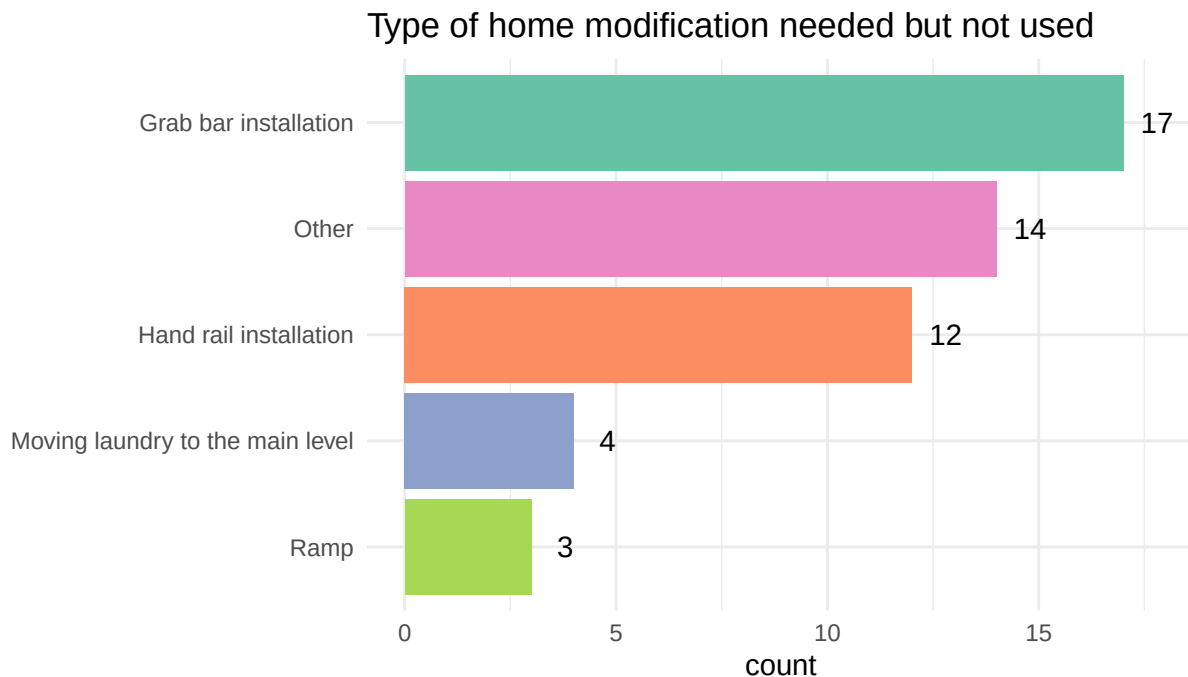


Text Responses

1. "Part of remodeling with contractor"
2. "We hired a chair lift professional"
3. "local contractor"
4. "My wife and home visiting P.T."
5. "Did it myself"
6. "Local contractors"
7. "Construction Business in town"
8. "nadien (?)"

Q13. Which home modifications did you need, but not use? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 298 respondents who answered this question, 39 of them needed a home modification service but did not use one, while 260 had no unmet needs. Out of the 39 respondents who needed a home modification service but did not use one, 17 of them needed home modification services for grab bar installation, 14 for other purposes, 12 for hand rail installation, 4 for moving laundry to the main level, and 3 for a ramp. The 14 written responses are very diverse and specific. Everyone was shown this question, and allowed for multiple answers.

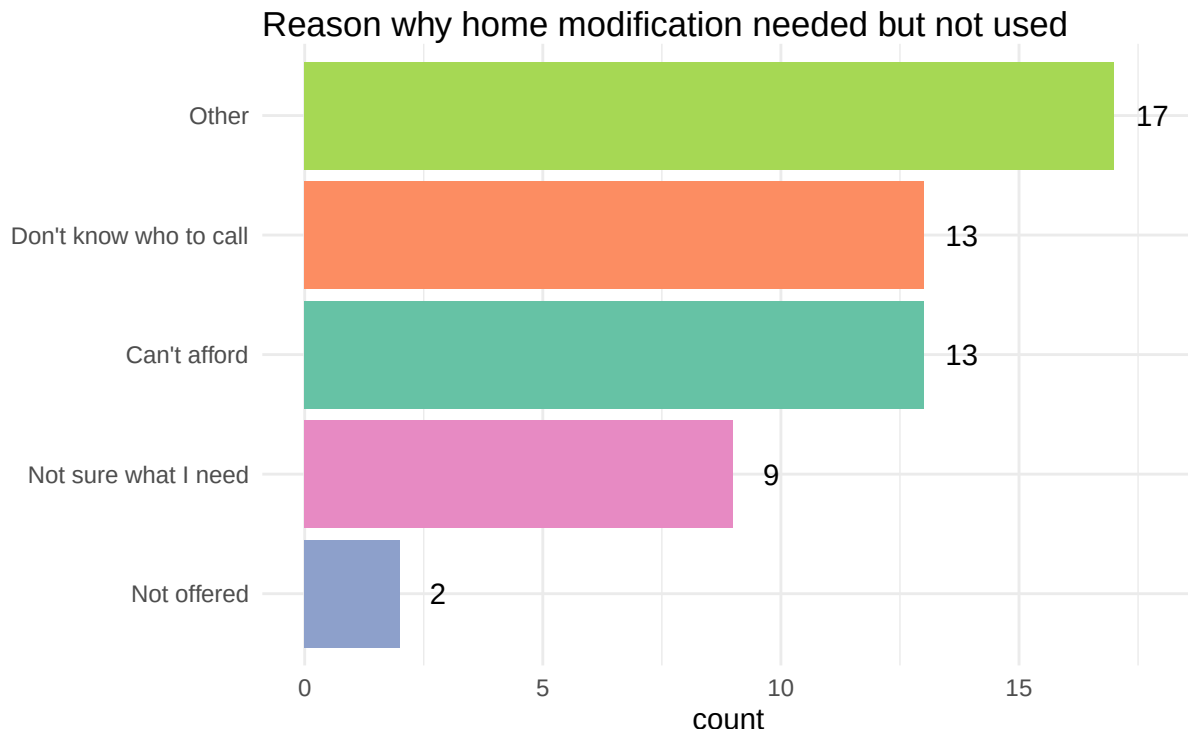


Text Responses

1. "Widening doorway doorway to accommodate walker"
2. "doorway widening"
3. "Installing pull out shelves in pantry closet"
4. "adding zero entry shower"
5. "fire alarm for deaf person"
6. "remov the sidewalk that I have to shovel"
7. "painting, home repairs"
8. "replace two toilets that are too low and fix a pocket door"
9. "None"
10. "kitchen modifications to accommodate limited mobility"
11. "Chair lift to laundry basement"
12. "needed handyman to put up bathroom cupboard, towel rack, self in closet, heavy mirror w/shelf"
13. "light bulbs inside and outside"
14. "lo hizo mi esposo (my husband did it)"

Q14. If you needed help with a home modification over the past year but did not use one, what was the reason? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 40 respondents who answered this question, 17 of them had other reasons, 13 didn't know who to call, 13 couldn't afford it, 9 were not sure what they needed, 2 did not use it because the service was not offered. Out of the 17 written responses, 3 of them are about haven't gotten to it yet, 3 about the service not coming, and 2 about covid concerns. This question was shown to everyone who did not check "I did not have an unmet need" in the previous question, and allowed for multiple answers.



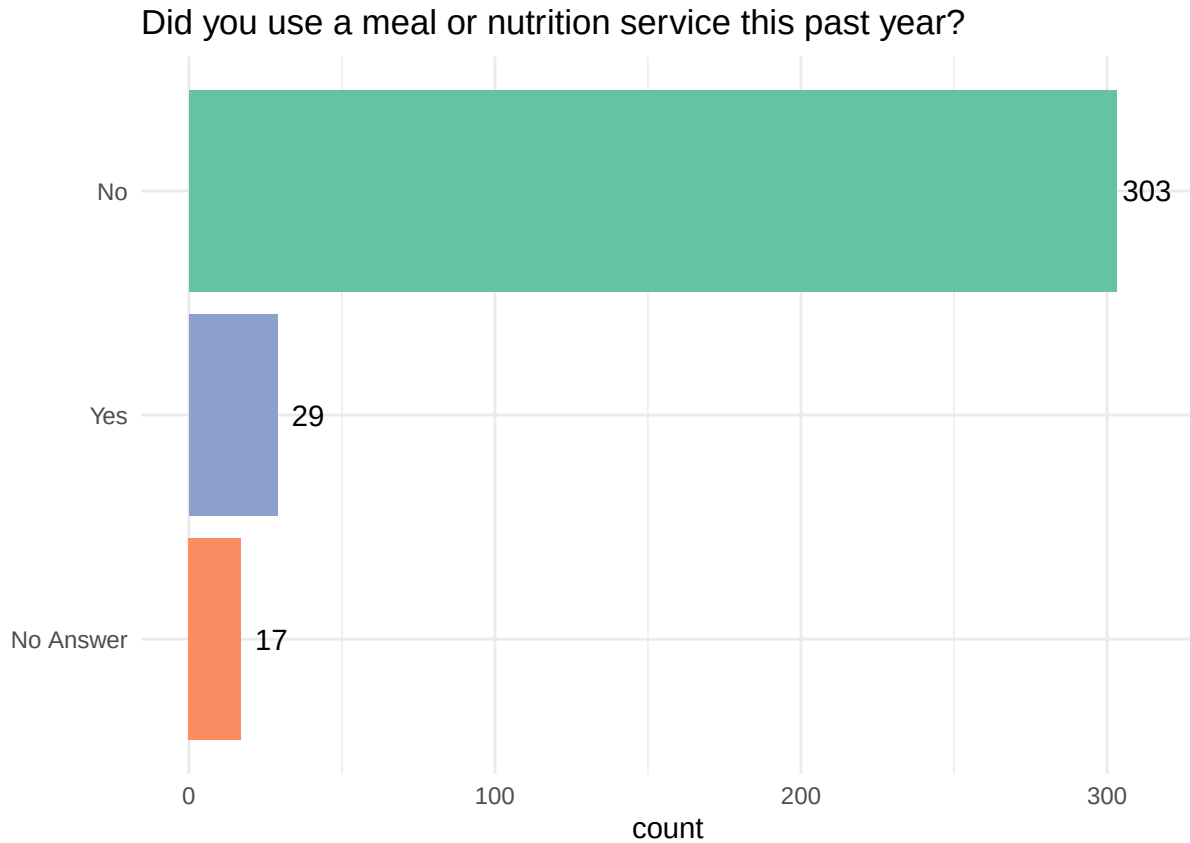
Text Responses

1. "Didn't get around to it."
2. "Did not want workers in home because of COVID concerns"
3. "it would make my husband feel bad"
4. "We just haven't explored it yet. Not sure if grab bars can be installed in our current shower stall."
5. "Paid others to do"
6. "husband wanted to install himself. Never got done."
7. "carpenter contacted, but the person was too busy to respond"
8. "Family helped"
9. "My husband installed the grab bar."
10. "decided to wait a year"
11. "Called several repair services, but did not hear back"
12. "None needed"
13. "Covid - short-staffed at Manor"
14. "I could use help: a strong line to be put up to clip dogs to in yard (please)"
15. "Did not show up when called"
16. "I live in an apartment"
17. "Lower on priority list"

Nutrition/Meal Services

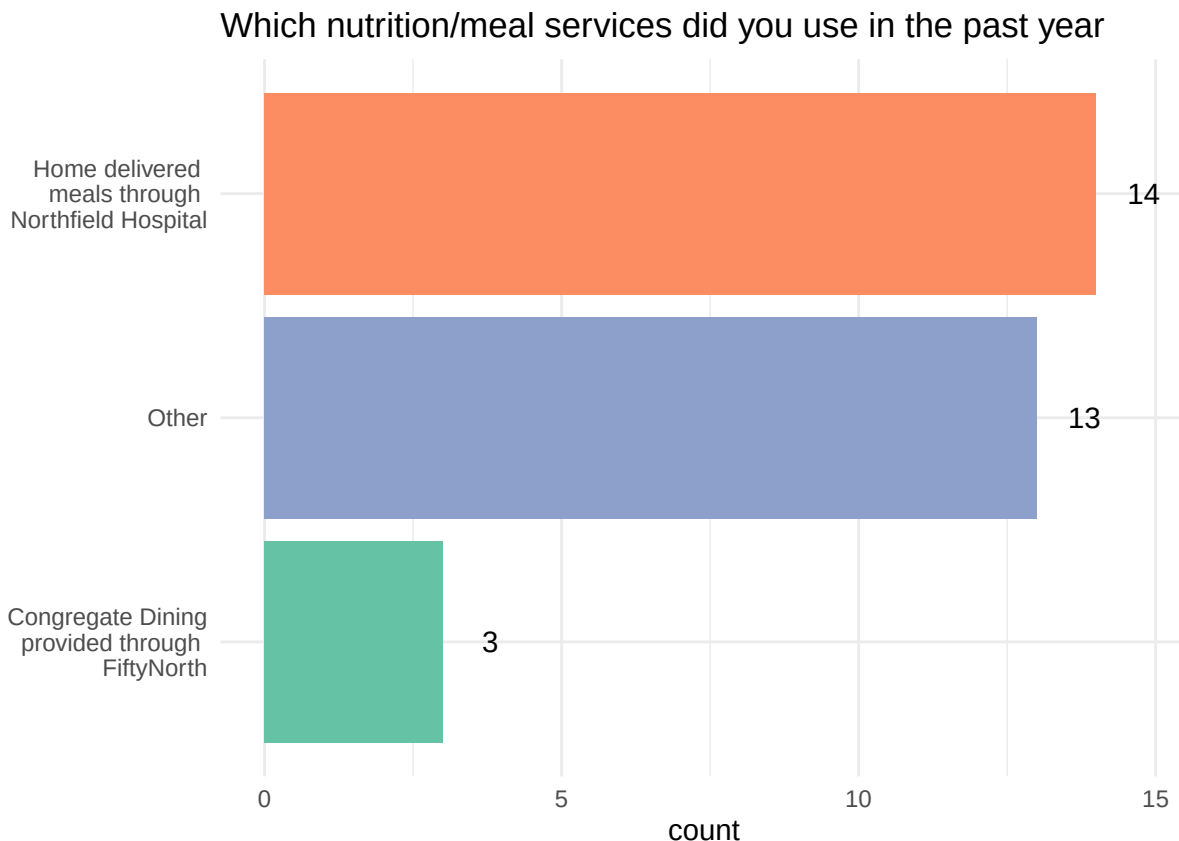
Q15. Did you use a meal or nutrition service over the past year?

As shown in the barplot below, out of the 332 people who answered this question, 29 people used this service, and 303 people did not use this service.



Q16. Which nutrition/meal services did you use in the past year? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 28 people who answered this question, 14 of them used home delivered meals through Northfield Hospital, and 3 of them used Congregate Dining. Out of the 12 written responses, 3 of them used Hello Fresh and 2 of them used Food Shelf. This question was shown to everyone who answered “Yes” to the previous question, and allowed for multiple answers.

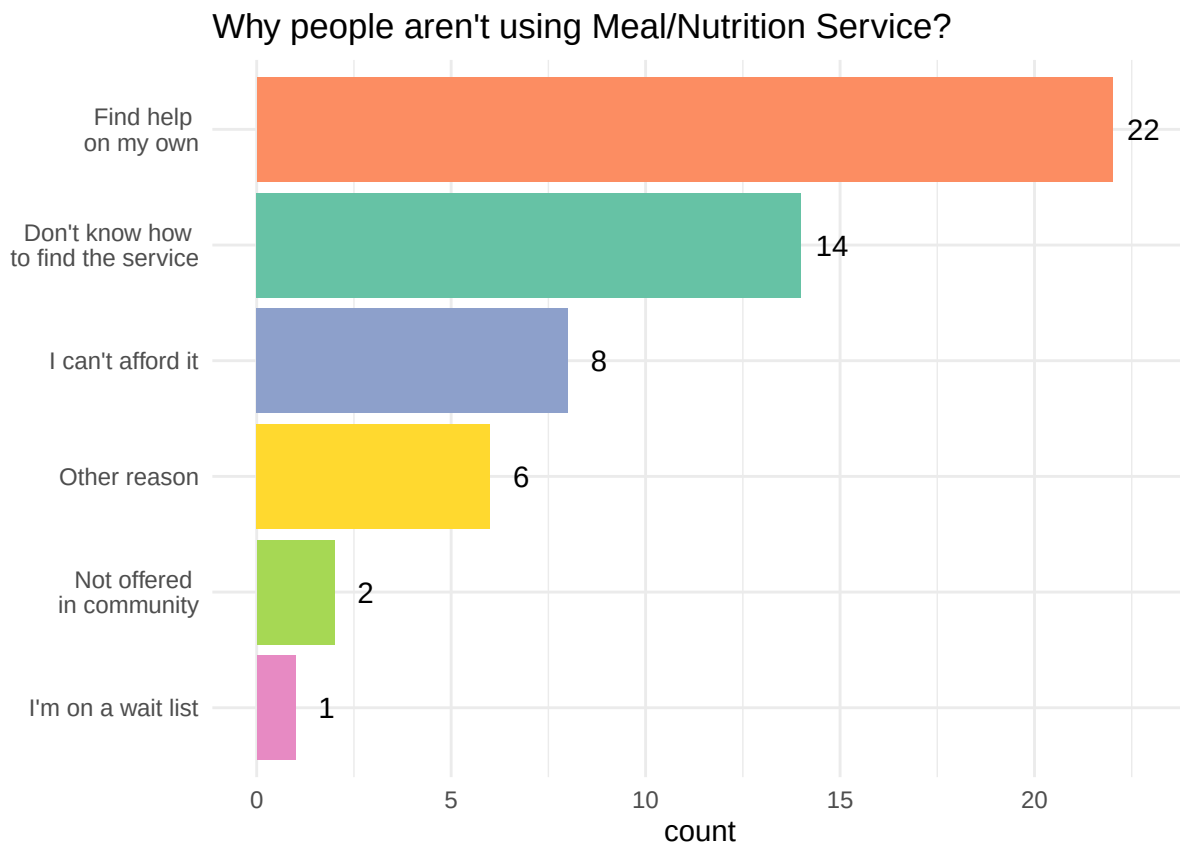


Text Responses

1. “Hello Fresh”
2. “Home delivery service”
3. “Hello Fresh”
4. “food shelf”
5. “Benedictine”
6. “Hello Fresh”
7. “Food shelf (1 x month)”
8. “Grab & Go delivered to my home”
9. “meals order from the Manor or Parkview at Northfield Retirement Center”
10. “Meals on Wheels”
11. “Family provided meals”
12. “Take home meals through FiftyNorth”

Q17. If you needed help with nutrition or meal preparation over the past year but did not use one, what was the reason? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 279 respondents who answered this question, 40 of them needed help with nutrition or meal preparation but did not use this, while 239 had no unmet needs. 22 found help on their own, 14 of them didn't know how to find the service, 8 couldn't afford it, 6 had other reasons, 2 did not use it because the service was not offered, and 1 was on a waitlist. This question was shown to everyone who checked "No" in question 15, and allowed for multiple answers.



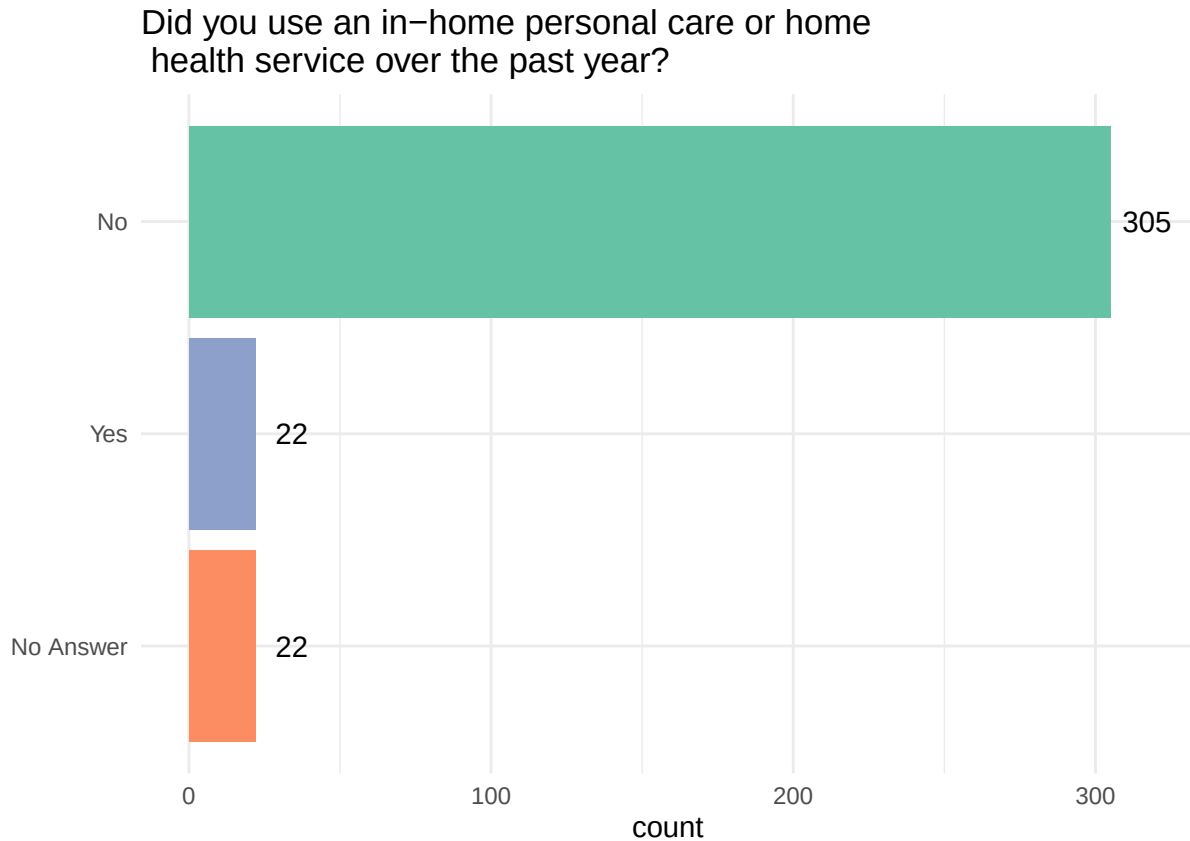
Text Responses

1. "I do the meal preparation myself"
2. "None needed"
3. "Covid"
4. "I deliver MOW still"
5. "covid"
6. "fed by our cook (lives at Valleyview Assisted Living)"

Personal Care and Home Health Services

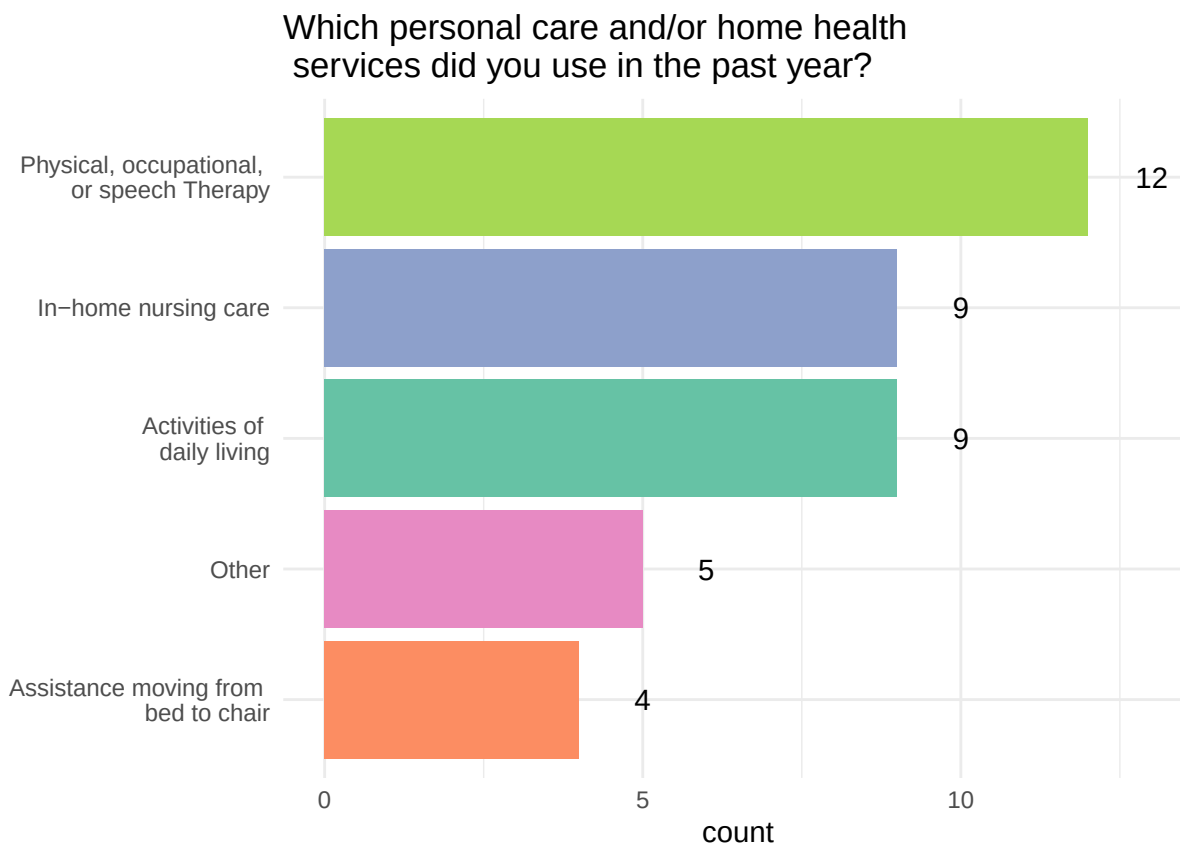
Q18. Did you use an in-home personal care or home health service over the past year?

As shown in the barplot below, out of the 327 people who answered this question, 22 people used this service, and 305 people did not use this service.



Q19. Which personal care and/or home health services did you use in the past year? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 22 people who answered this question, 12 of them used it for physical, occupational, or speech therapy, 9 for in-home nursing care, 9 for activities of daily living, 5 for other purposes, and 4 for assistance moving from a bed to a chair. Out of the 5 written responses, 2 of them referred to injury care. This question was shown to everyone who answered “Yes” to the previous question, and allowed for multiple answers.

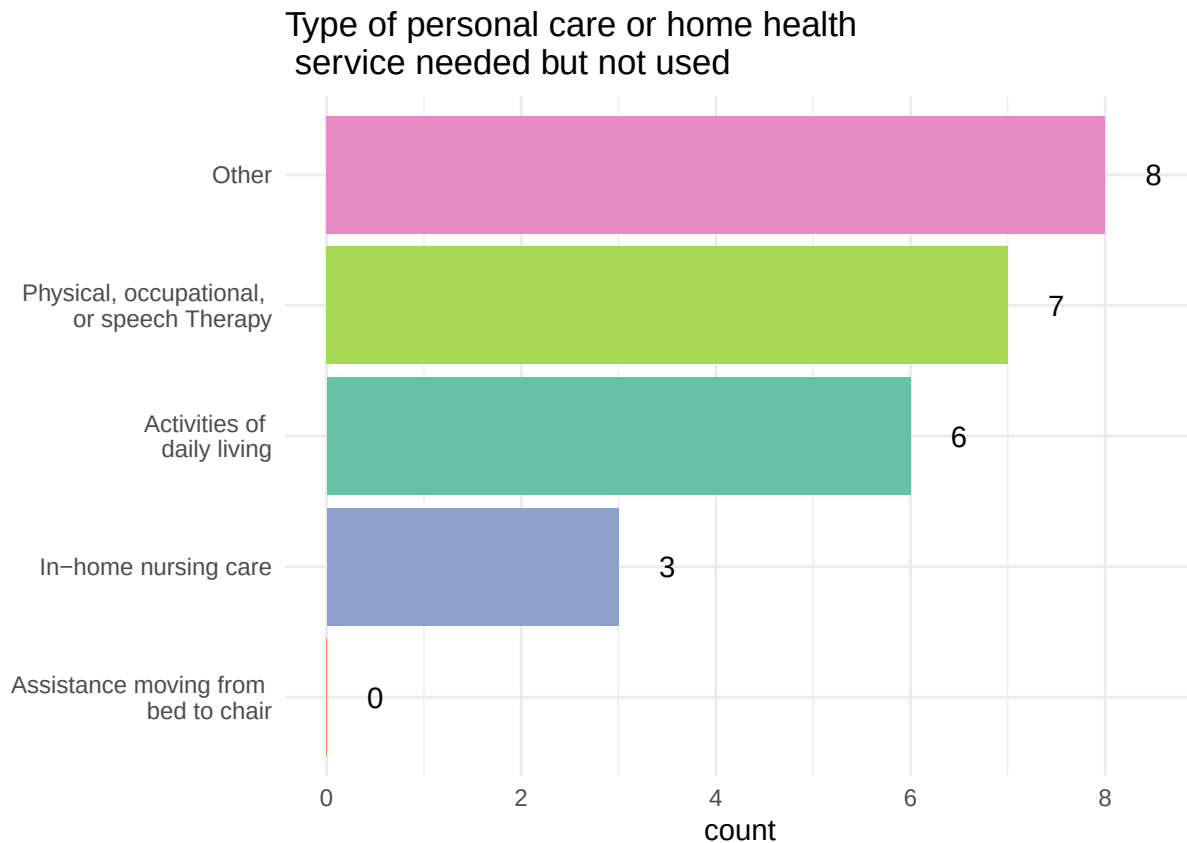


Text Responses

1. “These services were for my 94 year old father for 2 months in our home before he died.”
2. “light duty PCAs - meals, companionship, watching out for elder while family is out”
3. “Wound Care”
4. “Foot care”
5. ” cleaning house”

Q20. Which personal care and/or home health services did you need, but not use? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 293 people who answered this question, 19 of them needed a personal care or home health service but did not use one, and 276 had no unmet needs. Out of the 19 people who needed a personal care or home health service but did not use one, 8 of them needed a personal care or home health service for other reasons, 7 of them needed physical, occupational, or speech therapy, 6 for activities of daily living, and 3 for in-home nursing care. No respondents needed assistance moving from a bed to a chair. Out of the 8 written responses, 2 of them referred to driving to medical appointments in the Twin Cities. Everyone was shown this question, and allowed for multiple answers.

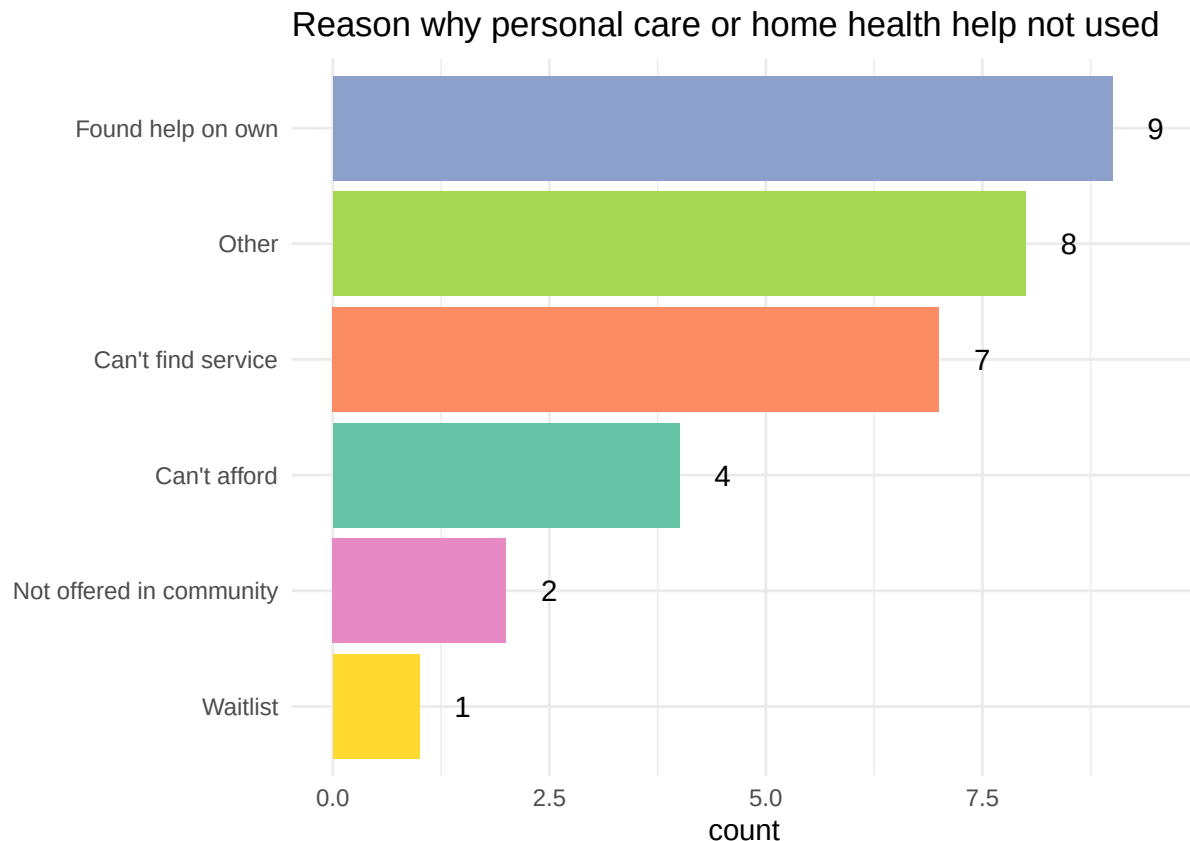


Text Responses

1. "driver to medical appt in Twin Cities"
2. "Day care for spouse with dementia so caregiver can take a break."
3. "None needed"
4. "How about toe nail cutting clinic once a week at FiftyNorth – sign up one week ahead (\$10 - \$15)"
5. "Rehab Clinic"
6. "After surgeries no one available to clean blood off and dressing"
7. "Help getting to medical appointments in the Twin Cities"
8. "could not find"

Q21. If you needed help with a personal care or home health service over the past year but did not use one, what was the reason? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 24 people who answered this question, 9 found help on their own, 8 had other reasons, 7 of them didn't know how to find the service, 4 couldn't afford it, 2 did not use it because the service was not offered, and 1 was on a waitlist. Out of the 8 written responses, 2 of them were related to the pandemic. This question was shown to everyone who did not check "I did not have an unmet need" in the previous question, and allowed for multiple answers.



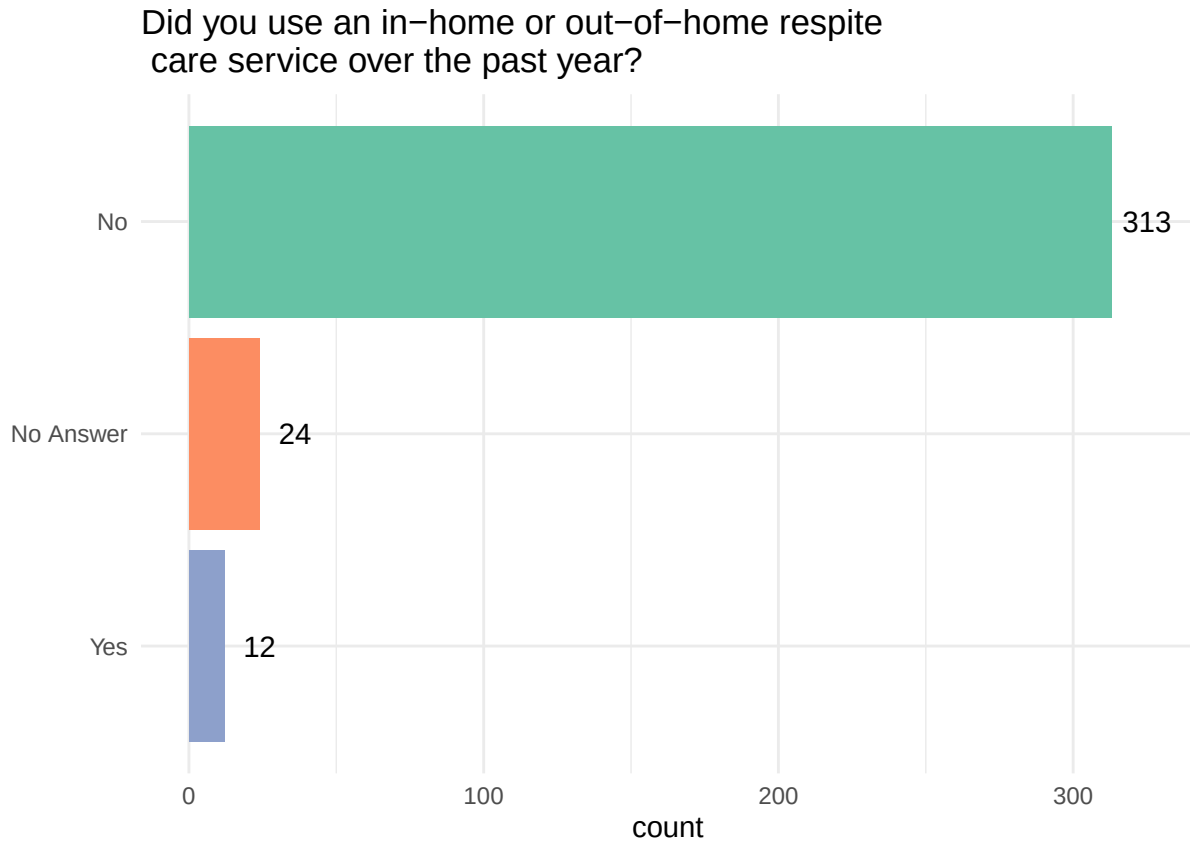
Text Responses

1. "I want care in 8 hour blocks so I can be free for the day."
2. "Not covered by Medicare or long term care"
3. "Covid prevented PT for a while"
4. "None needed"
5. "Pandemic related safety precautions"
6. "Went to professional therapy"
7. "My wife felt more secure at an assisted living"
8. "difficulty accepting help with bathing"

Respite Care Services

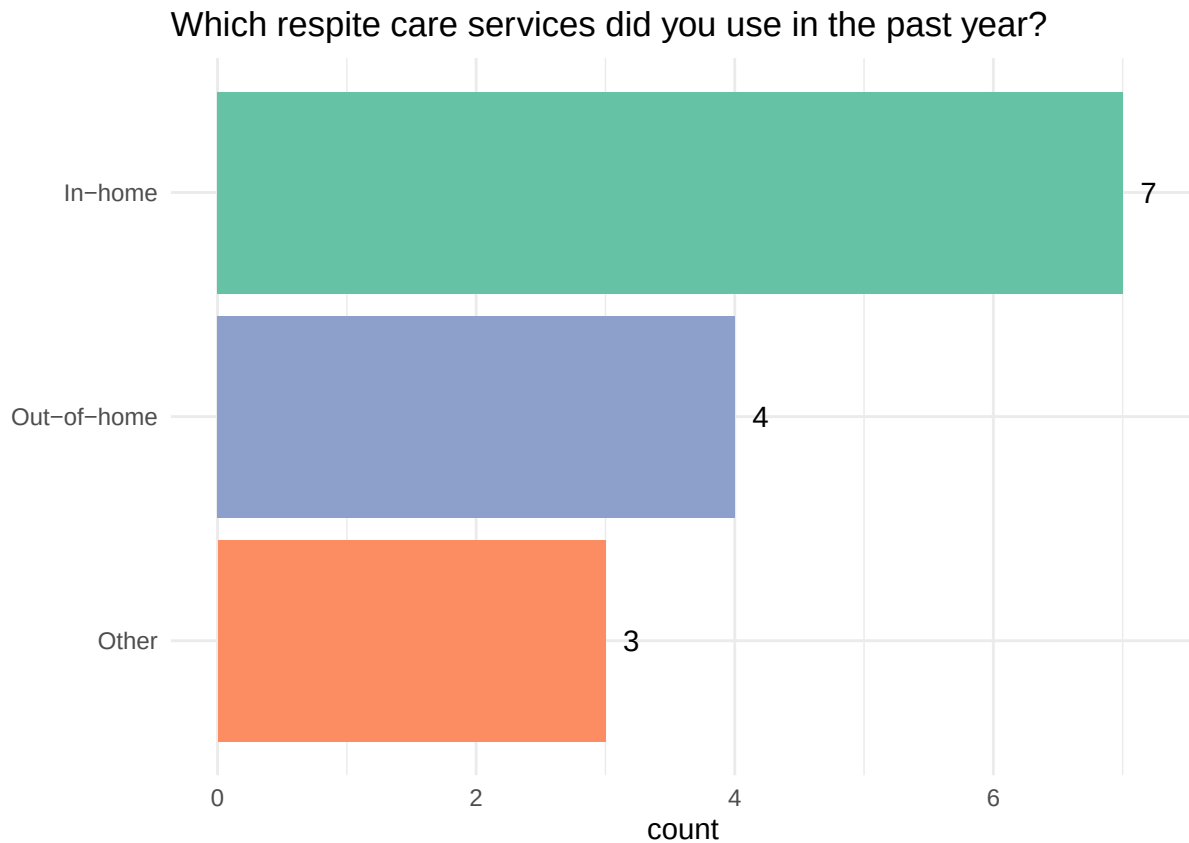
Q22. Did you use an in-home or out-of-home respite care service over the past year?

As shown in the barplot below, out of the 325 people who answered this question, 12 people used this service, and 313 people did not use this service.



Q23. Which respite care services did you use in the past year? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 11 people who answered this question, 7 of them used in-home respite care services, 4 used out-of-home respite care services, and 3 used other respite care services. This question was shown to everyone who answered “Yes” to the previous question, and allowed for multiple answers.

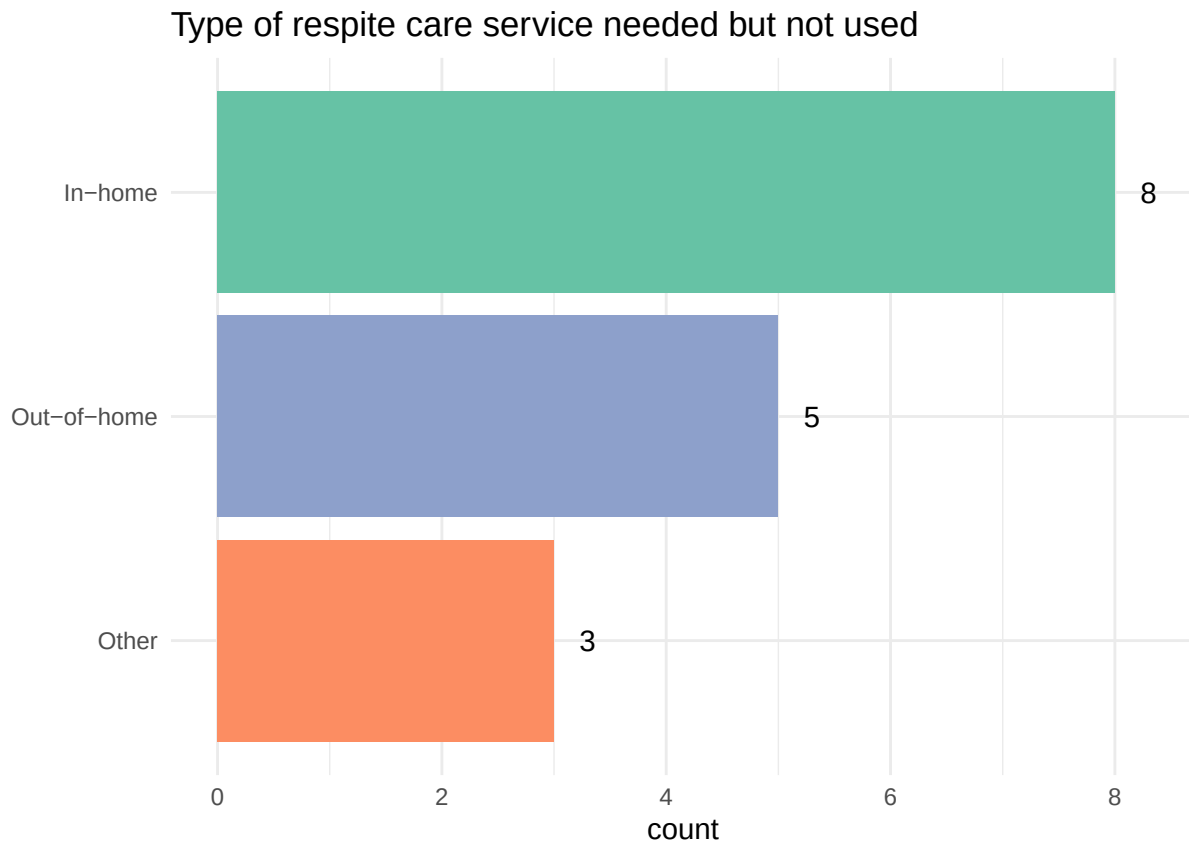


Text Responses

1. “These services were for us as we cared for my 94 year old dad who was in our home for 2 months at his end of life.”
2. “other dtr’s home”
3. “Was for parents at their home in town”

Q24. Which respite care services did you need, but not use? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 284 people who answered this question, 14 of them needed a respite care service but did not use one, and 270 had no unmet needs. Out of the 14 people who needed a respite care service but did not use one, 8 of them needed an in-home respite care service, 5 of them needed an out-of-home respite care service, and 3 needed it for other reasons. Everyone was shown this question, and allowed for multiple answers.

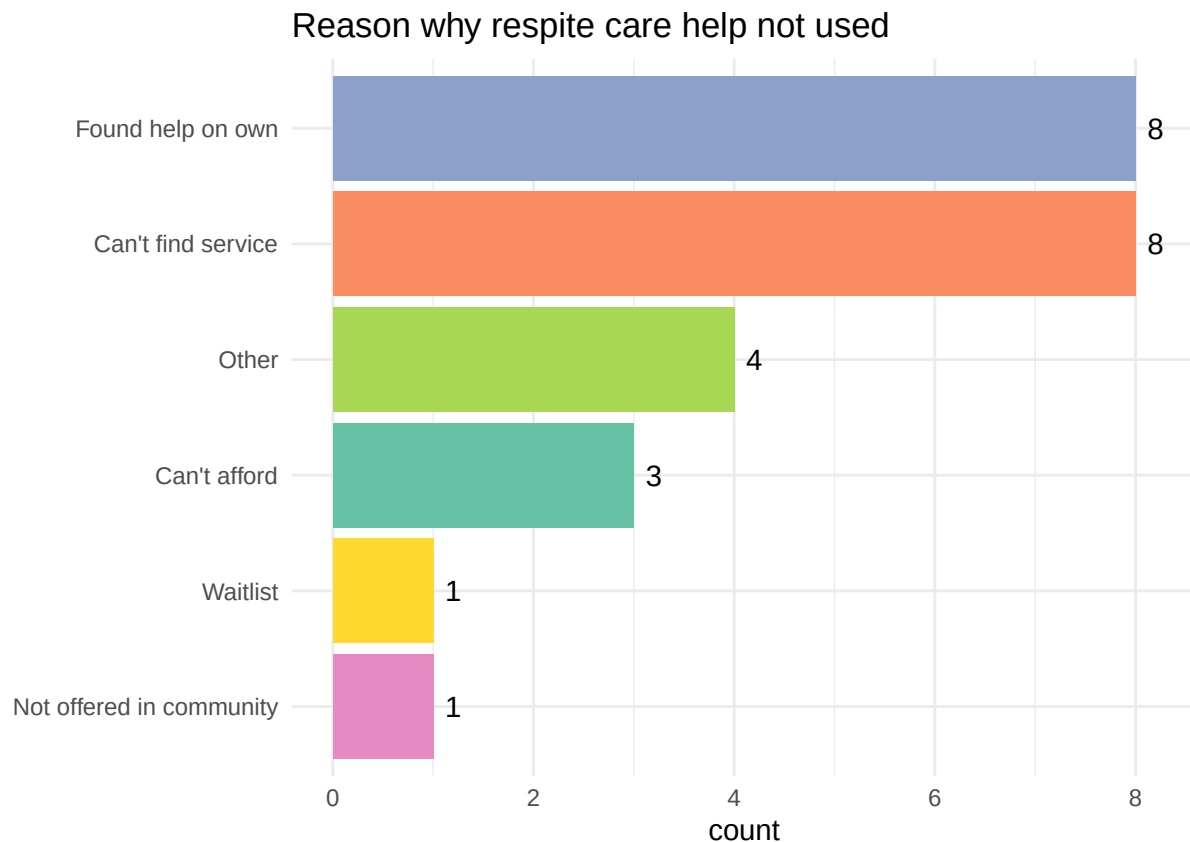


Text Responses

1. "Any! I just need a break!"
2. "None needed"
3. "Could not find"

Q25. If you needed help with respite care services this past year but did not use one, what was the reason? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 20 people who answered this question, 8 found help on their own, 8 of them didn't know how to find the service, 4 had other purposes, 3 couldn't afford it, 1 was on a waitlist, and 1 did not use it because the service was not offered. This question was shown to everyone who did not check "I did not have an unmet need" in the previous question, and allowed for multiple answers.



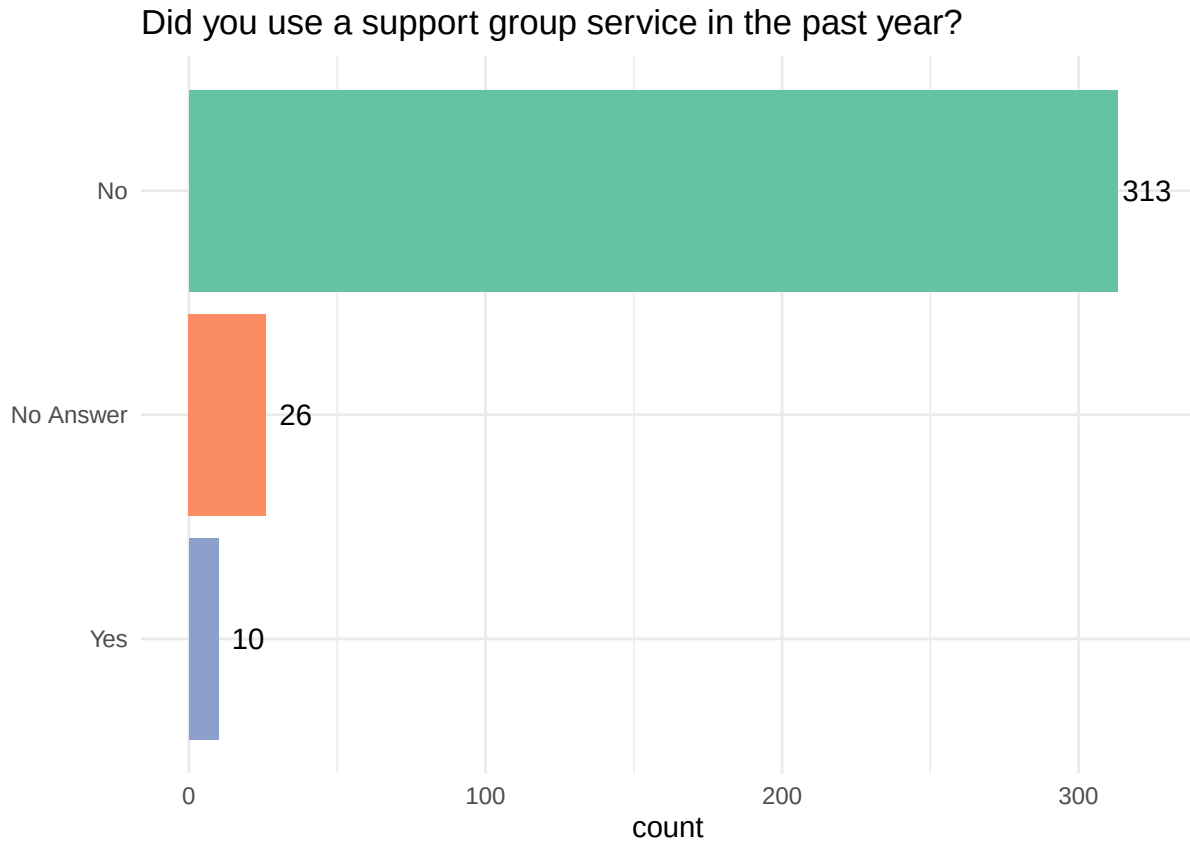
Text Responses

1. "Spouse who needs care not cooperative"
2. "We have long term care insurance which we would love to use for short periods of time (not the length required by agencies. BUT the person has to be CNA in order to get reimbursed. Hard to find people like that. Finally hired a nursing student from St. Olaf"
3. "None needed"
4. "Tried but could not find anyone"

Support Group Services

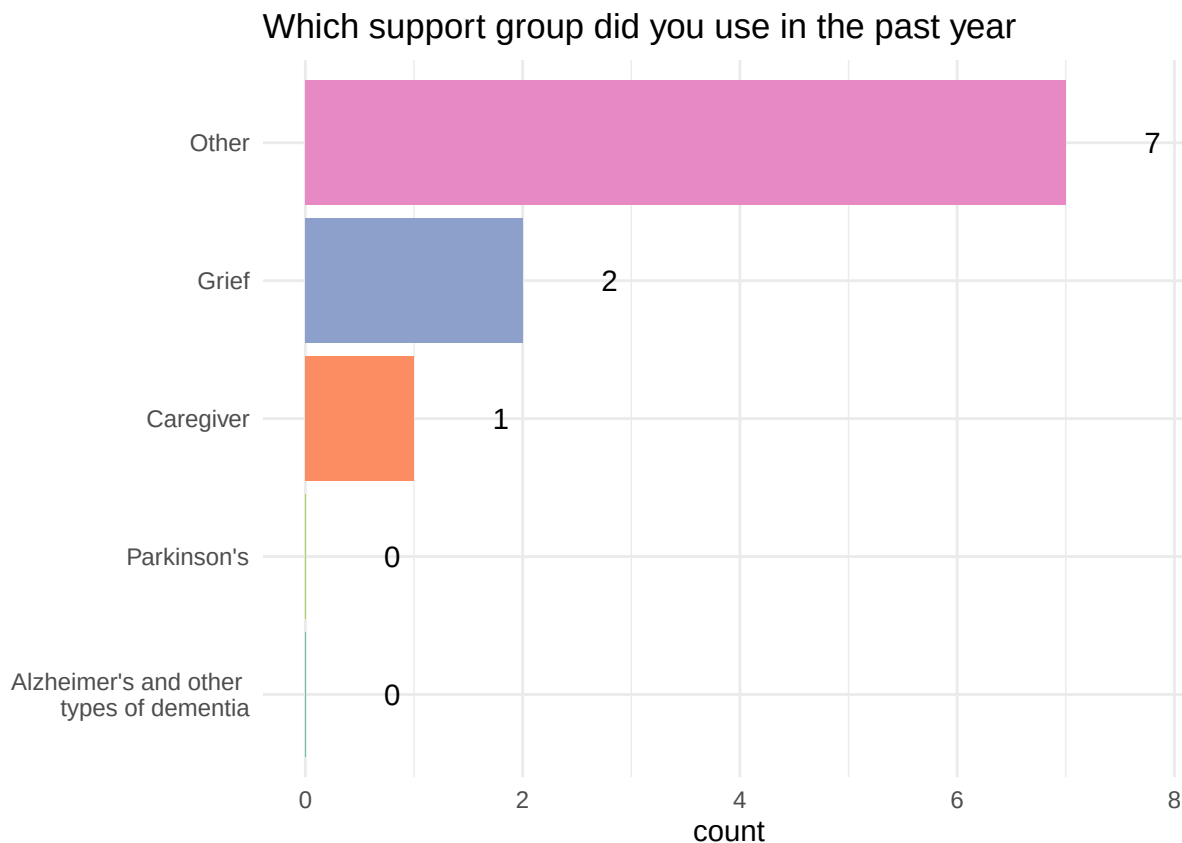
Q26. Did you use a support group service in the past year?

As shown in the barplot below, out of the 323 people who answered this question, 10 people used this service, and 313 people did not use this service.



Q27. Which support group did you use in the past year? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 9 people who answered this question, 2 of them used a grief support group, and 1 of them used a caregiver support group. 6 out of 7 people who selected “other” wrote their answer in the text box. This question was shown to everyone who answered “Yes” to the previous question, and allowed for multiple answers.

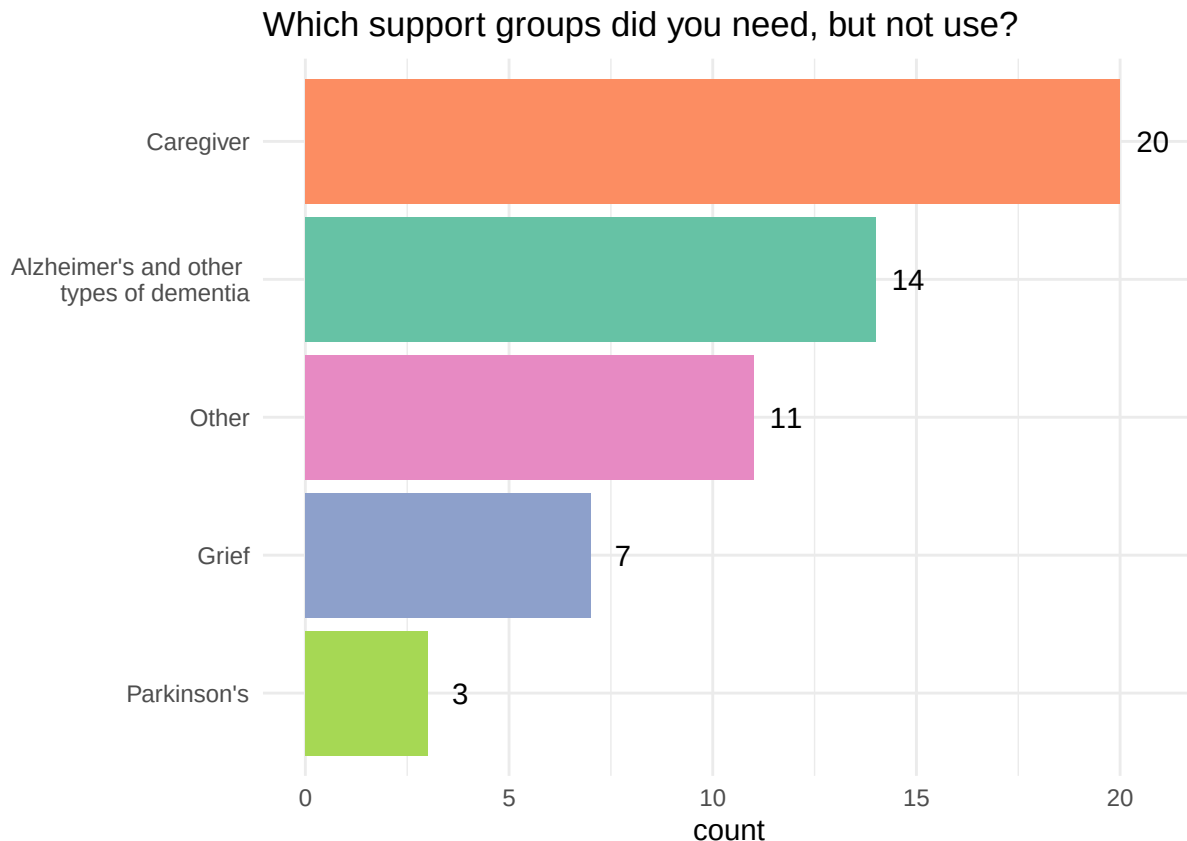


Text Responses

1. “NAMI”
2. “Aging.”
3. “Celiac”
4. “Cancer”
5. “Minn. Senior 1-800-333-2433 (Sarah)”
6. “E.A.”

Q28. Which support groups did you need, but not use? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 349 people who answered this question, 100 of them needed a chore service but did not use one, while 249 had no unmet needs. Out of the 100 people who needed support groups but did not use one, 20 of them needed caregiver support groups, 14 of them needed Alzheimer's and types of dementia support groups, 7 of them needed grief support groups and 3 of them needed Parkinson's support Groups. Out of the 11 written responses, 2 indicated mental issues, and 2 mentioned COVID influences. Everyone was shown this question, and allowed for multiple answers.

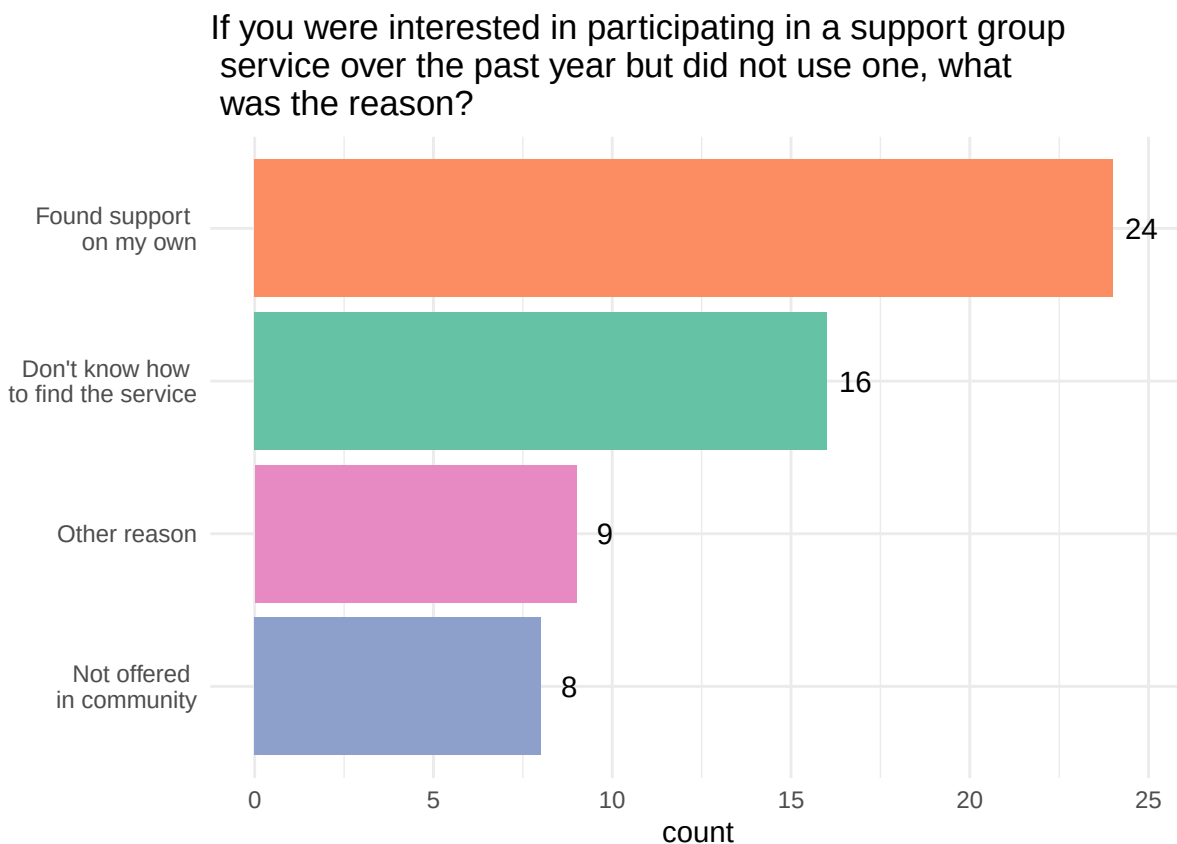


Text Responses

1. "Depression"
2. "COVID support-family testing positive"
3. "because of covid I just stay at home"
4. "Would like support group but can't find anyone to stay with my husband while I attend. He cannot be left alone and needs are more than I would ask a neighbor or friend to do"
5. "General socializing groups would be great"
6. "None needed"
7. "caregiving support for mental illness in family"
8. "Life Coach"
9. "Cancer"
10. "Low vision support group; support group for frustrations of dealing with technology in a world that seems to assume everyone is comfortable managing daily life online and using cell phones"
11. "Replace light bulbs"

Q29. If you were interested in participating in a support group service over the past year but did not use one, what was the reason? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 47 people who answered this question, 24 of them found help on their own, 16 didn't know how to find the service, 9 had other reasons, and 8 did not use it because the service was not offered. Out of the 9 written responses, 2 of them indicated COVID influences. This question was shown to everyone who did not check "I did not have an unmet need" in the previous question, and allowed for multiple answers.



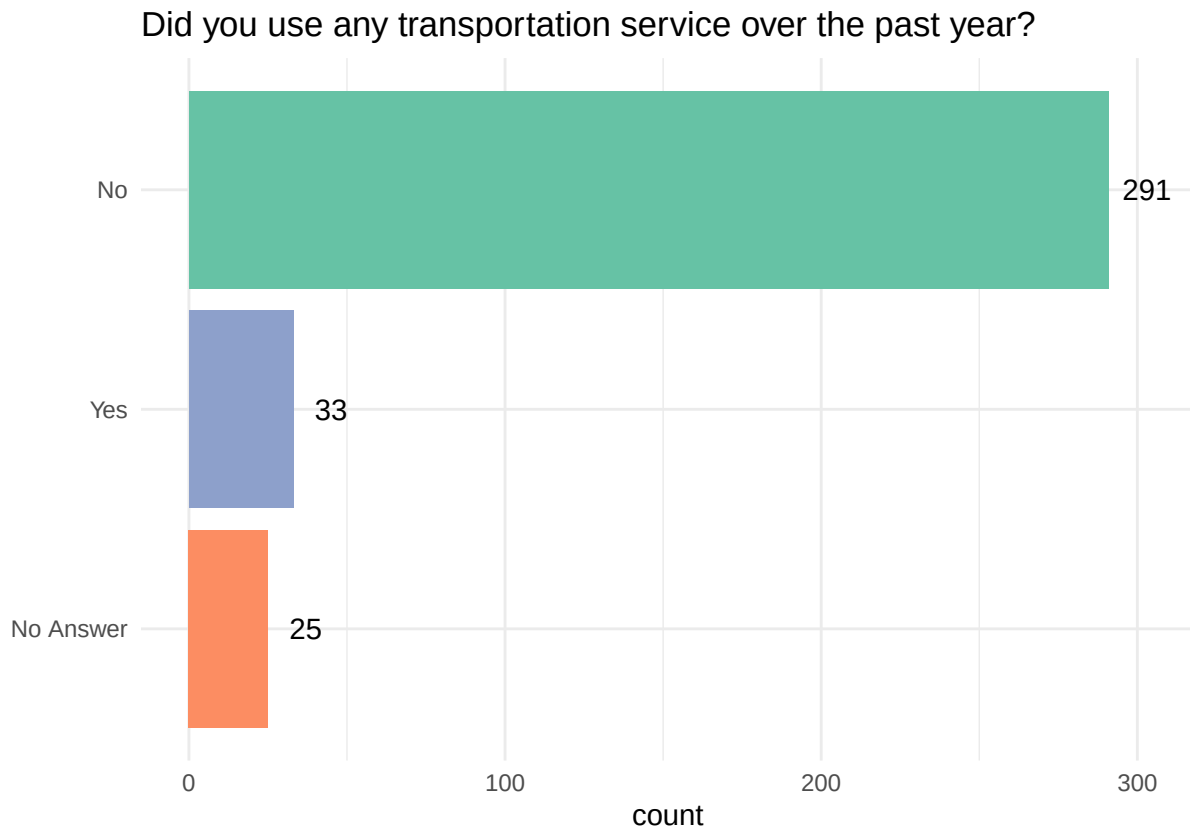
Text Responses

1. "Depression"
2. "COVID support-family testing positive"
3. "because of covid I just stay at home"
4. "Would like support group but can't find anyone to stay with my husband while I attend. He cannot be left alone and needs are more than I would ask a neighbor or friend to do"
5. "General socializing groups would be great"
6. "None needed"
7. "caregiving support for mental illness in family"
8. "Life Coach"
9. "Cancer"
10. "Low vision support group; support group for frustrations of dealing with technology in a world that seems to assume everyone is comfortable managing daily life online and using cell phones"
11. "Replace light bulbs"

Transportation Services

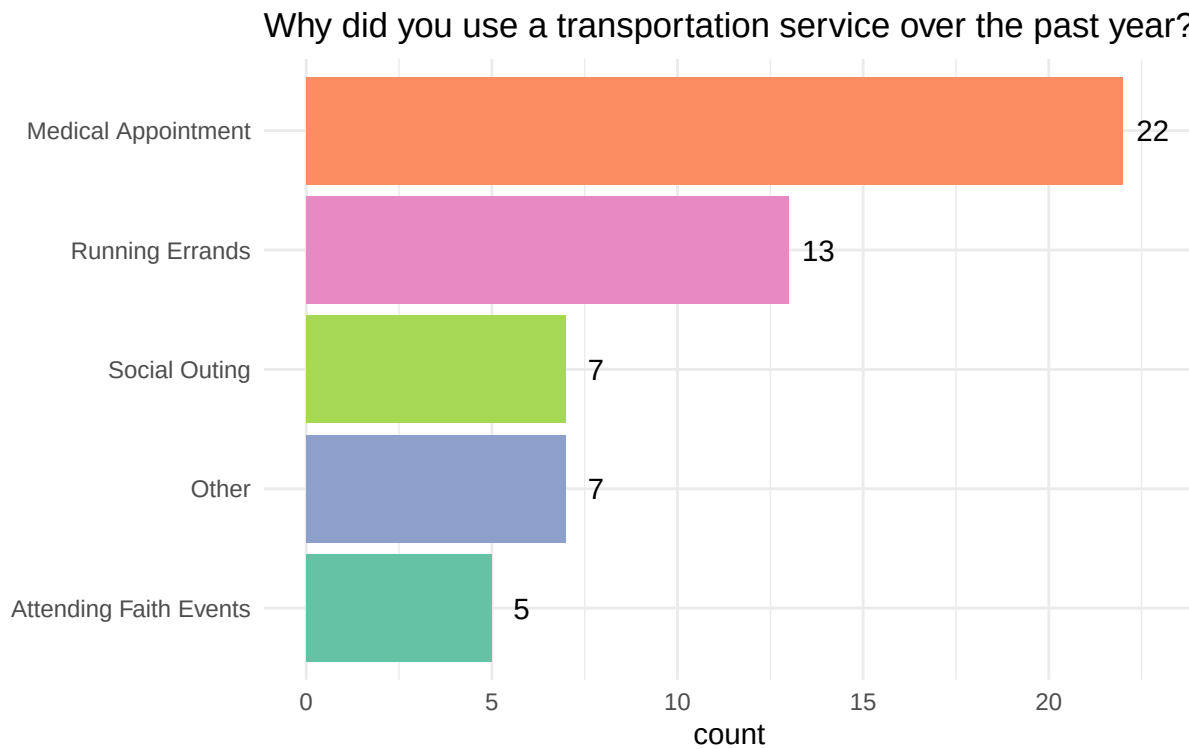
Q30. Did you use a volunteer, public, or other non-emergency transportation service over the past year?

As shown in the barplot below, out of the 324 respondents, 33 people used this service, and 291 people did not use this service.



Q31. Why did you use a transportation service over the past year? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 33 respondents who used the services over the past year, 22 of them used it for medical appointments, 13 for running errands, 7 for social outing, 7 for other purposes, and 5 for attending community faith events. Out of the 7 written responses, 3 of them are about airport runs. This question was shown to everyone who answered “Yes” to the previous question, and allowed for multiple answers.

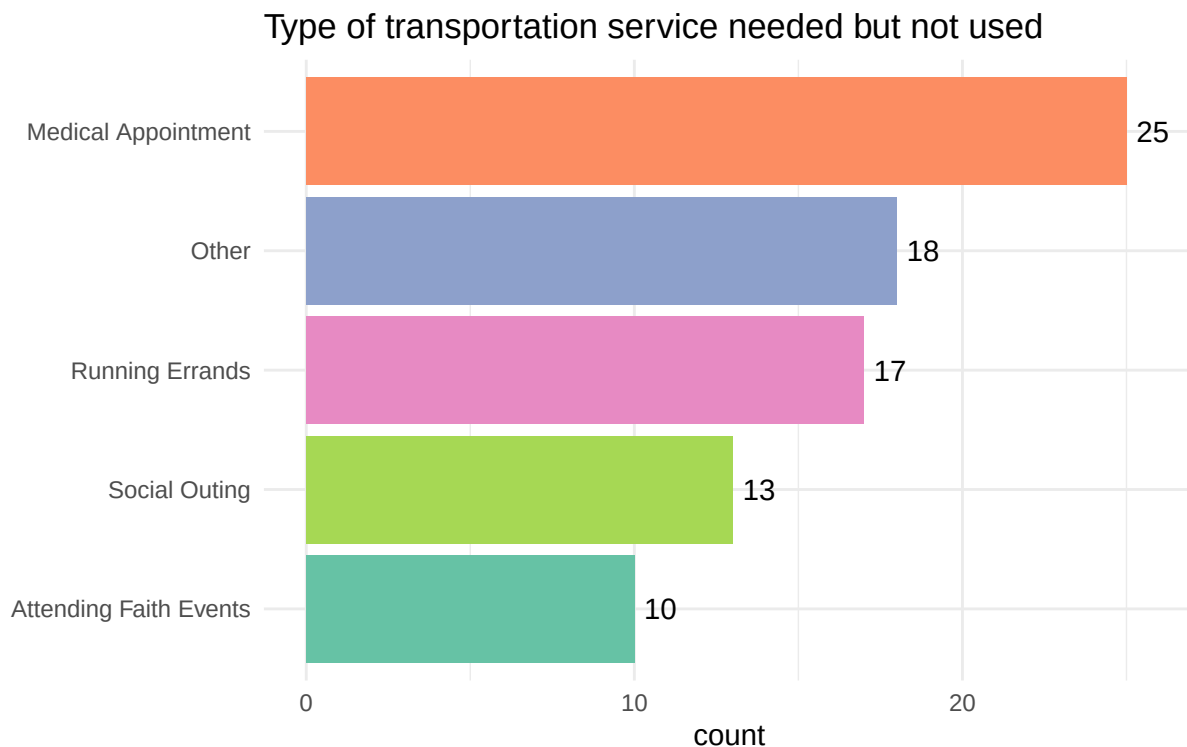


Text Responses

1. “Airport run”
2. “Rides to and from the airport”
3. “airplane trip transportation”
4. “dtr’s do all transportation”
5. “Commuting to/from the workplace”
6. “FiftyNorth Senior Center”
7. “50 North pool”

Q32. What type of transportation service did you need, but not use? (please check all that apply)

Out of 349 respondents, 49 of them needed a transportation service but did not use one, while 256 had no unmet needs. Out of the 49 respondents who needed a transportation service but did not use one, 25 of them needed transportation services for medical appointments, 18 for other use, 17 for running errands, 13 for social outing, and 10 for attending faith events. Out of the 17 written responses, 3 of them are about airport runs, 2 about taxi services being too expensive and unavailable on Sunday, and 1 about the lack of handicapped parking. Everyone was shown this question, and allowed for multiple answers.



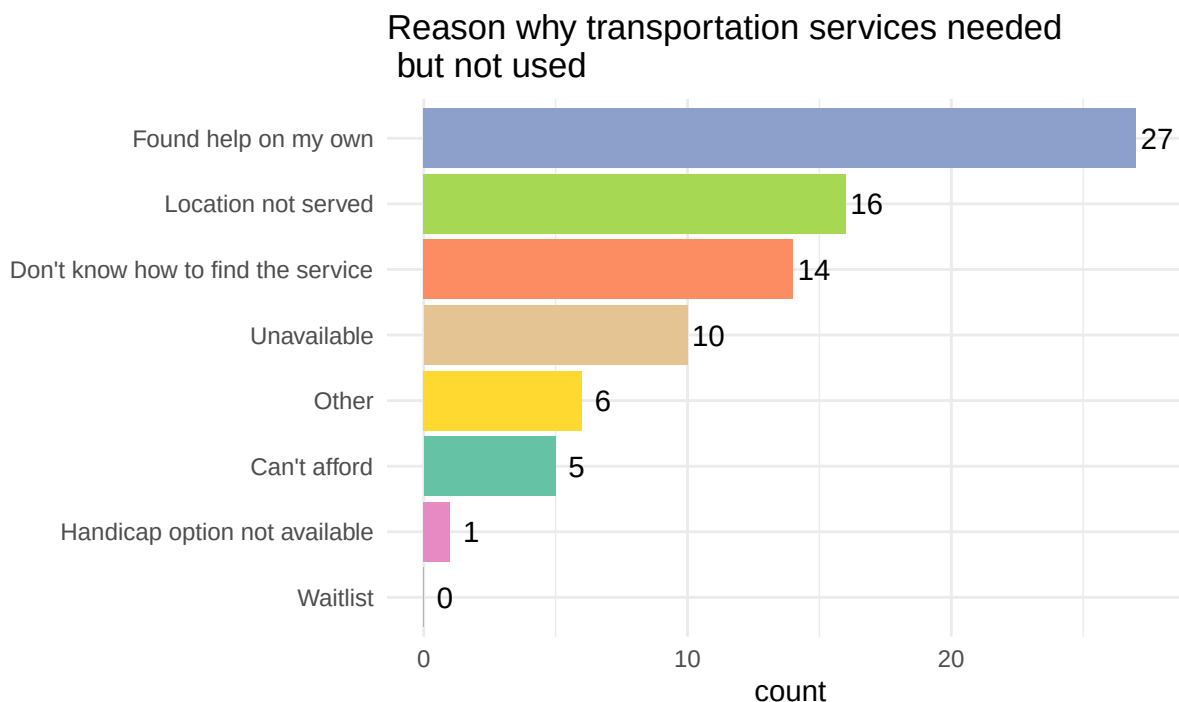
Text Responses

1. "Public Transportation to Rochester or twin cities for entertainment , restaurants"
2. "Commuting to work"
3. "We have a Northfield address, but live about 10 minutes out of town. Is there any public 4. transport that is available to people living that far from Northfield?"
4. "Airport"
5. "getting to airport and back"
6. "Needed a trip to the airport, and a neighbor gave me a lift."
7. "I don't have needs now but a lot of elders do need transportation"
8. "Although not mentions what limits us from doing things out of the home and in community is PARKING issues, lack of handicapped parking, lack of attention to obstacle to wheelchairs, public handicapped neutral gender bathrooms for the public. We have lived in Nfld since 1970 and actively participated in community activities but not anymore because are wheelchair bound. It makes us sad and feel isolated"
9. "None needed"
10. "Evening cultural events. Nighttime driving is a challenge."
11. "Is there a service that goes directly to Mayo Clinic in Rochester?"
12. "Attending evening cultural/social events"
13. "transportation to Twin Cities (less expensive than Taxi)"
14. "FiftyNorth Senior Center"

15. "I drive safely yet"
16. "I live in Dakota County and they do not service me"
17. "no taxi service on Sunday"

Q33. If you needed help with transportation services over the past year but did not use one, what was the reason? (please check all that apply)

Out of 79 respondents who needed help, 27 of them were able to find help on their own, 16 found that the transportation provider doesn't serve the location, 14 didn't know how to find the service, 10 found that the transportation provider wasn't available, 6 had other reasons, 5 couldn't afford it, and 1 found that the handicap option unavailable. Out of the 6 written responses, 2 are about financial concerns. This question was shown to everyone who did not check "I did not have an unmet need" in the previous question, and allowed for multiple answers.



Text Responses

1. "Very expensive , need Ubers/ lyfts"
2. "Unreliable or creepy drivers in past"
3. "None needed"
4. "No zip car or Lyft service in Northfield."
5. "Would like to go but I bother my family a lot for doctor appts"
6. "Dakota County is where I live but pay tax to Northfield City"

6. Caregiver Analysis

In this section, we aim to see if there is a difference in responses based on if a respondent is a caregiver or not. Our method for determining who was deemed a caregiver can be found in the methodology section of the report.

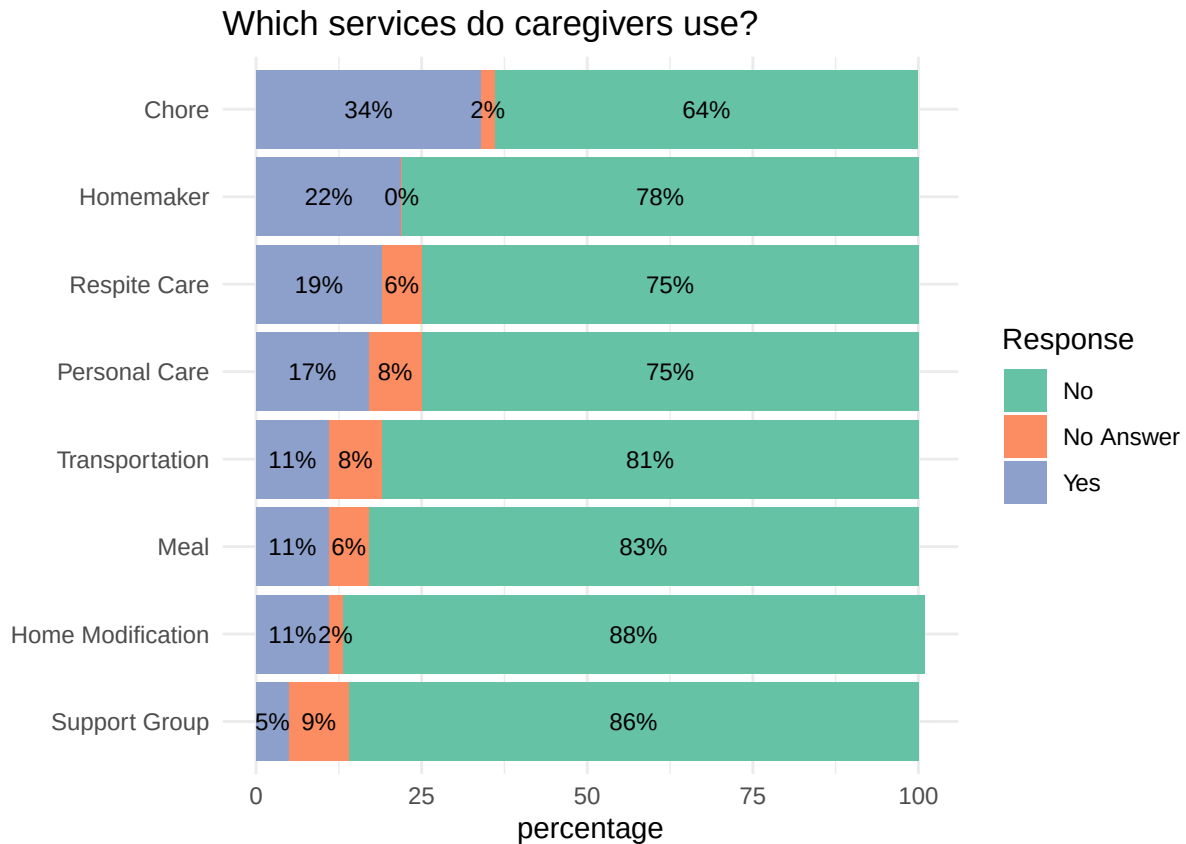
We will address the same goals as the main goals for the whole survey.

Here are the key findings:

1. Caregivers are facing the same problems as before.
2. Support group services were the most needed but not used service.
3. Transportation services were also indicated as being the most unavailable.
4. Chore services were also indicated as being highly needed but not used.
5. For caregivers, **support group services** are especially in need of development.

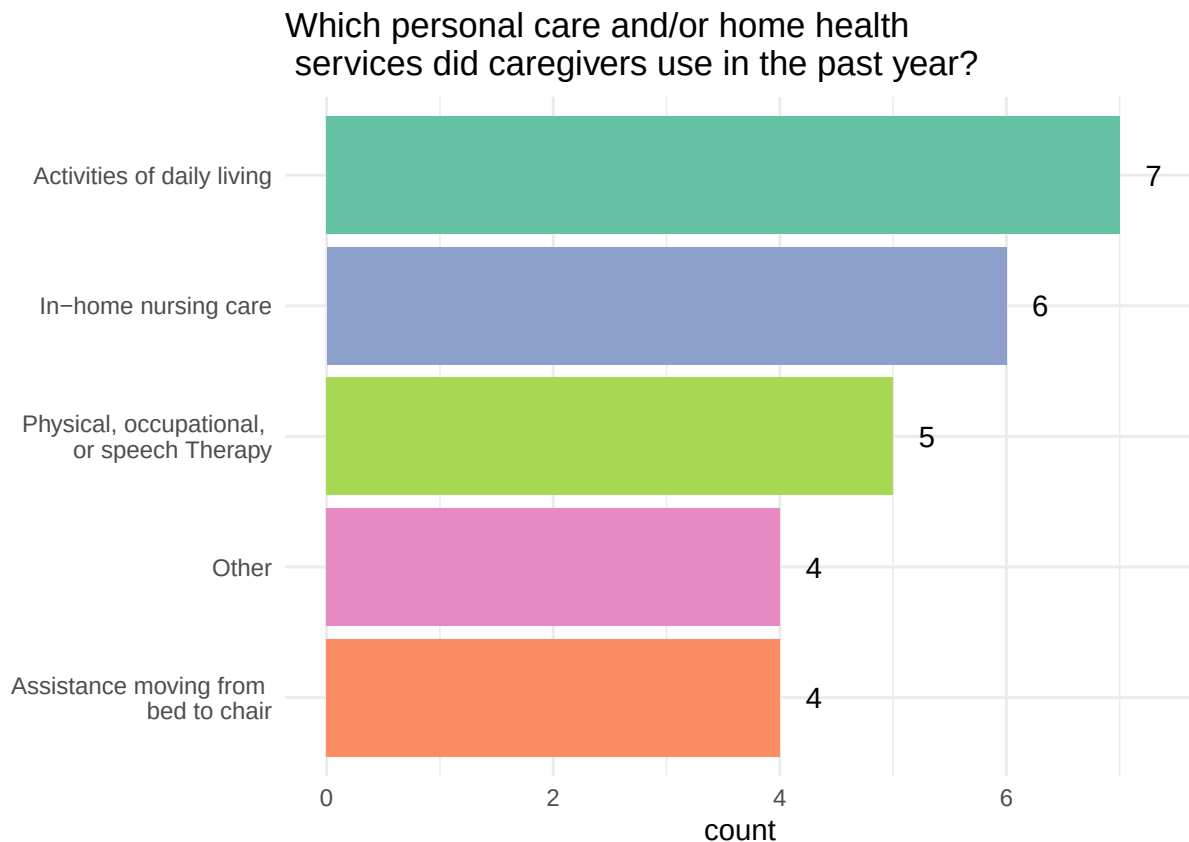
What services are caregivers using?

The proportions of caregivers using each service are quite similar to that in the overall analysis, except for respite care services and personal care and home health services. The spike in the proportion of respite care services is self-explanatory since the service is primarily provided for caregivers. The spike in personal care and home health services is unexpected. We found that half of the users of personal care and home health services are caregivers.



Which personal care and/or home health services did caregivers use in the past year? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 11 people who answered this question, 7 of them used it for activities of daily living, 6 for in-home nursing care, 5 for physical, occupational, or speech therapy, 4 for other purposes, and 4 for assistance moving from a bed to a chair. This question was shown to everyone who answered “Yes” to the previous question, and allowed for multiple answers.

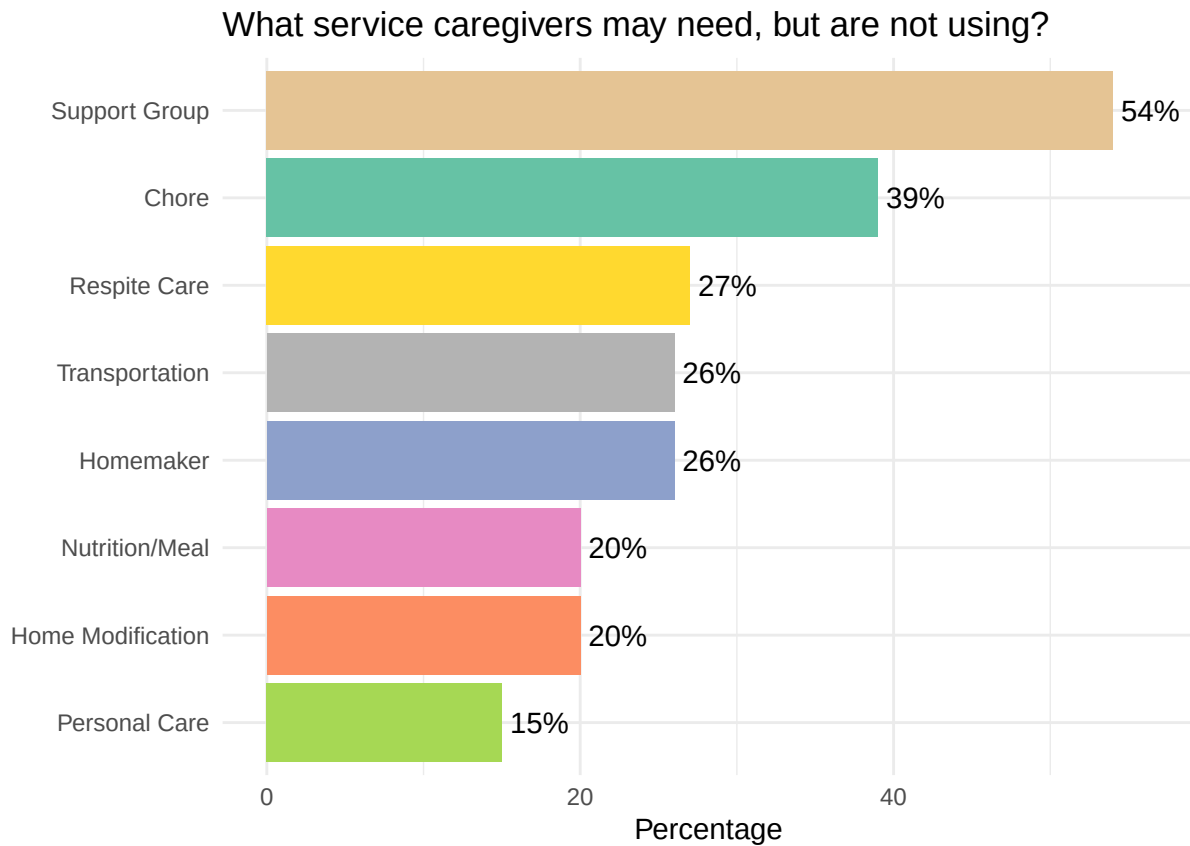


Text Responses

1. “These services were for my 94 year old father for 2 months in our home before he died.”
2. “light duty PCAs - meals, companionship, watching out for elder while family is out”
3. “Wound Care”
4. ” cleaning house”

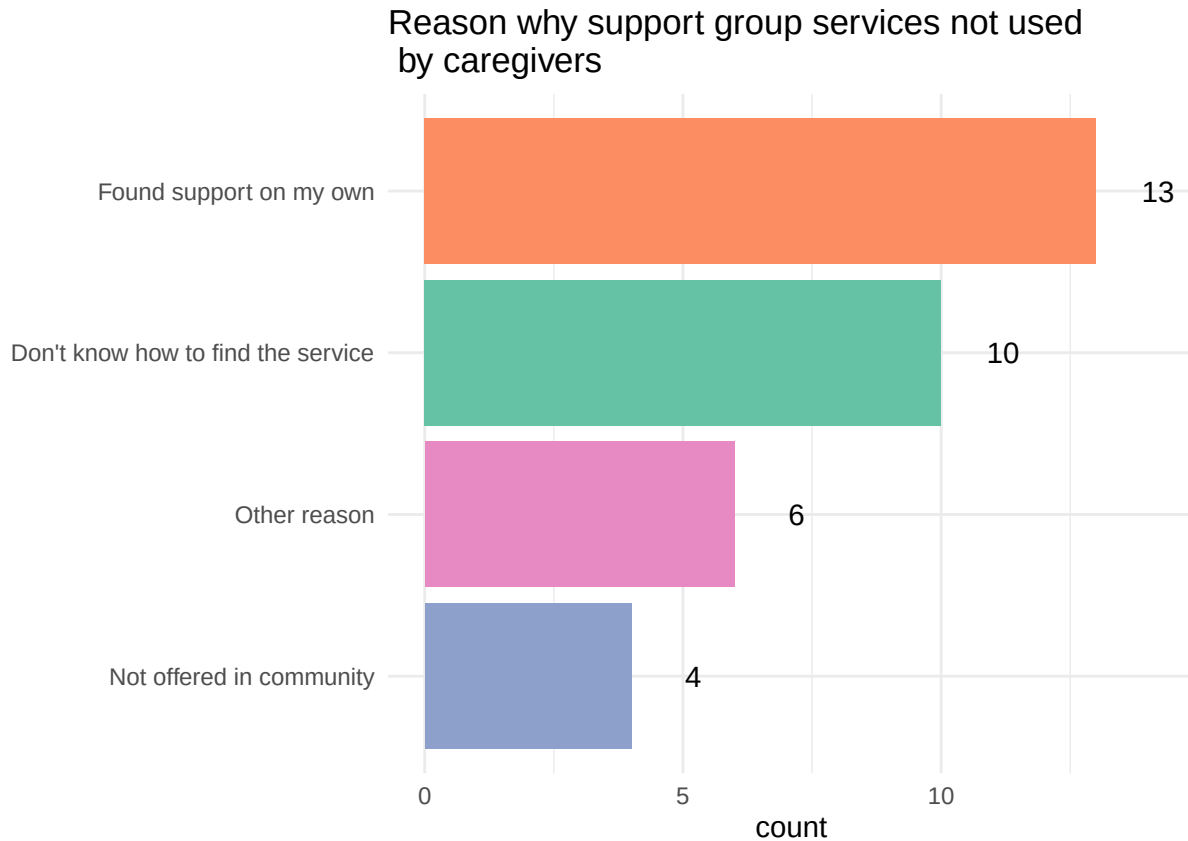
What services do caregivers need but are not using?

As shown in the bar plot below, support group services are the most needed but not used service with 54% of respondents indicating unmet needs. The rest of the services had a similar percentage of people saying that they needed the service but did not use them, with the exception of respite care services. However, the reason for this is self-explanatory as respite care services are primarily provided for caregivers.



Why aren't caregivers using Support Group Services? (please check all that apply)

Out of the 28 people who answered this question, 13 of them found help on their own, 10 didn't know how to find the service, 6 had other reasons, and 4 did not use it because the service was not offered. Everyone was shown this question, and allowed for multiple answers.



Text Responses

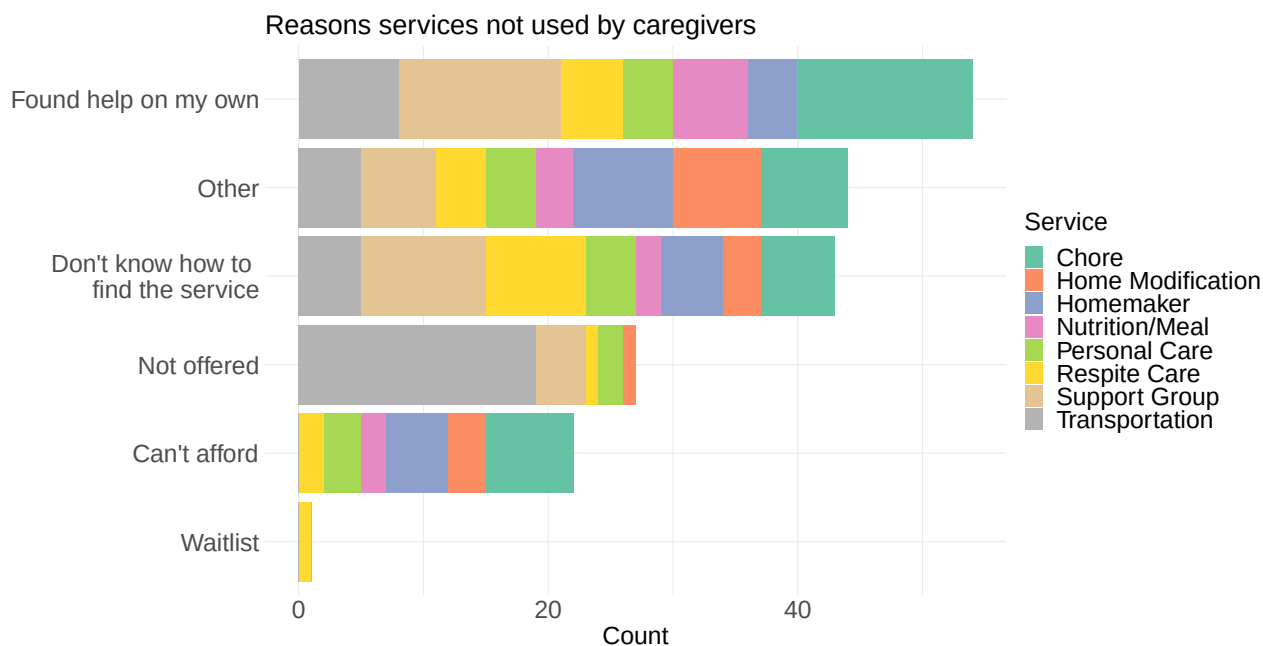
1. "I didn't know it was available."
2. "See above comments"
3. "new need for us"
4. "None needed"
5. "Not able to find affordable help on my income"
6. "Prefer a professional service. Pastors and support groups are helpful at a basic level but jot beyond."

Why aren't caregivers using the services?

This is an overview of why caregivers are not using services. Compared to the plot in the overall analysis, there is a large proportion of caregivers who needed support group services and transportation services but did not use them due to reasons such as “found help on my own”, “don’t know how to find the service”, and “not offered”. Thus, not using support group services and transportation services are big issues for caregivers.

Table 2: Reasons of services not used by caregivers

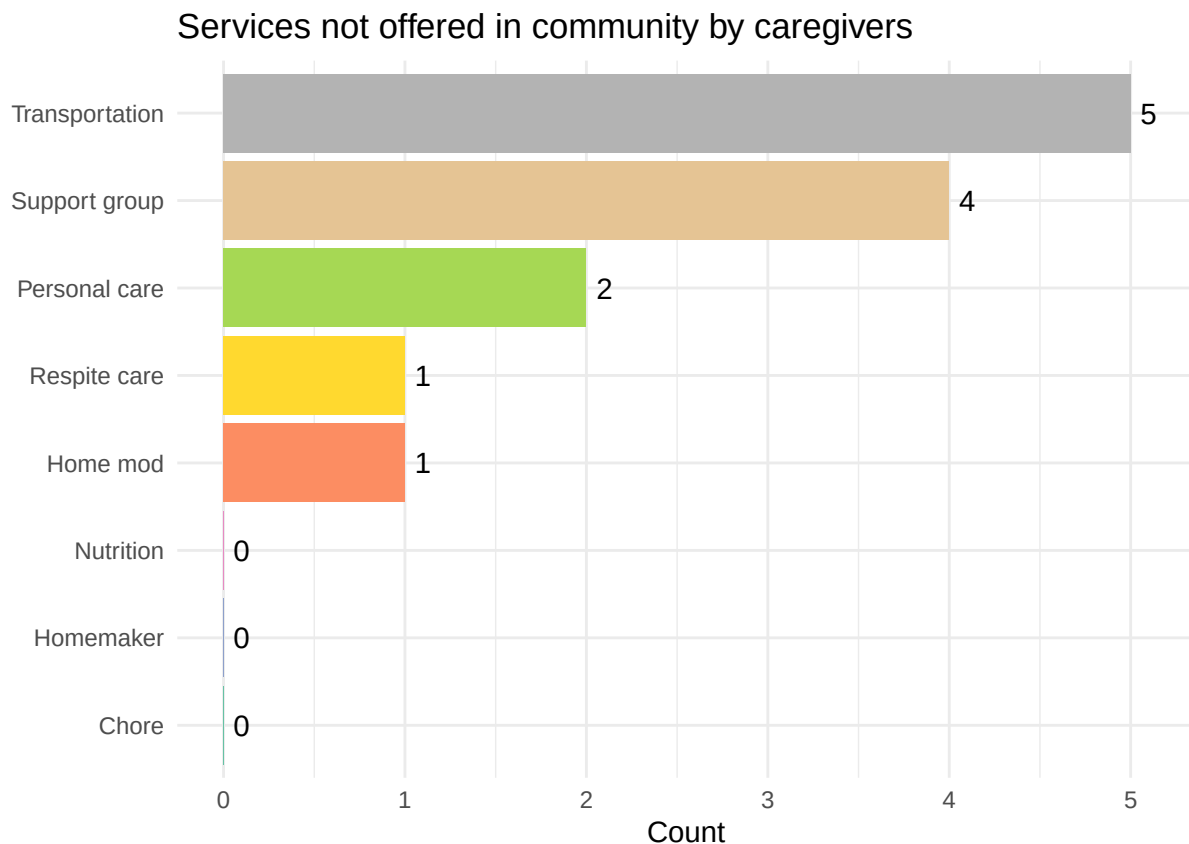
Reason	Chore	Homemaker	Home Modification	Nutrition/Meal	Personal Care and Home Health	Respite Care	Support Group	Transportation
Not offered	0	0	1	0	2	1	4	19
Don't know how to find the service	6	5	3	2	4	8	10	5
Can't afford	7	5	3	2	3	2	0	0
Waitlist	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0
Found help on my own	14	4	0	6	4	5	13	8
Other	7	8	7	3	4	4	6	5



What services are most needed but unavailable for caregivers?

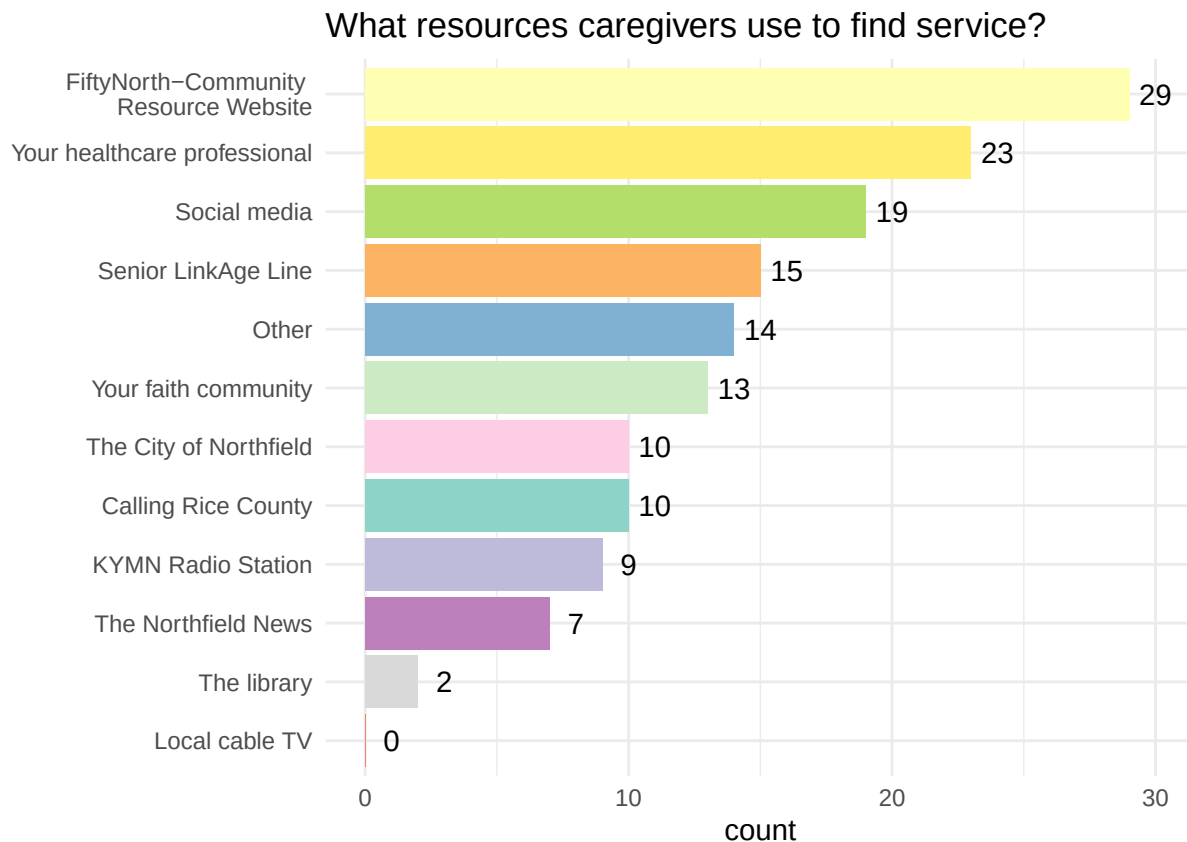
As shown in the bar plot below, transportation services stand out as being unavailable for caregivers, with 5 caregivers saying that transportation services were unavailable for them. Support group services are the 2nd most unavailable service with 5 people marking this as unavailable, followed by personal care services with 2 respondents.

Overall, these results are fairly similar to the overall results, with the main exception being that caregivers didn't find that chore services were unavailable to them.



What resources do caregivers use to find services?

We have a total of 64 valid responses, and 29 caregivers put FiftyNorth-Community Resource Website as one of their top three choices. Healthcare professionals are still the second most popular resource, with 23 caregivers using this resource. Social media became the third most popular resource for caregiver, with 19 of them using it. Among the 14 text responses, 5 caregivers indicated the usage of internet search including Google, and 3 caregivers mentioned a family or friend recommendation.



Text Responses

1. "Email"
2. "Friends and acquaintances"
3. "web"
4. "The Interwebs"
5. "Family/friends"
6. "Northfield Hospital Social Services Dept."
7. "my dtr's"
8. "Google"
9. "Internet"
10. "Friends and family"
11. "Chose more than three: FiftyNorth, Your Healthcare professional, calling Rice County, Senior LinkAge Line, Social Media"
12. "Internet search"
13. "Other selected - Senior LinkAge Line and Your healthcare professional; FiftyNorth-Community Resource Website – I am not a member and did not think bout their Resource Website for these services"
14. "Also chose... KYMN and your healthcare professional"

7. Appendix

The appendix is split into two sections: one section for income analysis and the other section for demographic information from the survey.

Income Analysis Results

In this section, we checked whether there was a difference in responses based on income level. Here are the main findings:

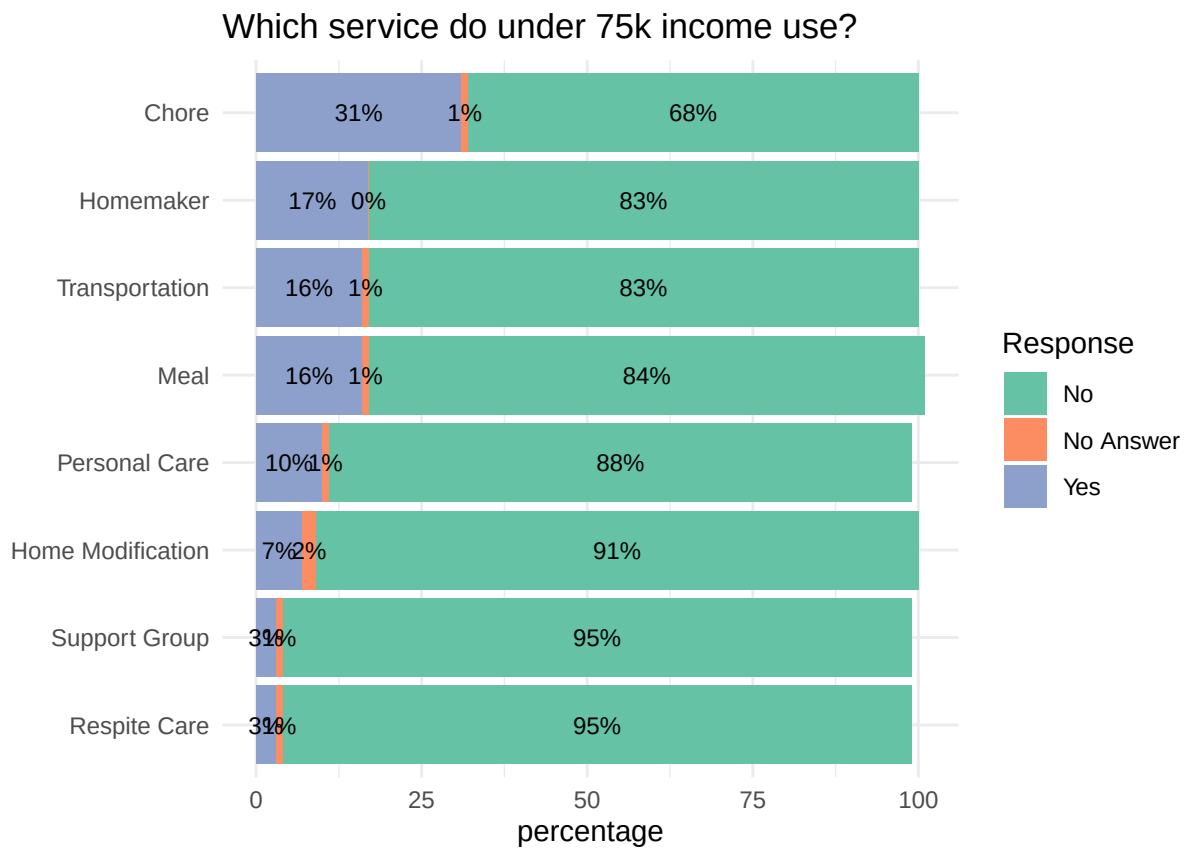
1. Those with the lesser income making up a large portion of people that use these transportation and meal services, and those with a greater income use these two services much less.
2. Those with the lesser income use transportation services mainly for medical appointments and running errands, while those with a greater income mainly use them for airport runs and medical appointments.
3. Those with the lesser income use home delivered meals through Northfield Hospital much more frequently. Additionally, those with the lesser income are the only ones using congregate dining provided through FiftyNorth.
4. Those with the lesser income need but don't use services at a higher rate than those with the greater income. Additionally, those with the lesser income make up a high proportion of those that need but don't use transportation and nutrition/meal services, while those with the greater income use support group services comparatively more.
5. Those with the lesser income were more likely to not know how to find the service and find help on their own compared to those with the greater income.
6. There is a higher proportion of those with the lesser income not being able to afford services.
7. Those with a greater income are more likely to use social media for information. Additionally, those with a lesser income use healthcare professionals, Senior LinkAge Line, and faith communities to a higher extent than those with a greater income.

Chore, support group, and transportation services have already been marked as in need of development, so it's worth noting that additionally, **Homemaker and Nutrition/Meal Services** are in need of development, especially for low income adults.

We will now show the analysis based on income level that we assessed by addressing the same questions as before for each income level.

What services are people with an annual income less than 75k using?

People with an income less than 75k mainly use chore, homemaker, transportation, and meal services.

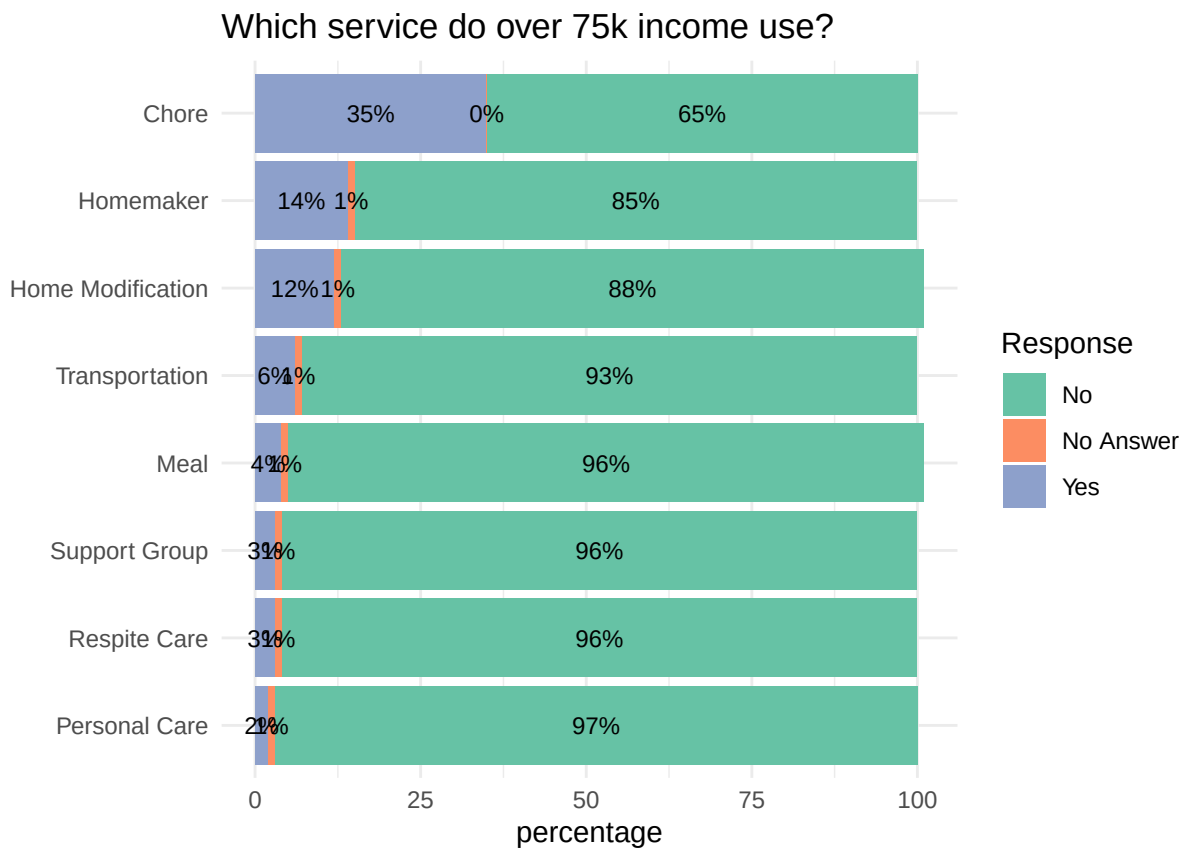


What services are people with an annual income greater than 75k using?

People with an income greater than 75k mainly use chore, homemaker, and home modification services.

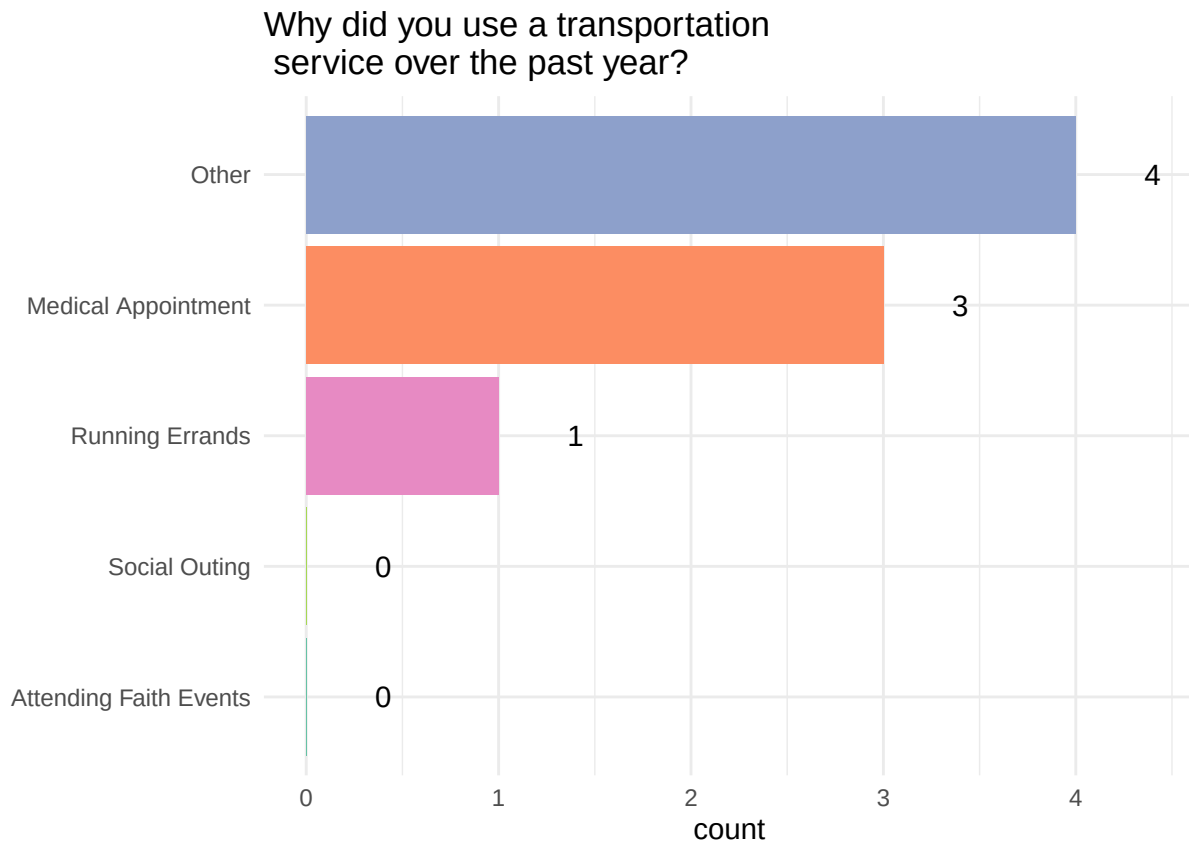
The two services with the greatest difference based on income levels are transportation and meal services, with those with the lesser income making up a large portion of people that use these two services, and those with a greater income using these two services much less.

We will now look at what transportation and meal services are used based on income.



What transportation services are used by people with an annual income greater than 75k?

Out of the 8 people who answered this question, 4 of them used it for other purposes, 3 for medical appointments, and 1 for running errands. Out of the 4 written responses, 3 of them referred to airport runs.



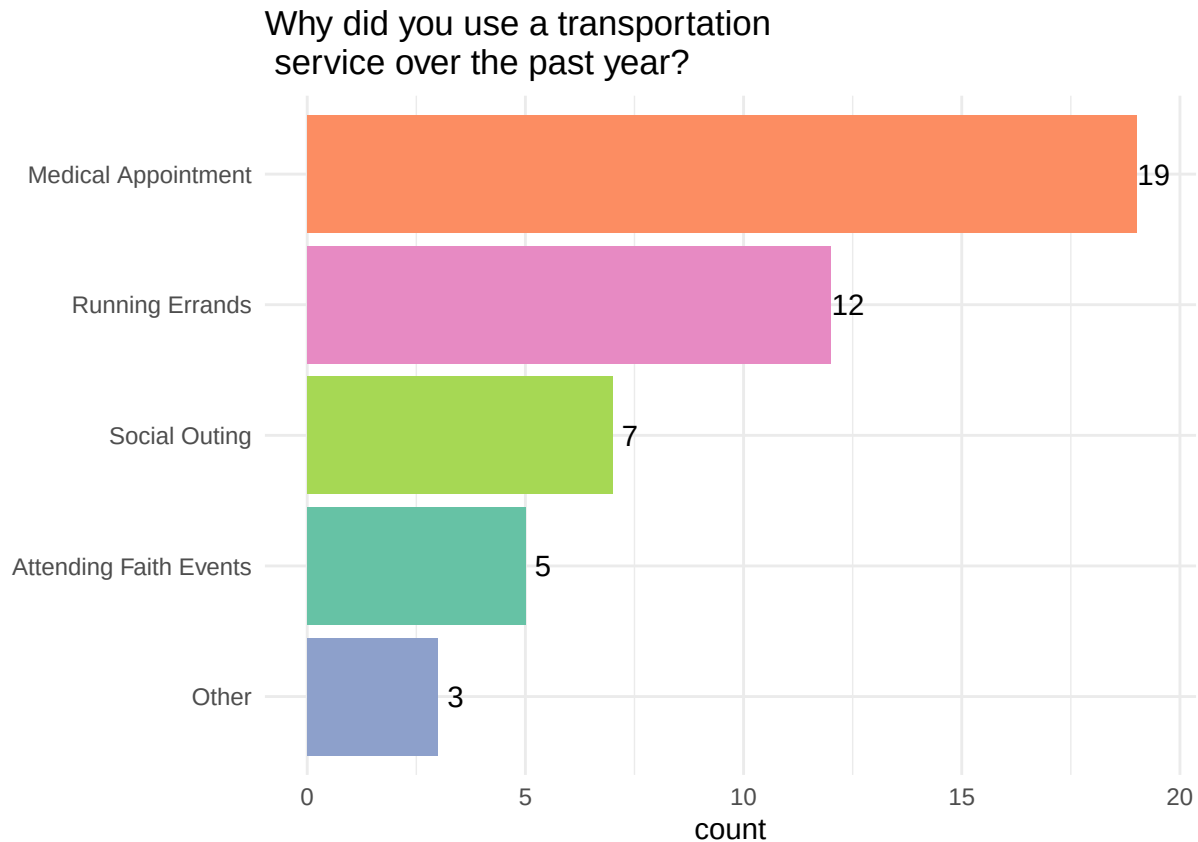
Text Responses

1. "Airport run"
2. "Commuting to/from the workplace"
3. "Rides to and from the airport"
4. "airplane trip transportation"

What transportation services are used by people with an annual income less than 75k?

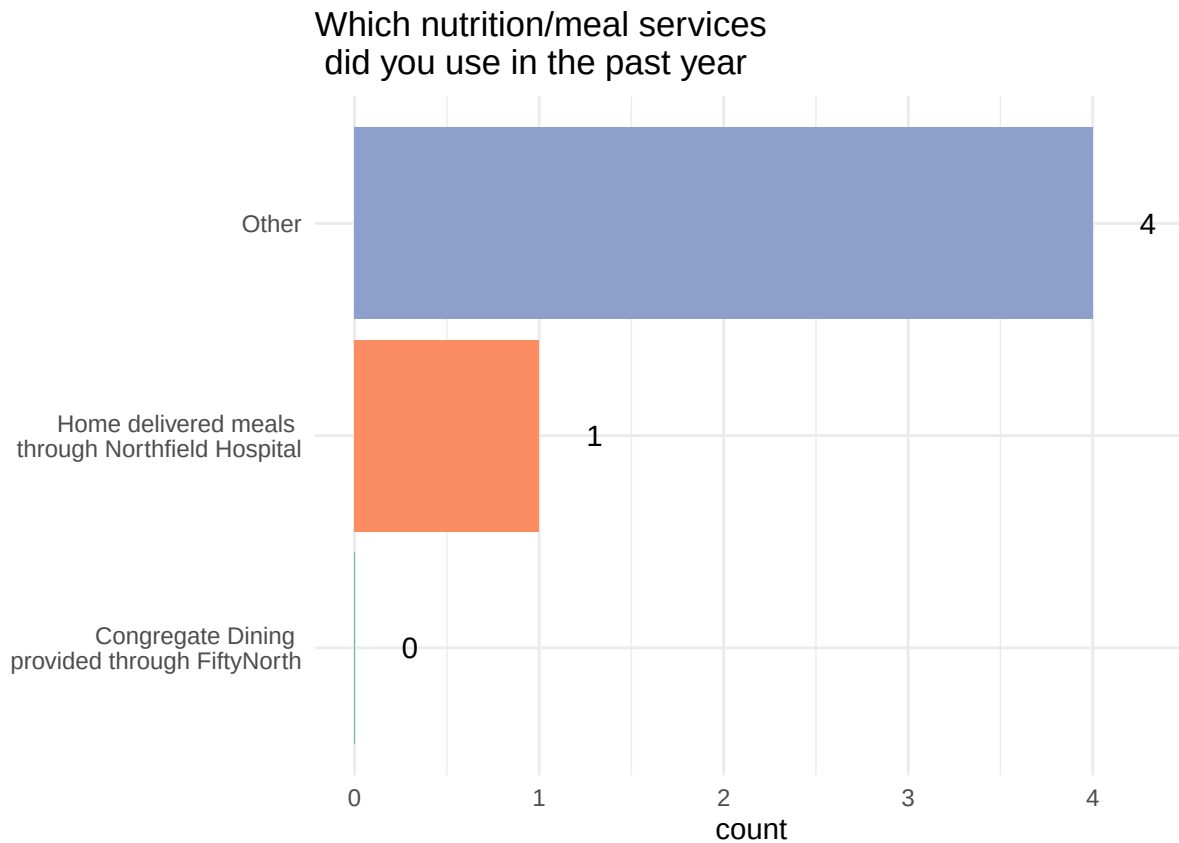
Out of the 25 people who answered this question, 19 of them used it for medical appointments, 12 for running errands, 7 for social outings, 5 for attending faith events, and 3 of them used it for other purposes.

The greatest differences based on income level are that those with the lesser income use transportation services mainly for medical appointments and running errands, while those with a greater income mainly use them for airport runs and medical appointments.



What meal services are used by people with an annual income greater than 75k?

Out of the 5 people who answered this question, 4 of them used it for other purposes and 1 used it for home delivered meals through Northfield Hospital. Of the 4 text responses, all of them refer to some form of home delivered meals.



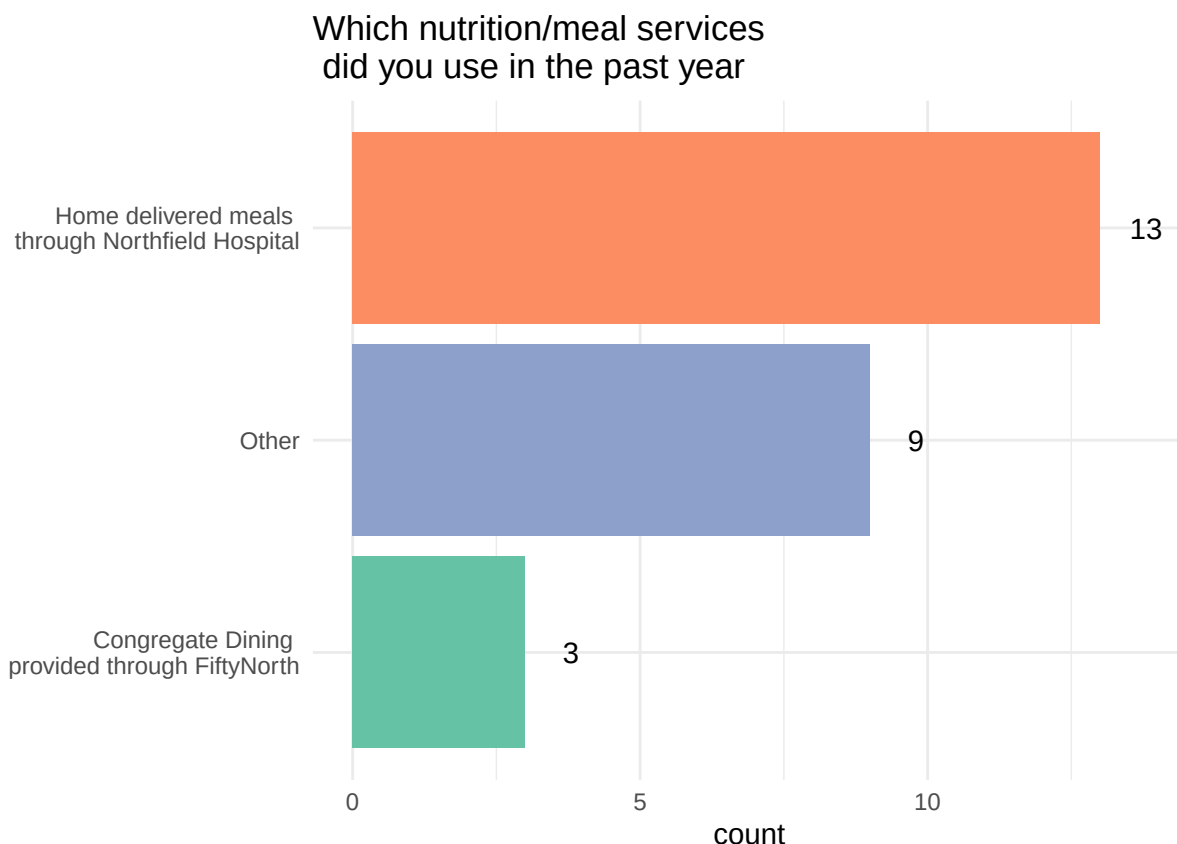
Text Responses

1. "Home delivery service"
2. "Hello Fresh"
3. "Grab & Go delivered to my home"
4. "Take home meals through FiftyNorth"

What meal services are used by people with an annual income less than 75k?

Out of the 23 people who answered this question, 13 of them used it for Home delivered meals through Northfield Hospital, 9 for other purposes, and 3 for congregate dining provided through FiftyNorth. Of the 8 text responses, 2 of them refer to Hello Fresh and 2 to a food shelf.

The greatest differences based on income level are that those with the lesser income use home delivered meals through Northfield Hospital much more frequently. Additionally, those with the lesser income are the only ones using congregate dining provided through FiftyNorth.

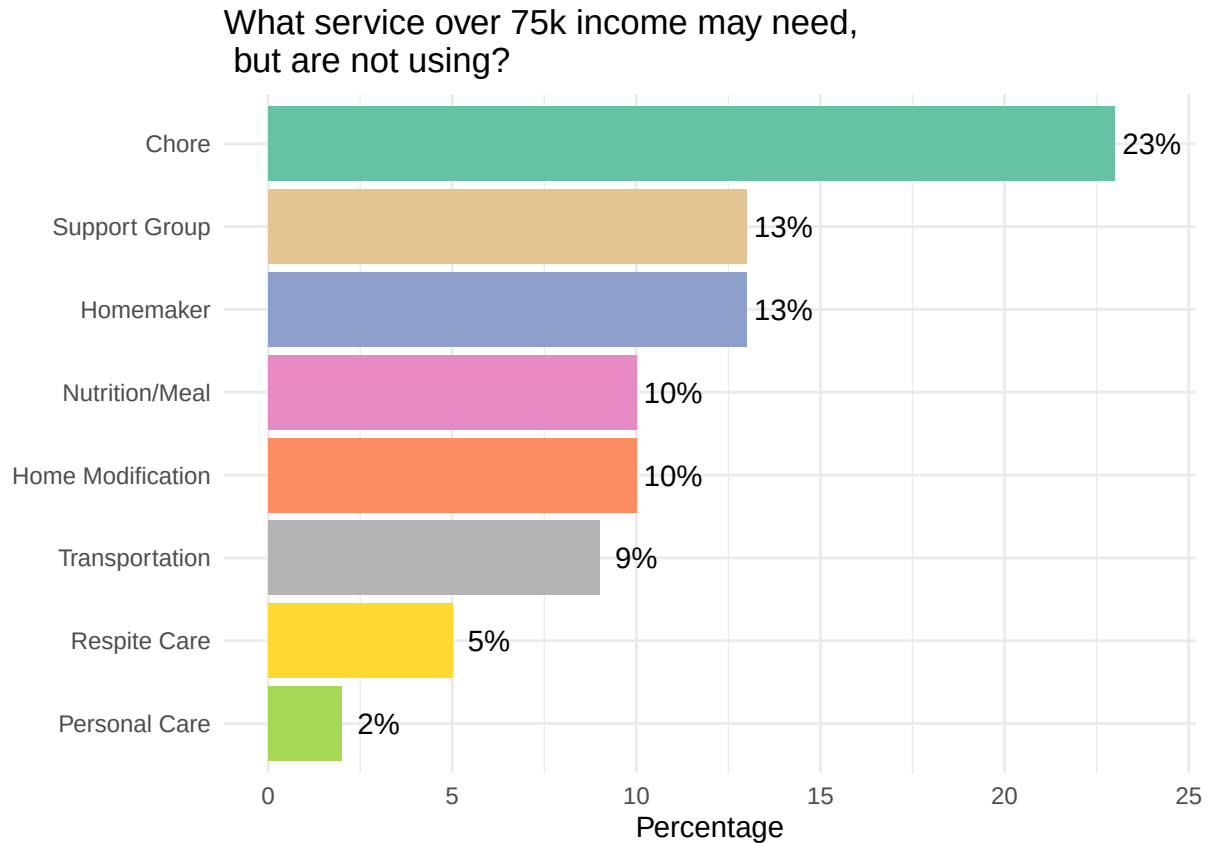


Text Responses

1. "Hello Fresh"
2. "food shelf"
3. "Benedictine"
4. "Hello Fresh"
5. "Food shelf (1 x month)"
6. "meals order from the Manor or Parkview at Northfield Retirement Center"
7. "Meals on Wheels"
8. "Family provided meals"

What services do people with an income greater than 75k need, but did not use?

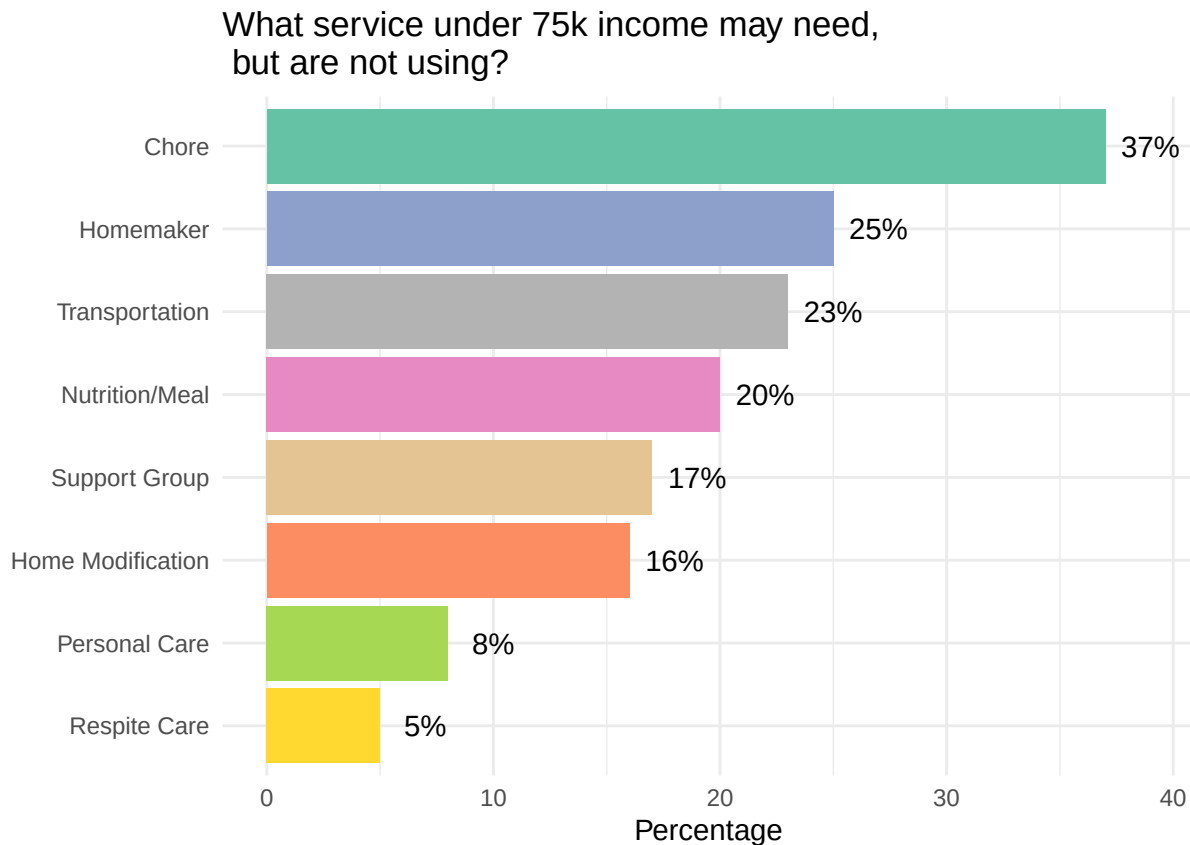
As shown in the barplot below, chore services remain the most needed but not used service, with 23% of people with an income greater than 75k needing but not using this service. The second most needed but not used services is tied between support group and homemaker services at 13%.



What services do people with an income less than 75k need, but did not use?

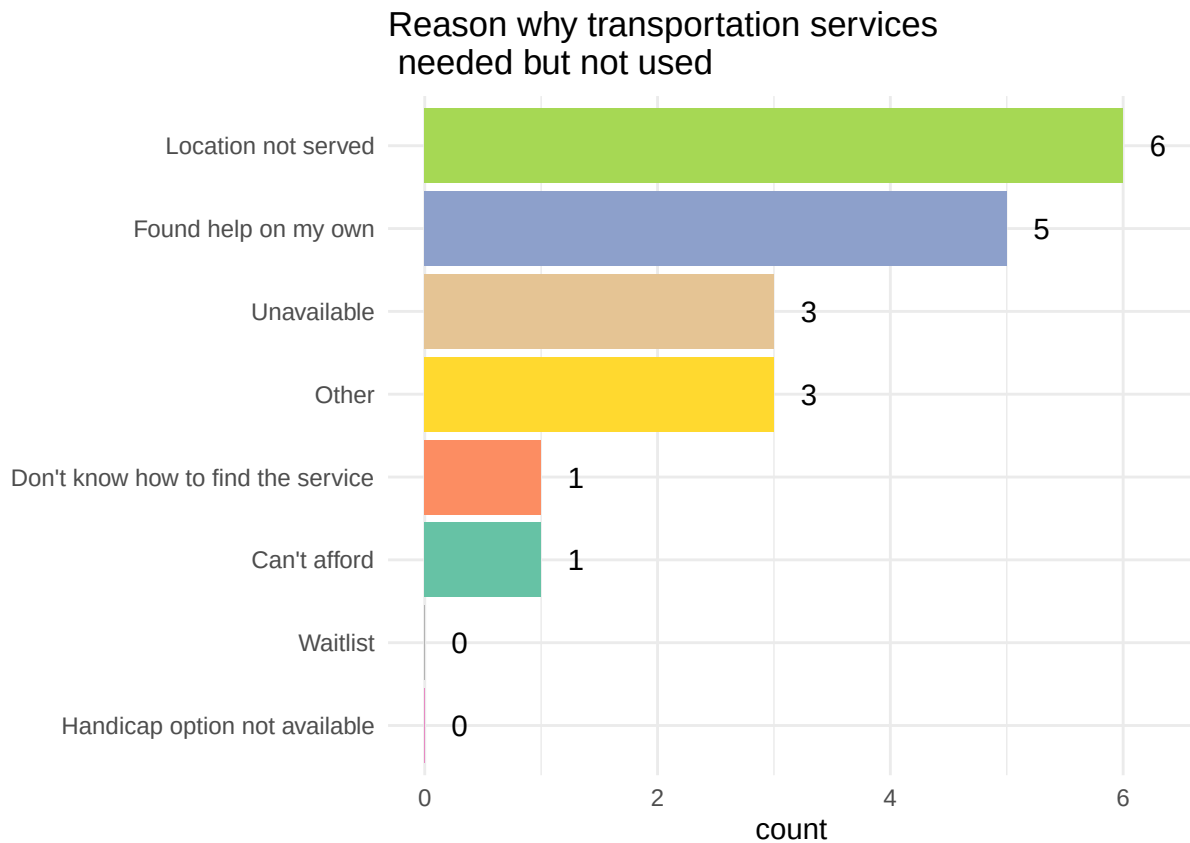
As shown in the barplot below, chore services remain the most needed but not used service, with 37% of people with an income greater than 75k needing but not using this service. The second most needed but not used service is homemaker with 25%, followed by transportation services at 23%.

Overall, those with the lesser income need but don't use services at a higher rate than those with the greater income. Additionally, those with the lesser income make up a high proportion of those that need but don't use transportation and nutrition/meal services, while those with the greater income use support group services comparatively more. We will now look for possible differences between the reasoning for transportation and support group services.



Why aren't people with an income greater than 75k using transportation services?

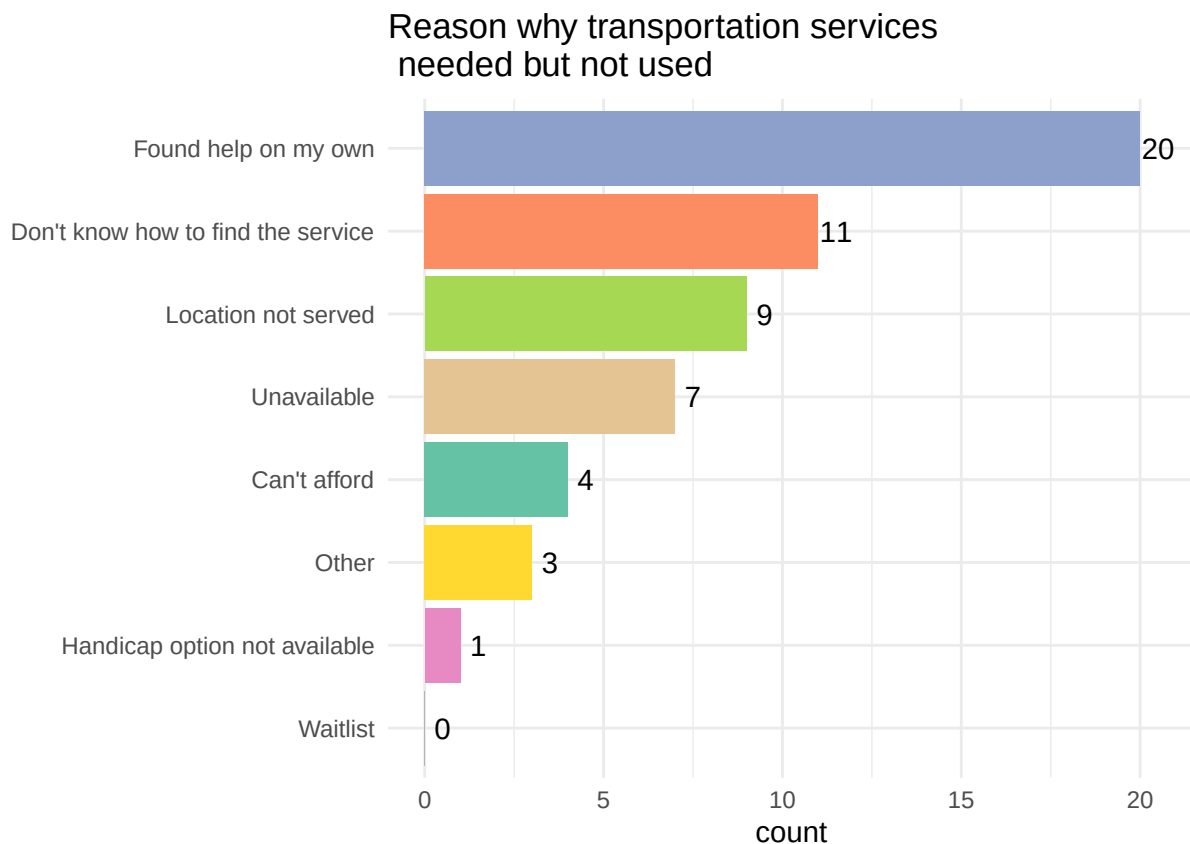
Out of the 11 people that answered this question, 6 said that their location was not served, 5 found help on their own, 3 said that the service was unavailable, 3 had other reasons, 1 did not know how to find the service, and 1 could not afford it. 0 people were on a waitlist or did not use it due to the handicap option not being available.



Why aren't people with an income less than 75k using transportation services?

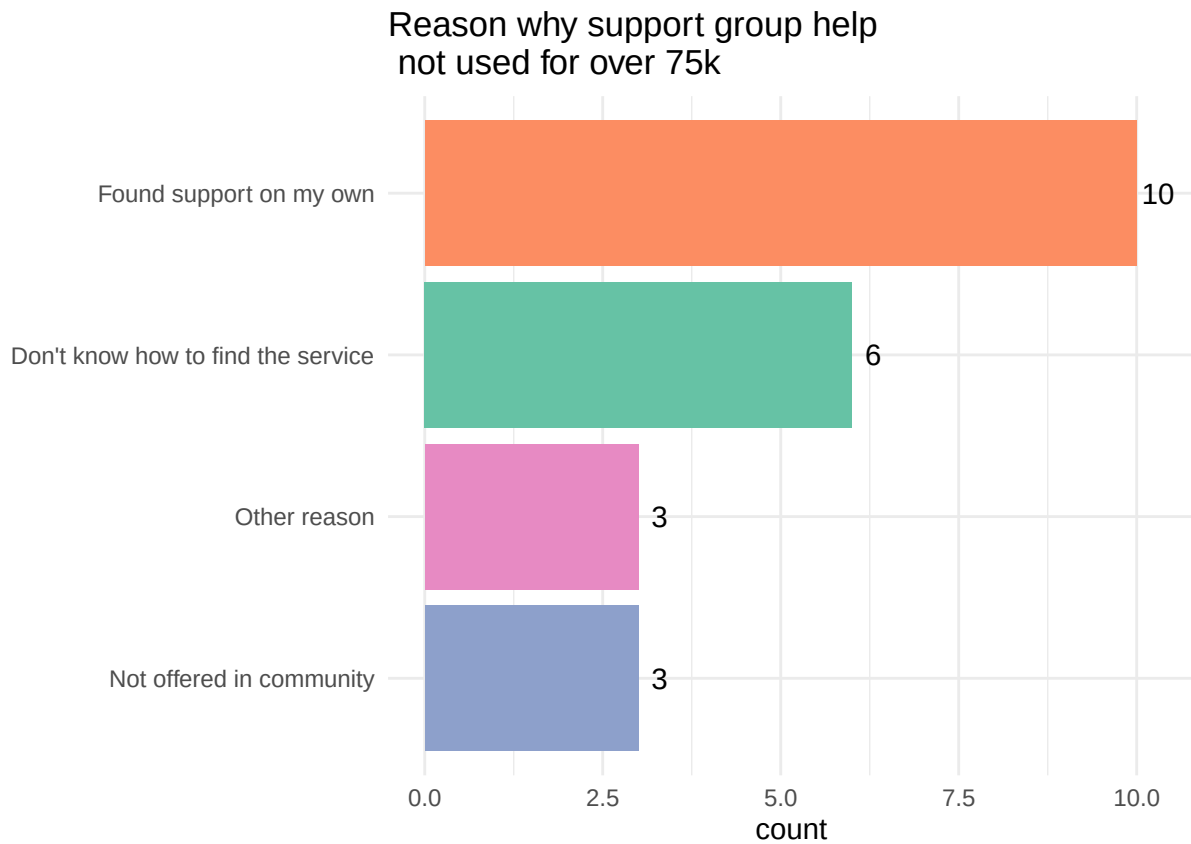
Out of the 33 people that answered this question, 20 people found help on their own, 11 didn't know how to find the service, 9 said that their location was not served, 7 said that it was unavailable, 4 couldn't afford it, 3 had other reasons, and 1 said that the handicap option was not available. 0 people were on a waitlist.

The main differences based on income level are that those with the lesser income were more likely to not know how to find the service and find help on their own compared to those with the greater income. Additionally, a higher proportion of those with the greater income indicated that the location was not served.



Why aren't people with an income greater than 75k using support group services?

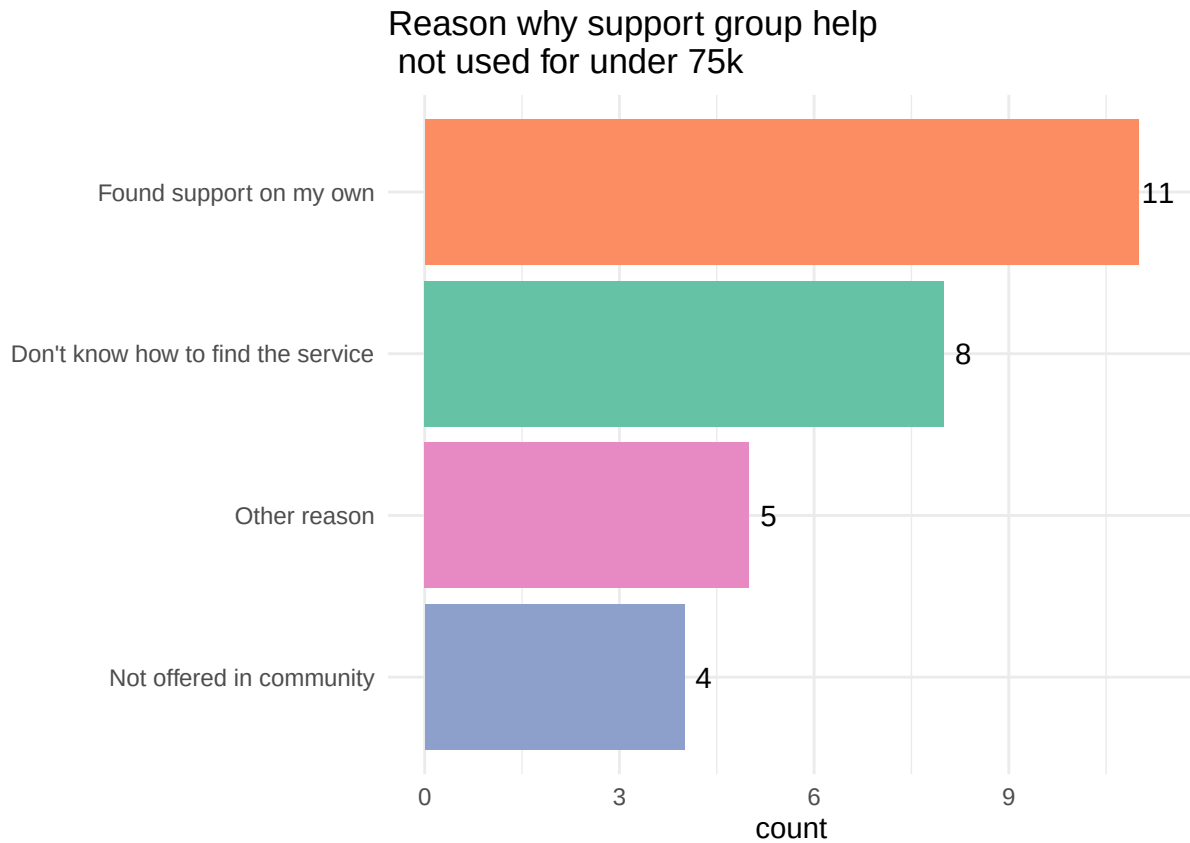
Out of the 18 people that answered this question, 10 people found support on their own, 6 didn't know how to find the service, 3 had other reasons, and 3 said that it was not offered in their community.



Why aren't people with an income less than 75k using support group services?

Out of the 23 people that answered this question, 11 people found support on their own, 8 didn't know how to find the service, 5 had other reasons, and 4 said that it was not offered in their community.

The reasons are the same based on income level.

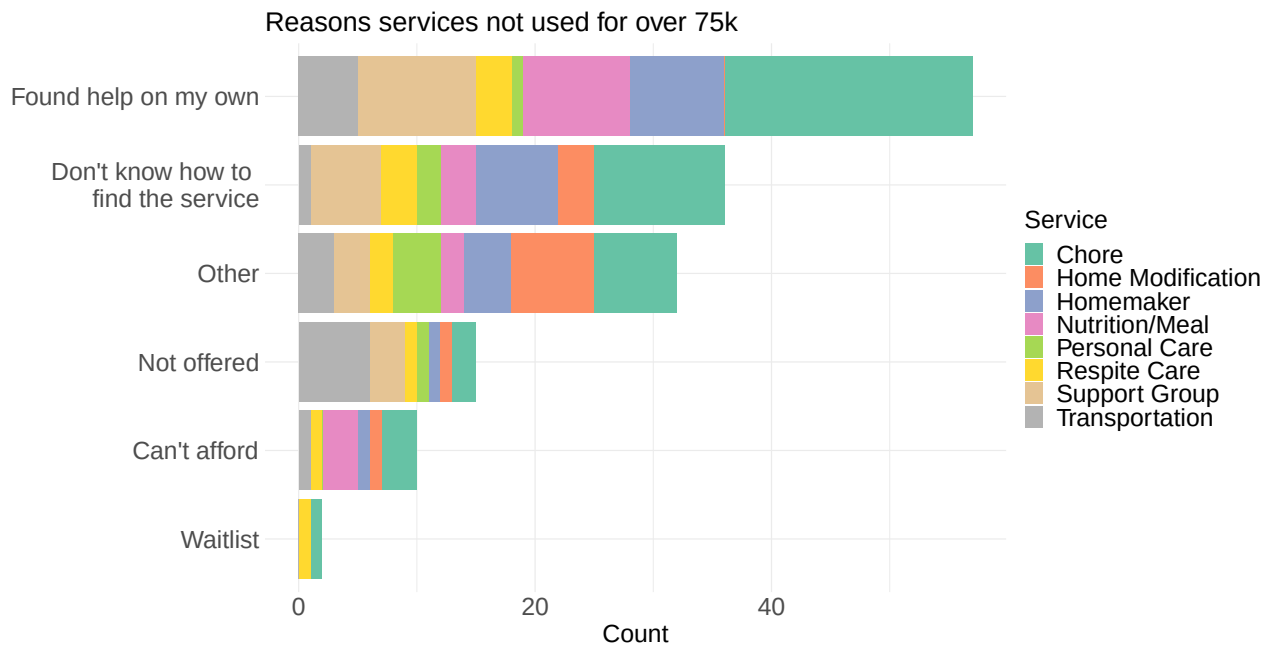


Why aren't people with an income greater than 75k using services?

As shown in the stacked barplot below, most people with an income greater than 75k found help on their own, with a significant portion also not knowing how to find the service and for other reasons.

Table 3: Reasons of services not being used

Reason	Chore	Homemaker	Home Modification	Nutrition/Meal	Personal Care and Home Health	Respite Care	Support Group	Transportation
Not offered	2	1	1	0	1	1	3	6
Don't know how to find the service	11	7	3	3	2	3	6	1
Can't afford	3	1	1	3	0	1	0	1
Waitlist	1	0	0	0	0	1	0	0
Found help on my own	21	8	0	9	1	3	10	5
Other	7	4	7	2	4	2	3	3



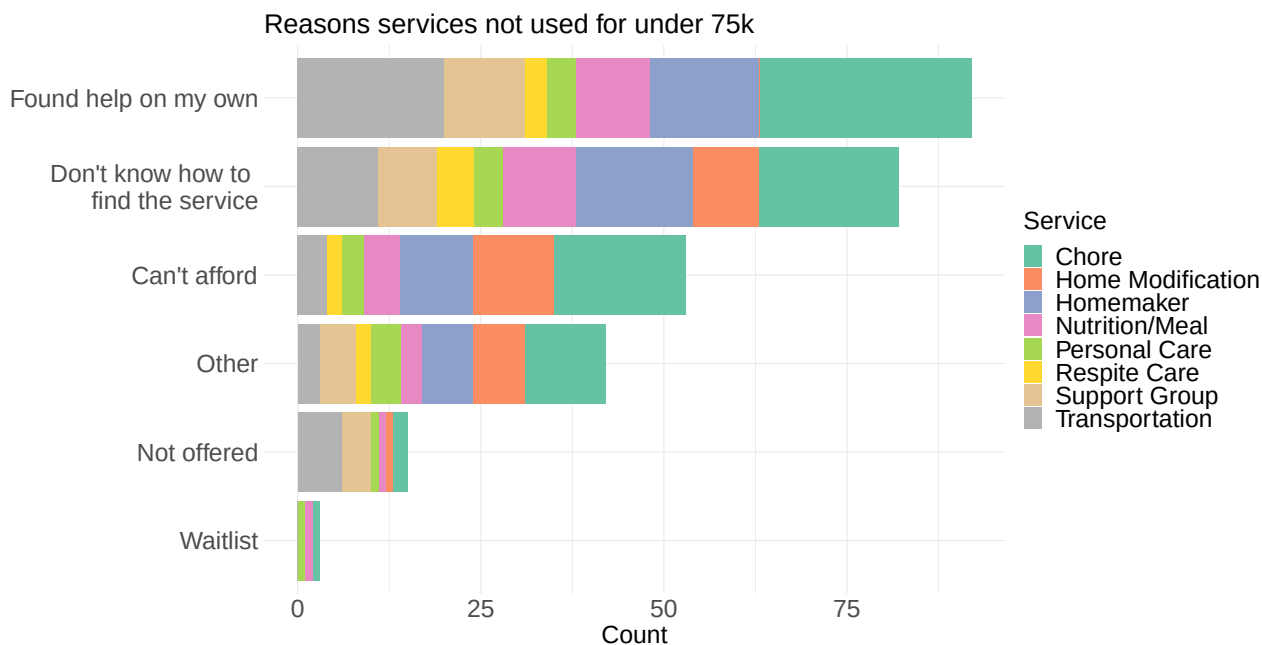
Why aren't people with an income less than 75k using services?

As shown in the stacked barplot below, most people with an income greater than 75k found help on their own, with a significant portion also not knowing how to find the service and not being able to afford it.

The main differences based on income level are that a greater proportion of those with the lesser income not knowing how to find the service, as well as there being a higher proportion of those with the lesser income not being able to afford services.

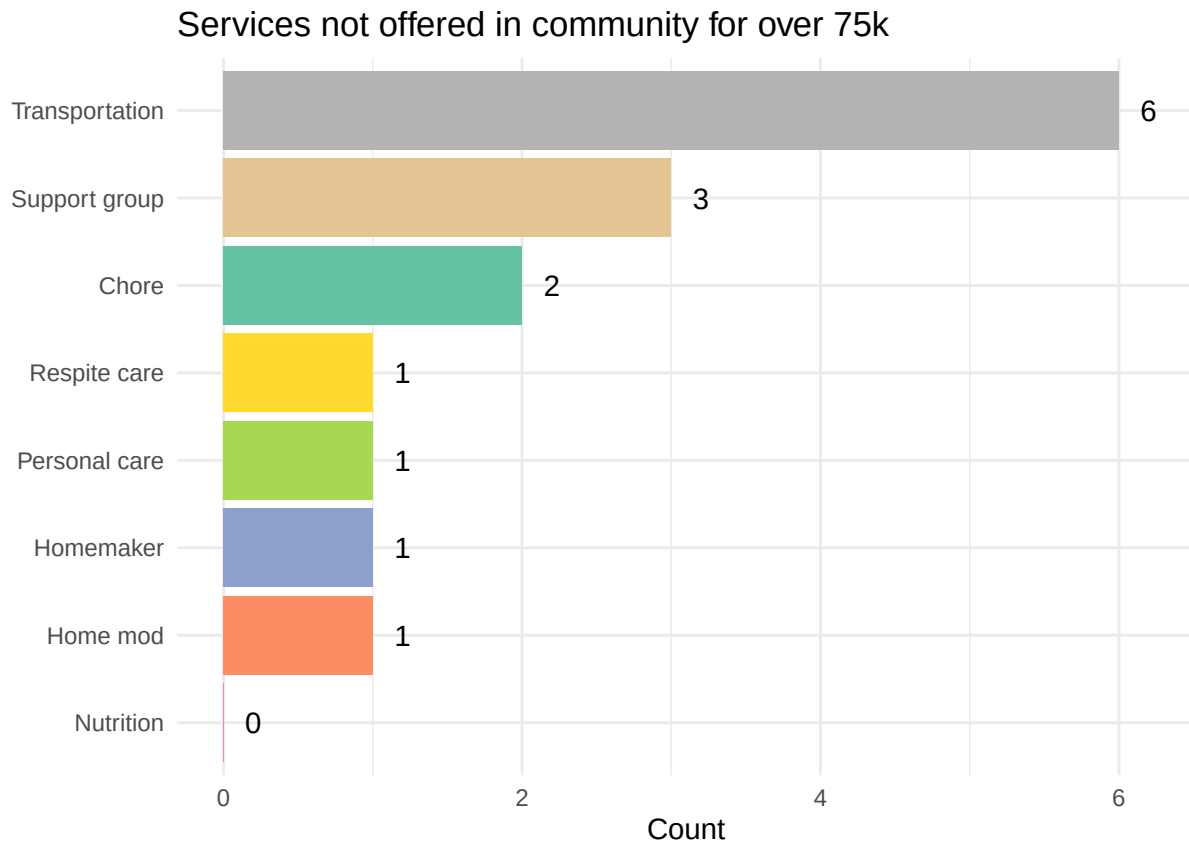
Table 4: Reasons of services not being used

Reason	Chore	Homemaker	Home Modification	Nutrition/Meal	Personal Care and Home Health	Respite Care	Support Group	Transportation
Not offered	2	0	1	1		1	0	4
Don't know how to find the service	19	16	9	10	4	5	8	11
Can't afford	18	10	11	5	3	2	0	4
Waitlist	1	0	0	1	1	0	0	0
Found help on my own	29	15	0	10	4	3	11	20
Other	11	7	7	3	4	2	5	3



What services are not offered in the community for people with an income greater than 75k?

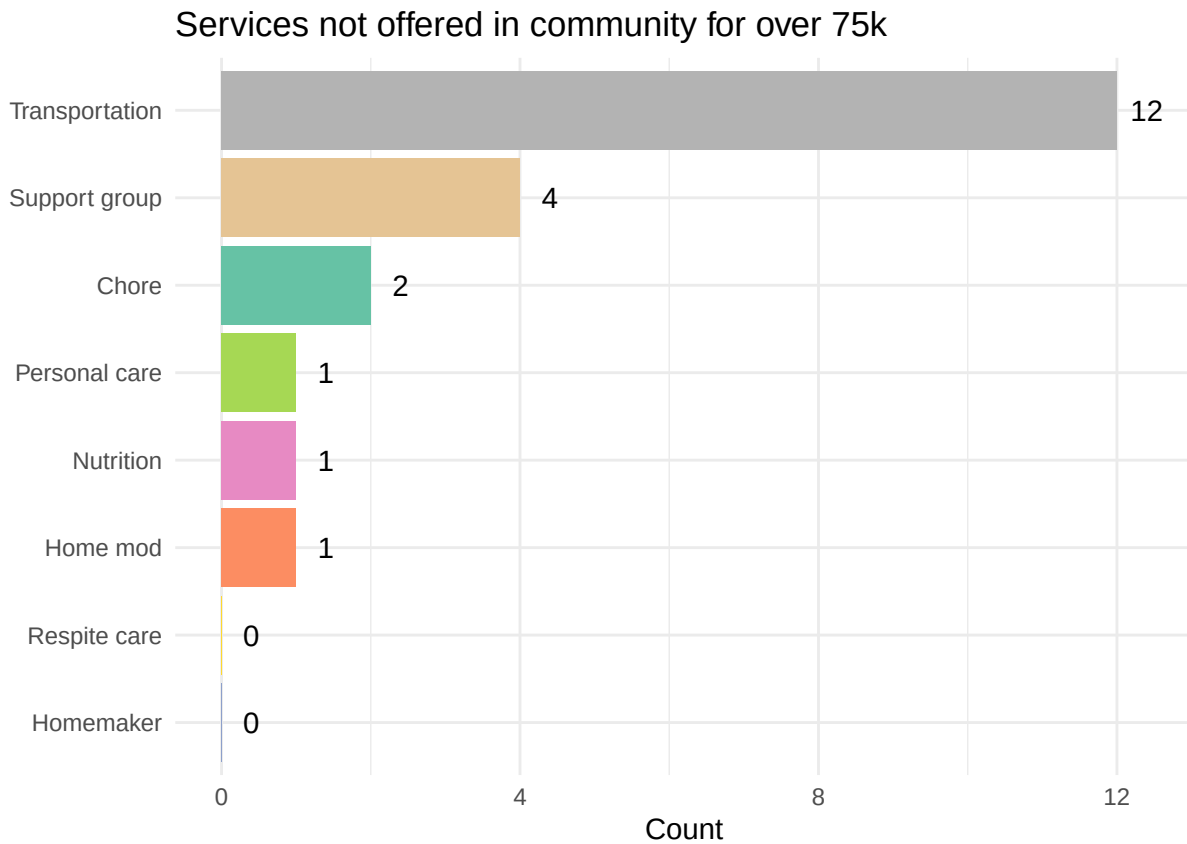
As shown in the bar plot below, transportation services stand out as being unavailable, with 6 people saying that transportation services were unavailable for them. Support group services follows with 3 people indicating so, with the 3rd most common service being marked as unavailable is chore services with 2 people.



What services are not offered in the community for people with an income less than 75k?

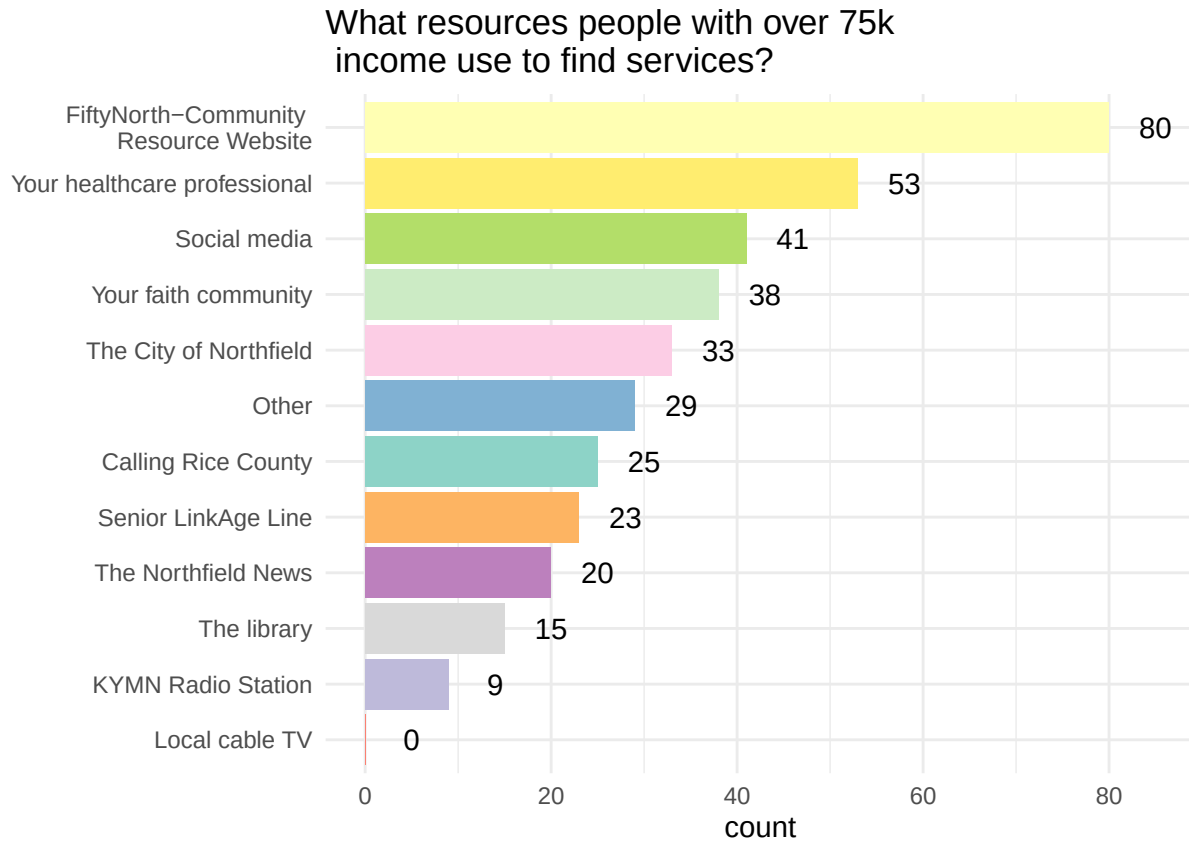
As shown in the bar plot below, transportation services stand out as being unavailable, with 12 people saying that transportation services were unavailable for them. Support group services follows with 4 people indicating so, with the 3rd most common service being marked as unavailable is chore services with 2 people.

There are no differences in service unavailability based on income.



What resources do people with an income greater than 75k use to find services?

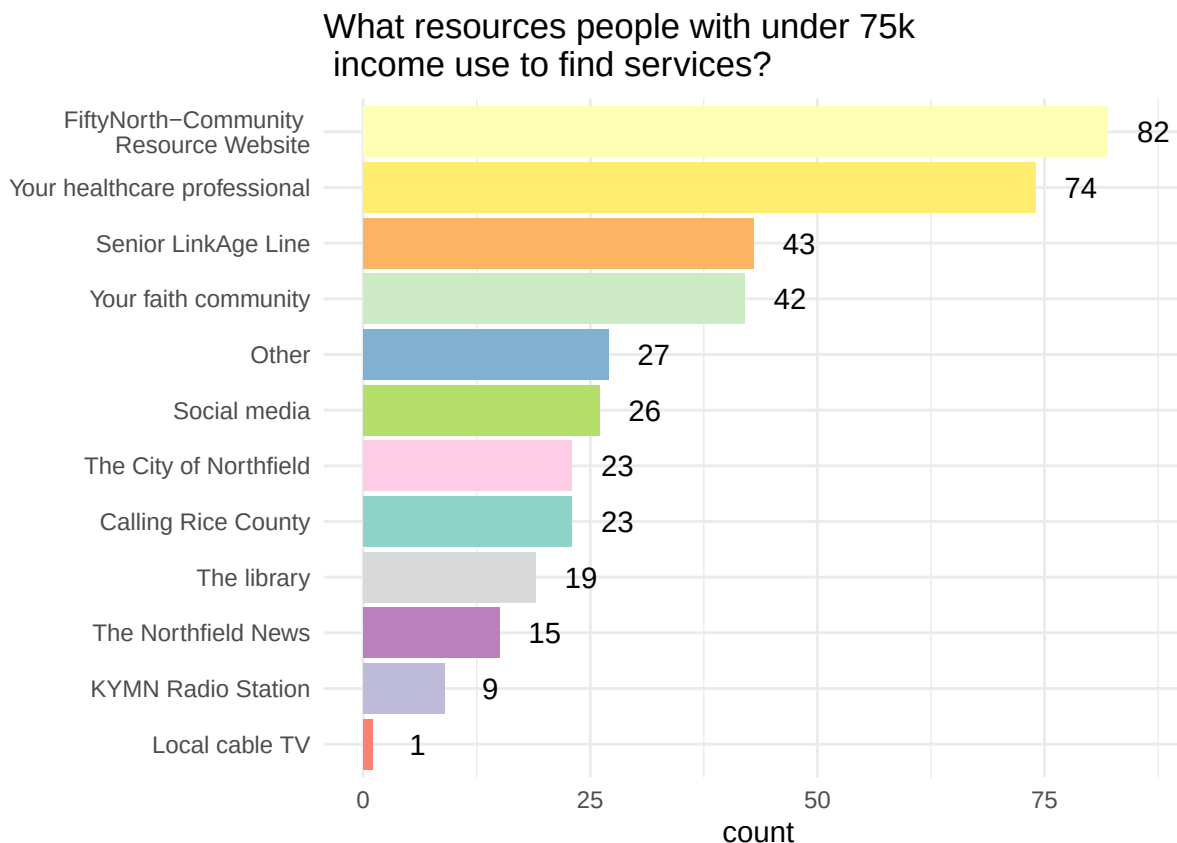
Out of the 136 people with an income greater than 75k that answered this question, most people use FiftyNorth to find services, with 80 people doing so. Healthcare professionals and social media are the next two commonly used resources for information, with 53 and 41 people using these services respectively.



What resources do people with an income less than 75k use to find services?

Out of the 154 people with an income less than 75k that answered this question, most people use FiftyNorth to find services, with 82 people doing so, closely followed by healthcare professionals with 74 people using this resource. Senior LinkAge Line and faith communities are the next two commonly used resources for information, with 43 and 42 people using these services respectively.

The main differences in which resources are used based on income is that those with a greater income are more likely to use social media for information than those with a lesser income. Additionally, those with a lesser income use healthcare professionals, Senior LinkAge Line, and faith communities to a higher extent than those with a greater income.



Overall Income Analysis

For those with an income greater than 75k, chore, support group, and home modification services appear to need the most development.

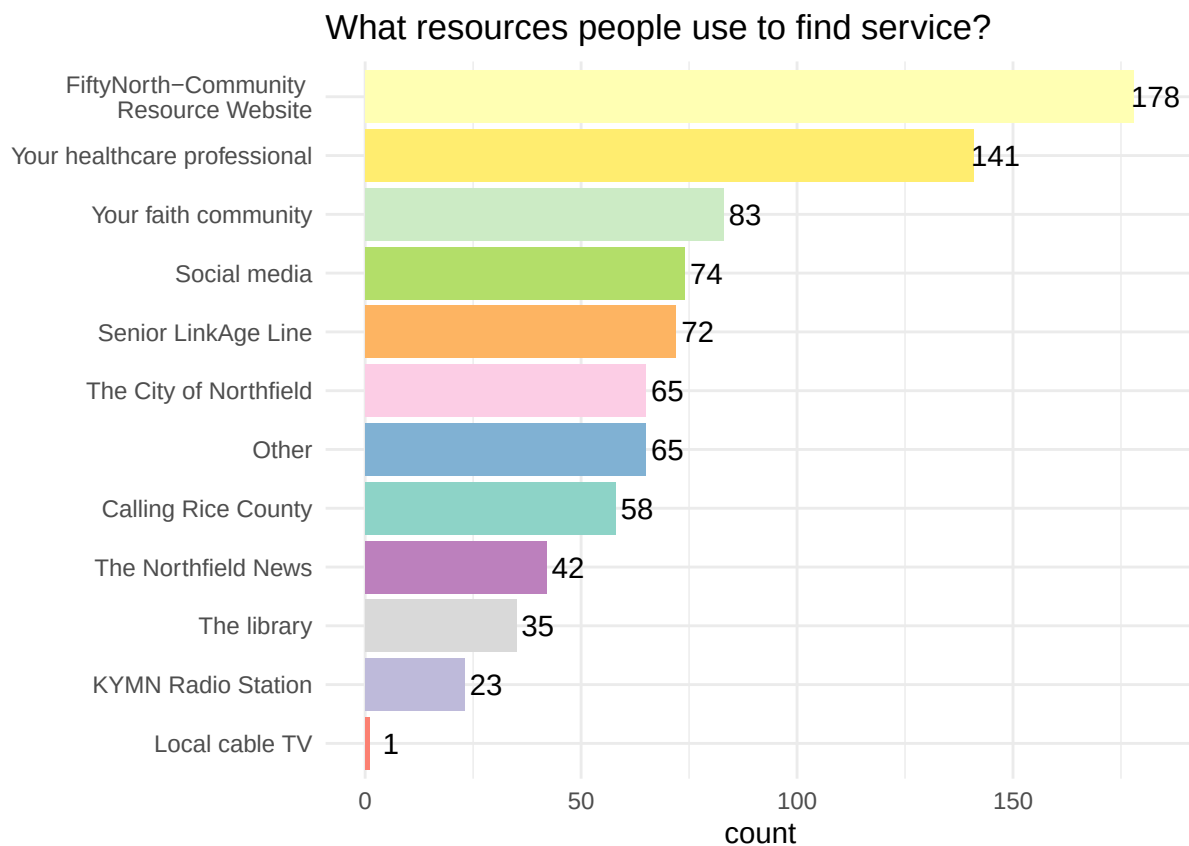
For those with an income less than 75k, chore, homemaker, transportation, and nutrition/meal services appear to need the most development.

A larger proportion of those with an income less than 75k did not know how to find services or couldn't afford them compared to those with an income greater than 75k.

Based on the counts of people answering the questions, the new development from this analysis is that **nutrition/meal services** are especially in need of development for low-income adults. The development needs for the other services have been highlighted previously.

Demographics

D1. What resources people use to find services?



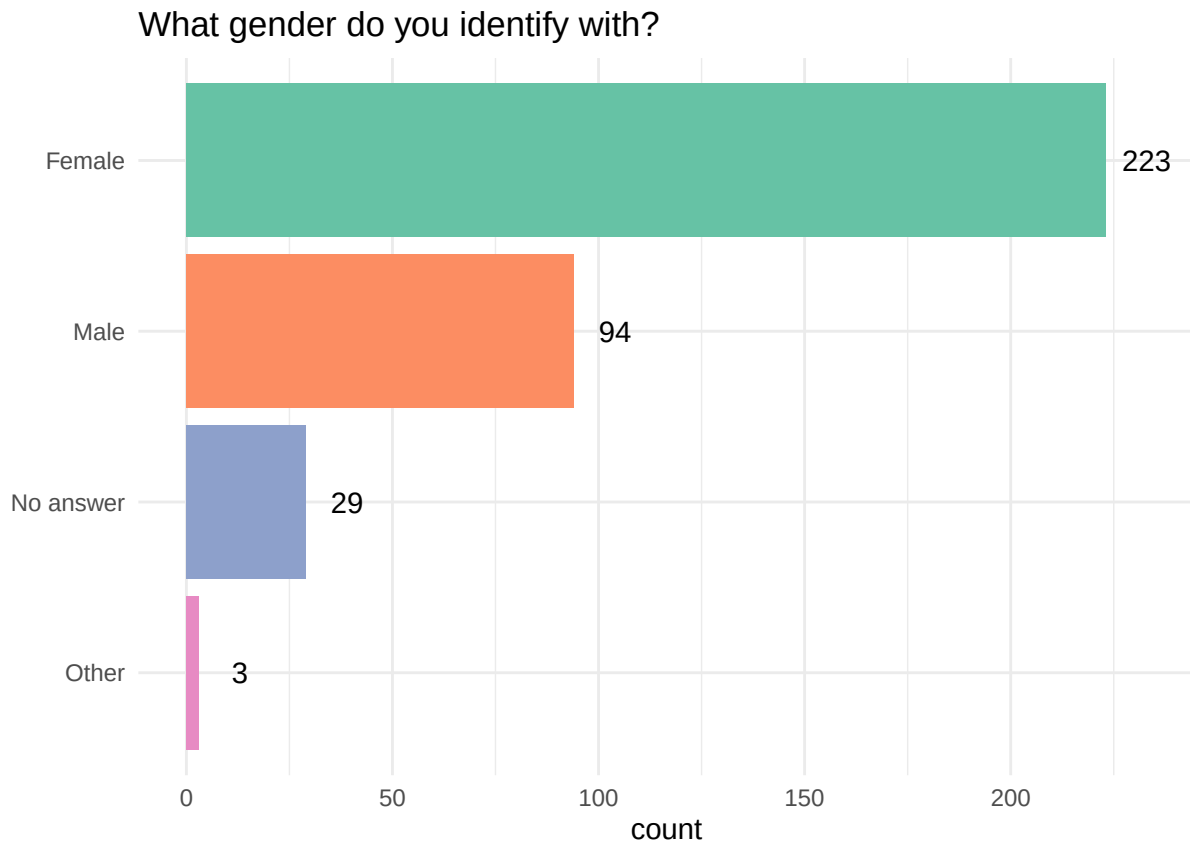
Text Responses

1. "Internet"
2. "Northfield Hospital"
3. "internet search"
4. "family and friends"
5. "friends"
6. "Email"
7. "Friends and acquaintances"
8. "Friends/Colleagues"
9. "Neighbours"
10. "City of Dundas"
11. "web"
12. "web search for service providers"
13. "Internet"
14. "Asking friends for suggestions or referrals"
15. "The Interwebs"
16. "family members"
17. "Family/friends"
18. "Google"
19. "Northfield Hospital Social Services Dept."
20. "a family member"
21. "Internet"
22. "personal network"

23. "internet"
24. "I wouldn't know so I'd ask friends for ideas"
25. "referrals from friends"
26. "My fellow colleagues for health care as we trade services"
27. "Google"
28. "google"
29. "Friend recommendation-word of mouth"
30. "my dtr's"
31. "Since there is no other place to add comment, the BEST thing you can do for seniors is to SHOVEL downtown sidewalks!! And keep the streets plowed along the curbs; most seniors are terrified of falls and stay home in the winter. We need to be safe getting OUT of our homes for errands, meeting friends, and going to appointments. More consistency on snow removal in shopping areas is needed."
32. "Google"
33. "Internet"
34. "Friend"
35. "Friends and family"
36. "Chose more than three: (1) your healthcare professional (2) Social Media (3) online resources"
37. "Friends"
38. "Friends"
39. "Google"
40. "Chose more than three: FiftyNorth, Your Healthcare professional, calling Rice County, Senior LinkAge Line, Social Media"
41. "Web search (Google, DuckDuckGo)"
42. "Three Links"
43. "Website: neighborhood"
44. "Internet search"
45. "Chamber of Commerce"
46. "Internet"
47. "Calling Dakota County (I am a Northfield resident but my home is in Dakota County)"
48. "Rice County Area on Aging"
49. "Other selected - Senior LinkAge Line and Your healthcare professional; FiftyNorth-Community Resource Website – I am not a member and did not think bout their Resource Website for these services"
50. "CAC or Three Rivers Community Action"
51. "private care givers that I know"
52. "friends and family"
53. "NRC"
54. "also chose... Your faith community, FiftyNorth, the library, social media"
55. "also chose... your faith community, FiftyNorth, KYMN, your healthcare professional, calling rice county, Senior LinkAge Line, social media"
56. "Also chose... KYMN and your healthcare professional"
57. "Also chose... your faith community, your healthcare professional"
58. "Also chose... calling Rice County, Senior LinkAge Line"
59. "friends"
60. "also chose... Local cable TV and Your healthcare professional"
61. "friends, family"
62. "Also selected... The City of Nfld, FiftyNorth, Your faith community, social media, Your healthcare professional, the library"
63. "Also chose... Your faith community, calling Rice County, social media, Your healthcare professional"
64. "wife and other family members"

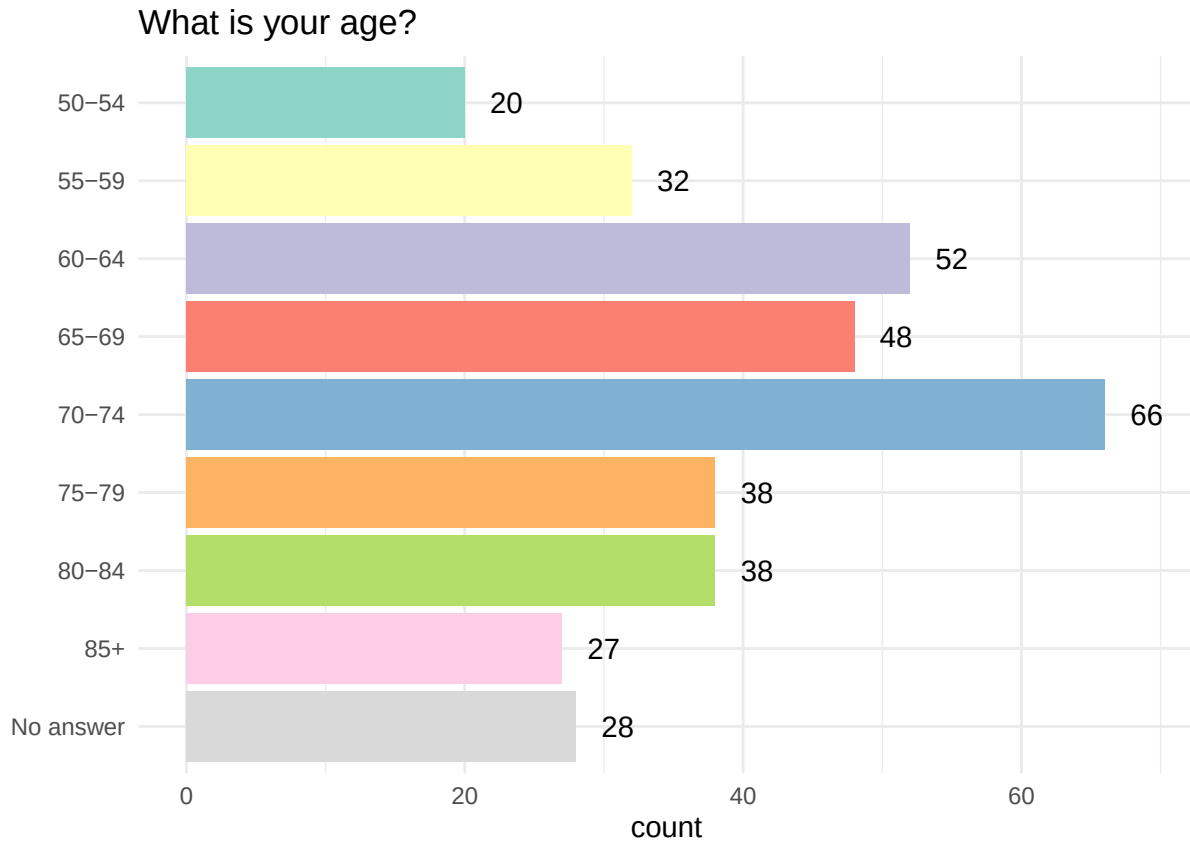
D2. What gender do you identify with?

Among the 320 people answering this question, 223 people identified themselves as females(69.7%), 94 identified as males(29.4%) and three identified as others(1%). In the text response, one response said “She/They”.



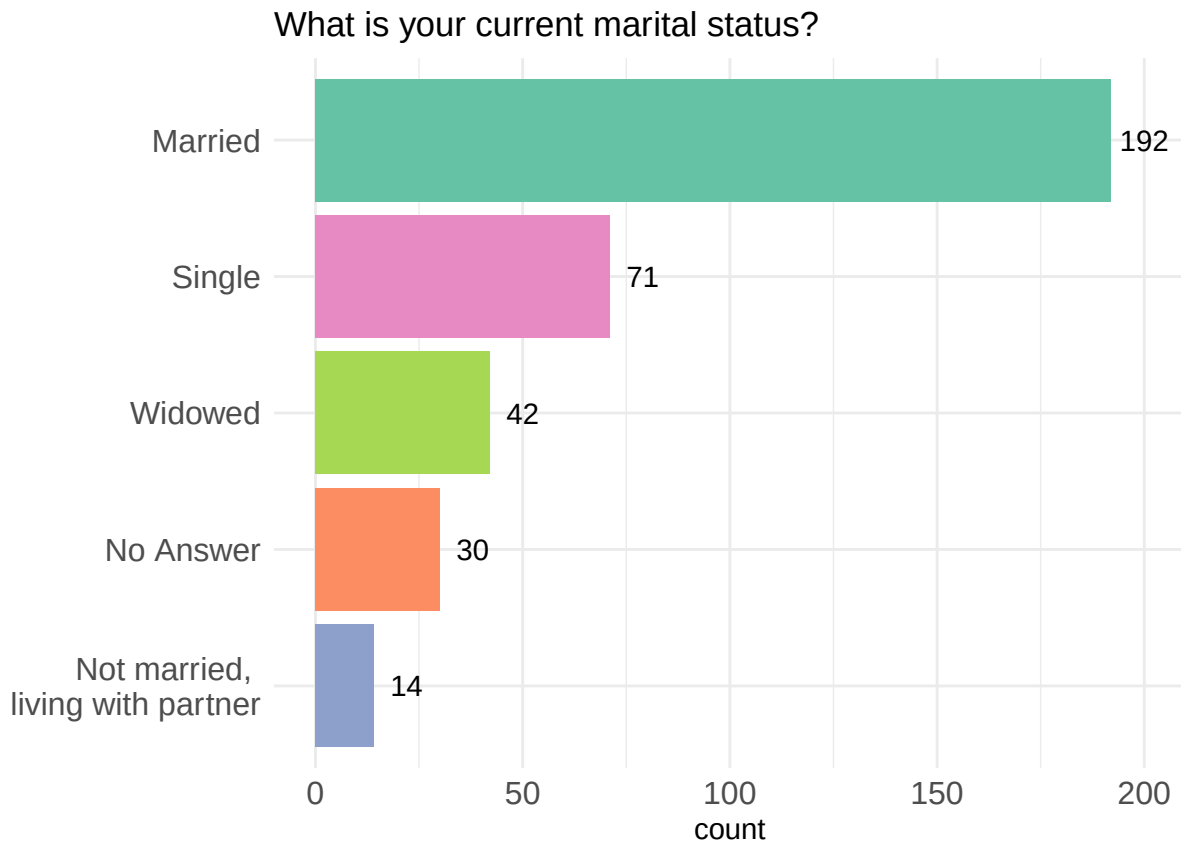
D3. What is your age?

There are 321 people answering this question. 20 people aged between 50-54, 32 people aged between 55-59, 52 people aged between 60-64, 48 people aged between 65-69, 66 people aged between 70-74, 38 people aged between 75-79, 38 people aged between 80-84, and 27 people aged 80+.



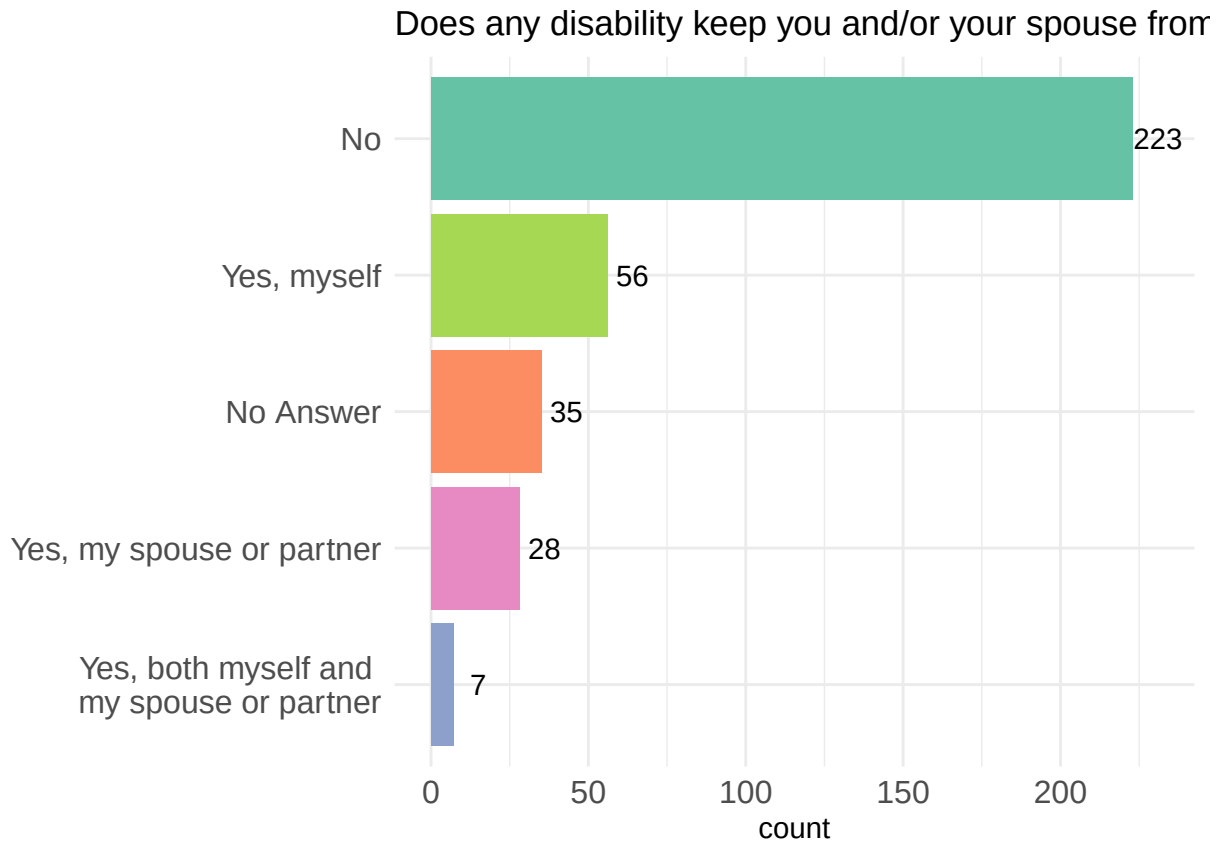
D4. What is your current marital status?

There are 319 people answering this question. 192 people are married, 71 people are single, 42 people are widowed, and 14 people are not married but living with a partner.



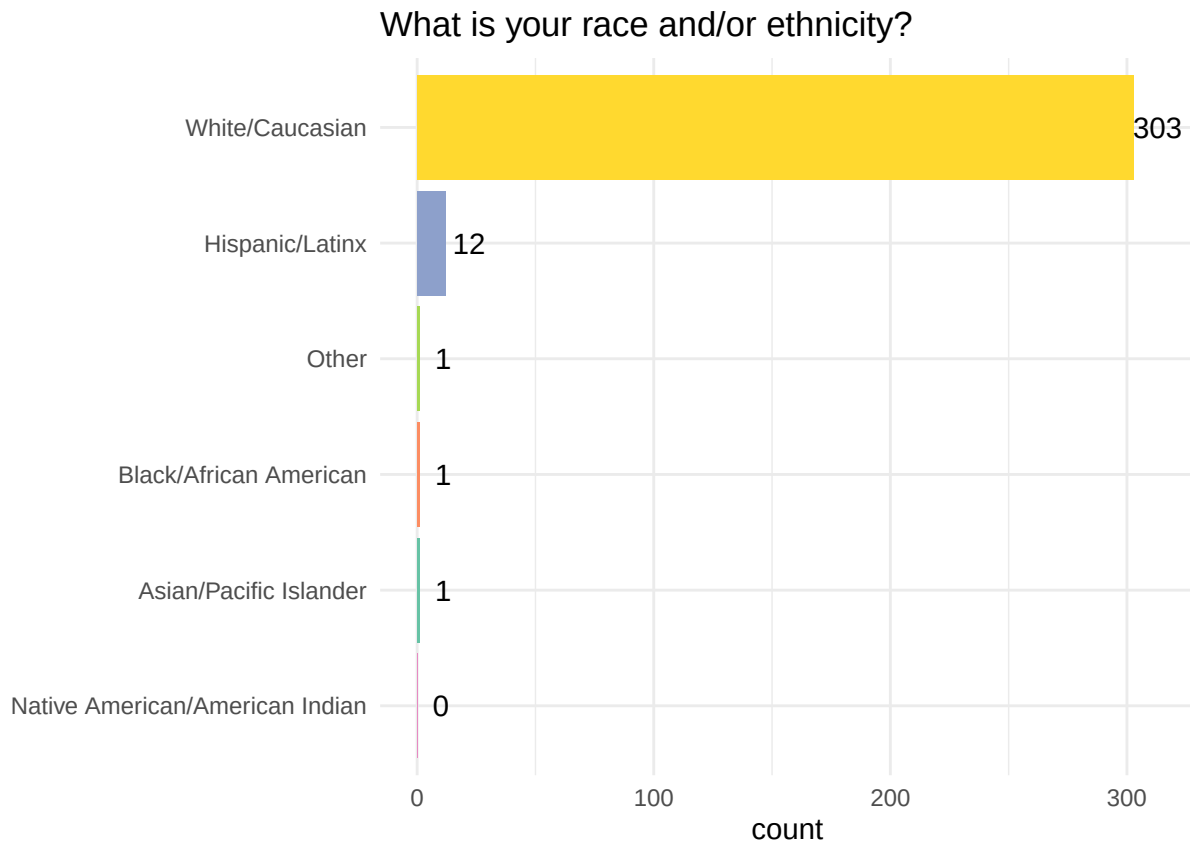
D5. Does any disability, handicap, or chronic disease keep you and/or your spouse or partner from fully participating in work, housework, or other activities?

There are 314 people answering this question. 223 people say that they don't have any disability, handicap, or chronic disease that keeps them from fully participating in work, housework, or other activities. 56 people indicated that they are disabled, 28 people indicated that their spouse or partner are disabled, and 7 people indicated both themselves and their spouse or partner are disabled.



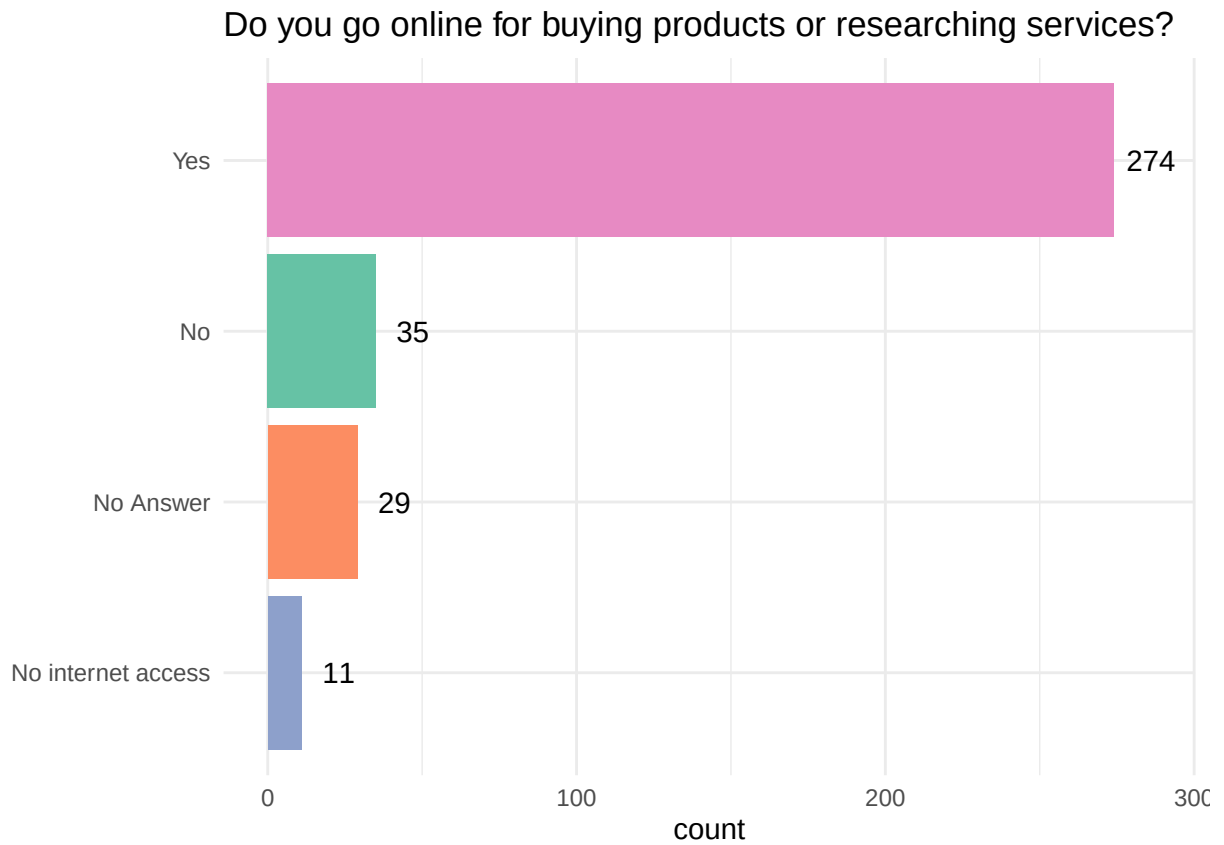
D6. What is your race and/or ethnicity?

There are 318 people answering this question. 303 people identify as white/Caucasian, 12 people identify as hispanic/Latinx, 1 identifies as other, 1 identifies as black/African American, and 1 identifies as Asian/Pacific Islander.



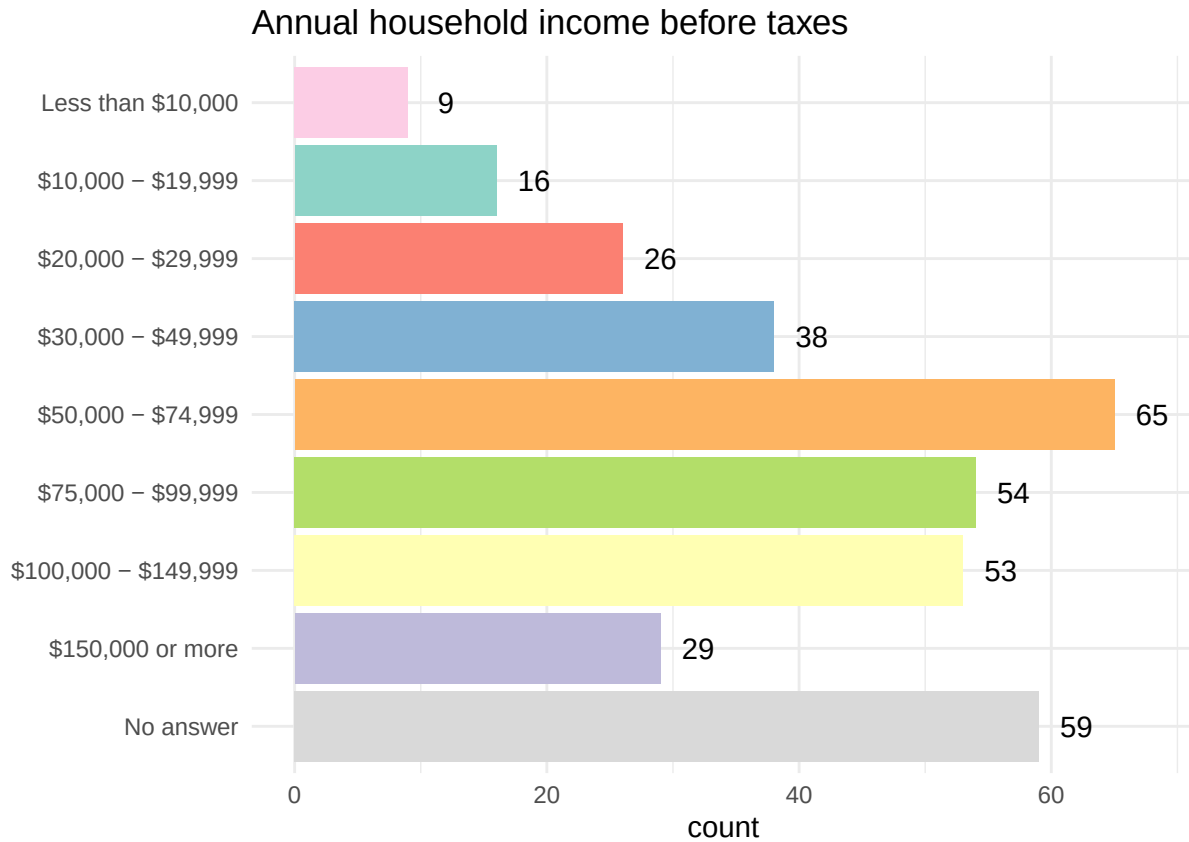
D7. Do you go online to access the internet for things like buying products or researching services?

There are 320 people answering this question. 274 people go online for buying products or researching services, 35 people do not, and 11 people do not have internet access.



D8. What was your annual household income before taxes in the most recent tax year?

There are 290 people answering this question. 9 people had annual household income less than \$10,000 before taxes, 16 people had \$10,000-\$19,999, 26 people had \$20,000-\$29,999, 38 people had \$30,000-\$49,999, 65 people had \$50,000-\$74,999, 54 people had \$75,000-\$99,999, 53 people \$100,000-\$149,999, and 29 people had \$150,000 or more.



D9. Which of the options below best describes your proximity to Northfield?

There are 316 people answering this question. 271 people live within the Northfield City limits, and 45 people live in rural Northfield.

